The Manifest Awakening of the Great Vairocana: The Extensive Blessing of Its Manifestations, a Dharma Discourse Called the King of the Lords of Sūtras

Mahāvairocanābhisaṃbodhivikurvitādhiṣṭhānavaipulyasūtrendrarājanāmadharmaparyāya · Toh 494 · Derge Kangyur

རྣམ་པར་སྣང་མཛད་ཆེན་པོ་མངོན་པར་རྫོགས་པར་བྱང་ཆུབ་པ་རྣམ་པར་སྤྲུལ་པ་བཟླ་གསྱི་རབྱོ་པ་ཤཱཝེ་ཏ་ཀ་རྒྱས་པ་མདོ་སོའེ་དཔང་པའོ་རྒྱལ་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའ་ཆསོ་ཀ་རྒྱ་སྣ་གདྲས

The Manifest Awakening of the Great Vairocana, known in Sanskrit as the Mahāvairocanābhisaṃbodhi and in Tibetan as Nampar Nangdzé Chenpo Ngönpar Dzokpar Changchupa, is one of the foundational scriptures of esoteric Buddhism, presented in its full title as an extensive discourse on the manifestations and blessing of Vairocana's perfect awakening, a king among sūtras. It is Toh 494 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the Tantra section among the tantras of conduct (caryā tantra). Set in Vairocana's vast vajra palace of the realm of phenomena, the text unfolds as a dialogue between Vairocana and the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, teaching the mind of awakening rooted in compassion and the practice of secret mantra, together with the construction of maṇḍalas, the use of mantras and mudrās, rites for removing obstructors, and the duty of protecting this teaching and its practitioners. It was translated into Tibetan by the Indian preceptor Śīlendrabodhi and the Tibetan translator Paltsek.

In the language of India: mahābairocana abhisaṃbodhi bikurbbati adhiṣṭhāna baipulya sūtra indrarājā nāma dharmmaparyāya

In the language of Tibet: The Discourse of Dharma Called the King of the Lords of Sūtras, the Extensive Blessing of the Manifestations of the Complete and Perfect Awakening of the Great Vairocana.

The first fascicle.

Homage to the Blessed One, Lord of Speech.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was dwelling within the great mansion of the king of jewels: the vast great vajra blessed by all the tathāgatas, the palace of the realm of phenomena (dharmadhātu), where all the vajra holders gather, which sports in manifold display through the inclination of the tathāgatas, which has neither edge nor center and whose pinnacles are lofty, and which arises superbly adorned with kings of jewels.

There he was seated upon the lion throne of the bodhisattva's body, together with vajra holders as numerous as the particles of the atoms of ten buddha fields, namely: the vajra holders Stainless Space, Moving Through Space, Arising from Space, Wearing Various Garments, Moving in Various Ways, Abiding in the Equality of All Phenomena, Vajra Protecting the Limitless Realm of Beings, Possessing the Strength of Nārāyaṇa, Possessing the Strength of the Great Nārāyaṇa, Excellent Vajra, Bearer of the Force of the Supreme Vajra, Stainless Vajra, Holder of the Supreme Vajra, Armor of the Tathāgata, Arising into the State of the Tathāgata, Abiding Free of Elaboration, Born from the Ten Powers of the Tathāgata, Stainless Eye, and the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi, and others besides.

Surrounded also by the great bodhisattvas Samantabhadra, Maitreya, Mañjuśrī, Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin and others, and gazed upon by them from before him, he taught the Dharma of the Dharma door called "The Ground of the Equality of Body, Speech and Mind," having blessed the day of the Tathāgata that transcends the three times.

Then those bodhisattvas, Samantabhadra and the others, and those vajra holders, the Lord of Secrets and the others, through the blessing of the Blessed One Vairocana, entered the unfolding of the inexhaustible treasury of the array of the equality of body. In the same way they entered the unfolding of the inexhaustible treasury of the array of the equality of speech and of mind. Yet they perceived no entering into, nor any turning back from, the body, speech or mind of the Blessed One Vairocana.

Everywhere, moreover, all the activities of body, all the activities of speech and all the activities of mind of the Blessed One Vairocana were seen teaching the Dharma to all the realms of beings throughout, with these words in the way of secret mantra. That is to say: for beings whose lives have been produced by karma, taking them up from the first generation of the mind of awakening, in order to bring them to completion in this very life up to the abiding on the ten grounds; and also, for those whose karmic lives have been cut off, in order to bring about the sprout of existence, forms resembling the bodies of the vajra holders, and resembling the bodies of the bodhisattva Samantabhadra and of Padmapāṇi, were also seen in the ten directions teaching the Dharma with the pure words of the way of secret mantra.

Then the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi, who was seated in that very assembly, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, the tathāgatas,

the arhats, the perfectly complete buddhas, having attained omniscient wisdom, distribute that omniscient wisdom among beings and teach it through various modes, various intentions and various means. To some they teach the way of the śrāvaka vehicle, to some the way of the pratyekabuddha vehicle, to some the way of the Great Vehicle, to some the way of the five superknowledges; to some they teach the Dharma for being born as gods, to some for being born as humans, and so on up to being born as mahoragas, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas and kiṃnaras.

"Among those beings, those to be tamed by a buddha see it in the form of a buddha, some in the form of a śrāvaka, some in the form of a pratyekabuddha, some in the form of a bodhisattva, some in the form of Maheśvara, some in the form of Brahmā, some in the form of Nārāyaṇa, some in the form of Vaiśravaṇa, and so on, some seeing it as mahoragas, and as humans and nonhumans. They see it in the modes of speech of each of their own kinds and in various modes of conduct. Yet that omniscient wisdom is, in this way, of one taste, the taste of the liberation of the Tathāgata.

"Blessed One, for example, the element of space is free from all thought and all conceptualization; it does not think and does not conceptualize. Likewise, Blessed One, omniscient wisdom too is free from all thought; it does not think and does not conceptualize.

"Blessed One, for example, this great earth is the sustenance of all beings. Likewise, Blessed One, omniscient wisdom too is the sustenance of the world with its gods, humans and asuras.

"Blessed One, for example, the element of fire burns all fuel and is never sated. Likewise omniscient wisdom too burns all the fuel of ignorance and is never sated.

"Blessed One, for example, the element of wind clears away all dust. Likewise, Blessed One, omniscient wisdom too clears away all the dust of ignorance.

"Blessed One, for example, the element of water refreshes the bodies of all beings.

"Likewise omniscient wisdom too thoroughly refreshes the world with its gods. That being so, Blessed One, what is the cause of this wisdom? What is its root? What is its culmination?"

When he had made this request, the Blessed One Vairocana spoke these words to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, excellent, excellent! Vajrapāṇi, it is excellent

indeed that you ask me about this matter. Therefore listen, and keep it well and thoroughly in mind, and I shall explain it to you.

"The cause is the awakening mind. The root is great compassion. The culmination is skillful means.

"Lord of Secrets, what then is awakening? It is to know one's own mind fully, exactly as it really is, and that is unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Lord of Secrets, in it there is not even an atom of any phenomenon, and nothing is perceived. Why is that? Because awakening has the characteristic of space. In it there is no one who awakens, and nothing whatsoever to be awakened to. Why is that? Because awakening has no characteristics. Lord of Secrets, all phenomena too are without characteristics; that is, they have the characteristic of space."

Then Vajrapāṇi again spoke these words to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, where should omniscience be sought? By what is awakening fully and perfectly attained?"

The Blessed One said: "Lord of Secrets, awakening and omniscience are to be sought in one's own mind. Why is that? Because that mind is by nature completely pure. It is not within, nor is it outside, nor is it perceived anywhere between the two.

"Lord of Secrets, that mind has not been seen by the tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly complete buddhas, nor will it be seen. It is not blue, it is not yellow, it is not red, it is not white, it is not madder colored, it is not crystal colored. It is not short, it is not long, it is not round, it is not square. It is not light, it is not darkness. It is not male, it is not female, it is not neuter.

"Lord of Secrets, that mind is not of the nature of the desire realm, it is not of the nature of the form realm, it is not of the nature of the formless realm. It is not of the nature of the shared classes of beings among the destinies of gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, humans and nonhumans.

"Lord of Secrets, that mind does not abide in the eye; it is not in the ear, it is not in the nose, it is not in the tongue, it is not in the body, and it does not abide in the mind. Why is that? Because that mind has the characteristic of space, and is therefore free from all thought and all conceptualization. Why is that? Because whatever is the nature of space is the nature of the mind, and whatever is the nature of the mind is the nature of awakening. Lord of Secrets,

thus mind, the expanse of space and awakening are not two and cannot be made into two. Moreover, it has compassion as its root and is embraced by the perfection of skillful means.

"Therefore, Lord of Secrets, by this explanation too it should be understood that whatever teachings I give in the assembly of bodhisattvas, all of them are for the sake of purifying the awakening mind and of fully knowing the mind. Therefore, Lord of Secrets, a son or daughter of good family who wishes to know awakening fully should fully know their own mind.

"Lord of Secrets, if you ask how one should fully know one's own mind, it is like this: though one seeks it thoroughly as an aspect, or as a color, or as a shape, or as an object, or as form, or as feeling, or as perception, or as formations, or as consciousness, or as a self, or as belonging to a self, or as the grasped, or as the grasper, or as pure, or as impure, or as an element, or as a sense source, and so on through every aspect, it is not found.

"Lord of Secrets, this is the first way of the illumination of the Dharma, the door of the illumination of the Dharma called the door of the purification of the bodhisattva's awakening mind. Abiding in it, bodhisattvas attain with little difficulty the meditative absorption that dispels all obscurations. Having attained it, bodhisattvas come to dwell in the company of all the buddhas. They also attain the five superknowledges. They also attain the dhāraṇī of limitless languages, sounds and tones. They come to know the thoughts of beings, and, blessed by all the tathāgatas, they come to have a nature that never degenerates while in saṃsāra. They become untiring in working for the welfare of beings. They become firmly established in unconditioned moral discipline, they abandon wrong views, and they come to realize and penetrate the correct view.

"Furthermore, Lord of Secrets, a bodhisattva who abides in this meditative absorption that dispels all obscurations, through the power of devoted faith that has arisen, perfects all the qualities of a buddha with little difficulty. Lord of Secrets, in short, that son or daughter of good family comes to possess immeasurable good qualities."

Then Vajrapāṇi again questioned the Blessed One: "Blessed One, how is it that one speaks of generating the mind toward awakening?

"How should one know the characteristics
Of the mind that arises, from which awakening comes?
Supreme among those who know minds,

Great Hero, born of wisdom,
Please teach how many minds it passes beyond
And then comes to arise.
Protector, please explain at length
The characteristics of the mind and the times as well.
What kind of merit do they have,
And what kind of conduct do they come to have?
Great Sage, please teach also
The distinctions of mind upon mind."

When he had made this request, at that time
The Blessed One, the Great Vairocana,
Said these words to Vajrapāṇi of noble birth:
"Excellent, my son!
The supreme state of the Great Vehicle,
The characteristics of the mind's continuum,
The supreme secret of the perfect buddhas,
Which no logicians know,
I shall explain to you in full.
Gather your mind one-pointedly and listen.

"Passing beyond a hundred and sixty minds,
For the sake of awakening itself,
The essence from which the greatest merit comes,
That from which awakening arises, is born.
Measureless like space,
Unstained, it abides just as it is;
It is not moved by any phenomenon,
Primordially at peace and without characteristics.
Accomplished through measureless wisdom,
It is the perfect Buddha, the Teacher.
Because it is accomplished through offering and conduct,
It is held to be the first, for the sake of awakening.

"Lord of Secrets, in beginningless saṃsāra, childish ordinary beings, through clinging to the grasping at 'I' and the grasping at 'mine,' have conceived countless distinctions of the self. Lord of Secrets, without examining the very nature of the self, they rouse the grasping at 'I,' thinking 'this is my self.' Others conceive of it as arising from time, as emanated by a holder, as

emerging with certainty; that is, as Īśvara, the Emitter, Time, the Principal (pradhāna), the agent, the non-agent, yoga, the measure, the pure, the impure, the inner self, the Person (puruṣa), the all-pervading lord, the life principle, the individual, consciousness, the all-base (ālaya), the knower, the seer, the grasped, the grasper, knowledge, the knowable, that which is to be realized, the Manu-born, the child of Manu, the expressible and the inexpressible. Lord of Secrets, these and other such distinctions of the self were conceived in the past by yogis who desired yoga, wishing for liberation.

"Furthermore, Lord of Secrets, among childish ordinary beings, who are like cattle, once in a hundred times a thought of the Dharma occasionally arises, like this: 'I shall keep the fasting observance.' They hold just that much in mind, and, gaining satisfaction from it, they cultivate it again and again. Lord of Secrets, that is the first mind, like the seed from which virtuous action grows.

"With that as its cause, on each of the days that bear that mark, one gives gifts to one's father and mother, sons and daughters, friends and relatives. This is the second, like a sprout.

"Furthermore, one gives that same gift also to those one does not know. This is the third, like a stalk.

"Furthermore, one seeks out worthy recipients and gives that same gift to them. This is the fourth, like leaves.

"Furthermore, one joyfully gives that same gift to teachers or to musicians. This is the fifth, like a flower.

"Furthermore, one gives that same gift to those who are dear to one's heart. This is the sixth, like a fruit.

"Furthermore, Lord of Secrets, one guards moral discipline in order to be reborn in the higher realms. This is the seventh, like its enjoyment.

"Furthermore, Lord of Secrets, while one wanders in saṃsāra with just such a mind, one hears these words from some spiritual friend:

"'These gods are great gods;
They grant happiness to all.
If you honor them with reverence,
All will become prosperity for you.
They are, namely,
Īśvara and Brahmā,

Likewise Viṣṇu, Śaṅkara,
Rudra and also Skanda,
The Sun, the Moon, Varuṇa himself,
Kubera, Dhanada, Śakra,
Virūpākṣa, Viśvakarman,
Yama, Kālarātri, Nirvāṇa,
The one called Chief of the World,
Agni, Garuḍa the son of Vinatā,
Likewise the goddess Umā,
Padma and the nāga Takṣaka,
Vāsuki and the one called Śaṅkha,
Karkoṭaka, Mahāpadma,
Kulika and Many-Hooded,
The Eternal One, Ananta, the Primordial God,
Likewise the gods and the supreme sages,
The Veda and the men of the Veda.
Make offerings to them, wise one!'

"Hearing such words from him,
One's mind becomes truly satisfied,
And then, filled with deep reverence,
One serves them devotedly.

"Lord of Secrets, this is the supreme relief for childish ordinary beings who wander throughout saṃsāra. This has become a strength, and the Victors have declared it the eighth mind.

"Furthermore, Lord of Secrets, with higher understanding, among those who abide distinctively in each of the distinctions proclaimed as described, an understanding toward the aim of isolation (kaivalya) arises. Yet, saying 'it exists, it exists,' they think of emptiness alone as an entity. Lord of Secrets, they do not truly know emptiness. Emptiness is not an entity, nor is it a non-entity; it is not existent, nor is it nonexistent, nor is it both. If there is neither conceptualizing nor non-conceptualizing about it, how could one conceive of it as 'empty'?

"Those who do not know emptiness
Do not know nirvāṇa.
Therefore, by destroying entity and non-entity,

Emptiness is to be known."

Then Vajrapāṇi again made a request to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, please explain those distinctions of mind." When he had made this request, the Blessed One spoke these words to the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi:

"Lord of Secrets, listen to the characteristics of the distinctions of mind. Lord of Secrets, these minds are: the mind of attachment, the mind free of attachment, the mind of aversion, the mind of loving-kindness, the mind of delusion, the mind of wisdom, the decisive mind, the mind of doubt, the darkened mind, the illuminated mind, the gathering mind, the mind of strife, the mind of dispute, the mind without dispute, the mind of a god, the mind of an asura, the mind of a nāga, the mind of a human, the mind of a woman, the mind of a lord, the mind of a merchant, the mind of a farmer, the mind of a river, the mind of a pond, the mind of a well, the guarding mind, the mind of avarice, the mind of a dog, the mind of a cat, the mind of a garuḍa, the mind of a mouse, the mind of song, the mind of dance, the mind of the cymbal, the mind of a house, the mind of a lion, the mind of an owl, the mind of a crow, the mind of a rākṣasa, the mind of a thorn, the mind of the underground, the mind of wind, the mind of water, the mind of fire, the mind of mud, the mind of turbidity, the mind of pigment, the mind of a plank, the mind of error, the mind of poison, the mind of a noose, the mind of a fetter, the mind of a cloud, the mind of a field, the mind of salt, the mind of a razor, the mind like Mount Meru, the mind like the ocean, the mind like a cave, and the mind that has been born.

"Lord of Secrets, what is the mind of attachment? It is to engage with phenomena with attachment. What is the mind free of attachment? It is to engage with phenomena free of attachment. What is the mind of aversion? It is to engage with phenomena with hostility. What is the mind of loving-kindness? It is to engage with phenomena endowed with loving-kindness. What is the mind of delusion? It is to engage with phenomena without examining them. What is the mind of wisdom? It is to engage with phenomena so as to realize distinction upon distinction. What is the decisive mind? It is to act exactly in accordance with the command and words of one's teacher. What is the mind of doubt? It is to engage in hesitation about certainties, however they are held. What is the darkened mind? It is to perceive doubt where there is nothing to doubt. What is the illuminated mind? It is to engage without doubt where there is nothing to doubt. What is the

gathering mind? It is to make many into one. What is the mind of strife? It is mutual contention. What is the mind of dispute? It is to dispute self against self. What is the mind without dispute? It is to view all alike, with evenness.

"What is the mind of a god? It is to be proud of oneself in one's mind. What is the mind of an asura? It is to disparage saṃsāra itself. What is the mind of a nāga? It is to think of acquiring great wealth. What is the mind of a human? It is to think for the sake of that very other. What is the mind of a woman? It is to engage with phenomena solely for the sake of desire. What is the mind of a lord? It is to be proud, thinking, 'I have conceived everything.' What is the mind of a merchant? It is to gather, multiply, and afterwards enjoy. What is the mind of a farmer? It is to seek many kinds of learning and afterwards make use of them. What is the mind of a river? It is to engage while looking to the two extremes. What is the mind of a pond? It is to engage with craving. What is the mind of a well? It is to think what is not deep to be deep. What is the guarding mind? It is to think, 'This alone is true; anything else is delusion.' What is the mind of avarice? It is to keep things for oneself and not give to others. What is the mind of a cat? It is to engage while looking for honors. What is the mind of a dog? It is to be satisfied even with little. What is the mind of a garuḍa? It is to engage with the Dharma by holding to a faction. What is the mind of a mouse? It is to think of cutting through all bonds.

"What is the mind of song? It is to think, 'I shall win over beings with songs of various melodies.' What is the mind of dance? It is to think, 'Through various miracles I shall bring others to embrace what is right.' What is the mind of the cymbal? It is to think, 'I shall beat the drum of the Dharma.' What is the mind of a house? It is to engage with things in order to protect one's own body. What is the mind of a lion? It is to engage in overpowering all. What is the mind of an owl? It is to think at night. What is the mind of a crow? It is to think with fear of everything. What is the mind of a rākṣasa? It is to accomplish nonvirtue by means of virtue. What is the mind of a thorn? It is to think with regret about everything. What is the mind of the underground? It is to think for the sake of what lies beneath the earth. What is the mind of wind? It is to accomplish everything everywhere. What is the mind of water? It is to engage with things in order to wash away all nonvirtue. What is the mind of fire? It is to torment oneself with austerities. What is the mind of mud? It is to blame others for one's own faults. What is the mind of turbidity? It is to stir up turbidity in the mind by fixing on the faults of others. What is the mind of pigment? It is to engage with things through attachment to them. What is the

mind of a plank? It is to engage while abandoning other virtues.

"What is the mind of error? It is to take hold of one thing and think it entirely another. What is the mind of poison? It is to think of utter non-existence. What is the mind of a noose? It is to remain bound up in oneself in every respect. What is the mind of a fetter? It is to think while staying on one's two feet. What is the mind of a cloud? It is to think of rain. What is the mind of a field? It is to tend one's own body. What is the mind of salt? It is to think further about whatever one has been thinking. What is the mind of a razor? It is to rely on mere going forth. What is the mind like Mount Meru? It is to think from a lofty height. What is the mind like the ocean? It is to remain holding one's own body as supreme. What is the mind like a cave? It is to be certain at first and afterwards to change by that very thing. And what is the mind that has been born? It is the mind that goes along with just whatever formation it was born together with.

Lord of Secrets, in this way, by the doubling of one, two, three, four, and five, one passes beyond the one hundred and sixty worldly minds over three eons, and the supramundane mind arises, namely:

This is nothing but the aggregates;
A self never exists at all.
Through the elements, the city of the senses,
The world is ruined, to no purpose.
These twelve links of dependent origination
Are set in motion by afflictions and karma;
Arising from the seed of ignorance,
They are free of any agent and the rest.
Thus they are peaceful and most profound,
Hard for all reasoners to understand,
Free of every fault,
As the buddhas taught of old.

Lord of Secrets, even in those who abide in the supramundane mind there arises the notion, "There is something in the aggregates." When they generate freedom from attachment to the aggregates, then, since the aggregates perish like foam, like bubbles on water, like an illusion, and like a mirage, they become liberated. That is, they come to realize the sphere in which the very nature of reality is at peace, free of the aggregates, the elements, the sense sources, the apprehended and the apprehender.

Lord of Secrets, this supramundane mind, connected with the eight distinctions of mind, inverted and not inverted, and free of the net of karma and afflictions, yogins pass beyond in one eon.

Furthermore, Lord of Secrets, in those who travel by the Great Vehicle and do not rely on others, the mind of the selflessness of phenomena arises. Why is that? It is because, as they practice the conduct practiced before, when the abode of the aggregates is destroyed, they fully understand essential nature, and so the perception arises that things are like an illusion, a mirage, a reflection, an echo, a whirling firebrand, and a city of gandharvas. Therefore, Lord of Secrets, with regard to their mind, even the selflessness of phenomena is to be abandoned: one's own mind is unborn from the very beginning. Why is that? Lord of Secrets, because they fully understand essential nature, neither a prior limit nor a later limit of mind is found. This too yogins pass beyond in two eons.

Furthermore, Lord of Secrets, in bodhisattvas who practice the bodhisattva conduct by way of secret mantra, who for immeasurable hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of eons have gathered immeasurable collections of merit and wisdom, who are embraced by immeasurable wisdom and means, who are honored by the world with its gods and asuras, who have entirely surpassed all the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and who are honored by Śakra (Indra), by Brahmā the lord, by Upendra (Viṣṇu), and others, there arises the mind that is utterly without essential nature: the essential nature of emptiness, without substance, without characteristics, without signs, beyond all conceptual elaboration, immeasurable like space, the open ground of all phenomena, free of the element of the conditioned and the unconditioned, without action or deed, and free of eye, ear, nose, tongue, body, and mind. Lord of Secrets, the Victors have declared this to be the first awakening mind.

They are freed from afflictions and karma,
Yet they are also endowed with karma and afflictions.
They are worthy of the world's offerings;
They should always be worshiped and portrayed in images.

Furthermore, Lord of Secrets:

The ground of conduct through devoted interest
Is the cultivation of the three minds.
Through practicing the perfections
And the four means of gathering,

The ground of devoted interest is unequaled,
Immeasurable and inconceivable.
The arising of immeasurable wisdom
Is attained by means of the ten minds.
Whatever little I have spoken of
Is all attained through this.
Therefore the Omniscient One
Has called it devoted interest.
In a single eon the wise
Pass wholly beyond the grounds,
And by a quarter of this
They pass beyond devoted interest as well.

Then Vajrapāṇi again addressed the Blessed One:

Protector, all-pervading Lord,
Since you have taught the characteristics of mind,
How many kinds of solace must they gain
For those supreme-born ones to find solace?

When he had requested this, the Blessed One,
The Great Vairocana,
Then said to Vajrapāṇi,
"Listen to this with a collected mind."

Lord of Secrets, when childish ordinary beings abandon nonvirtuous actions and perform virtuous actions, at that time they find solace through virtue. When they fully understand the reality of the self just as it truly is, at that time they find solace by relying on the self. When, having grasped the aggregates completely and examined their own essential nature, they give up relying on a self, at that time they find solace through selflessness. When, having abandoned the aggregates, they abide in phenomena as their object, at that time they find the solace of phenomena. When, having abandoned phenomena, they abide in non-arising, at that time they find solace through the selflessness of phenomena. When the wisdom of emptiness arises, knowing that the aggregates, the elements, and all the sense sources, the apprehended and the apprehender, the self, the life principle and the rest, phenomena, and even the unborn self are without essential nature even as the essential nature of emptiness, at that time they find solace through the

sameness of the essential nature of all phenomena.

Lord of Secrets, then bodhisattvas who practice the bodhisattva conduct by way of secret mantra, by meditating on dependent origination through ten similes, will come to understand and realize the way of secret mantra. What are the ten? They should meditate on it as like an illusion, a mirage, a dream, a reflection, a city of gandharvas, an echo, the moon in water, a bubble on water, an optical illusion, and a whirling firebrand.

Lord of Secrets, bodhisattvas who practice the bodhisattva conduct by way of secret mantra should examine these one by one, as follows. What is an illusion? Through the craft of those who work with medicines and mantras, various different things are displayed, captivating to the eye and the mind, things never seen before; yet they do not go to or come from one another in the ten directions.

Why is that? Because an illusion is empty by its intrinsic nature. In the same way, everything arises from the practice of those who apply secret mantra.

Furthermore, Lord of Secrets, a mirage is empty by its intrinsic nature; yet it is designated by the conventions of perception, and it also brings about conventional activity. In the same way, this perception too is designated by convention as "secret mantra," and it also brings about conventional activity.

Furthermore, Lord of Secrets, in a dream one sees oneself remaining for a day, an instant, a moment, a year, and so on, and experiencing many kinds of happiness and suffering; yet on waking one sees nothing at all. In the same way, this way of secret mantra too should be understood to be like a dream.

Furthermore, Lord of Secrets, the arising of the accomplishments of secret mantra should be known to be like a reflection. Just as the reflection of a face arises in dependence on the face and a mirror, so too the accomplishments of secret mantra should be known to be like that.

Furthermore, Lord of Secrets, the abode of the accomplished should be regarded as like a city of gandharvas.

Furthermore, Lord of Secrets, the sound of secret mantra should be known to be like an echo. Just as an echo arises in dependence on a sound, so too this way of secret mantra should be known to be like that.

Furthermore, Lord of Secrets, when the moon has risen, one sees its reflection in water and calls it "the moon in the water." In the same way, the mantra practitioner himself, like the moon in water, is called a vidyādhara, a holder of

spells.

Furthermore, Lord of Secrets:

Just as, when rain falls,
Bubbles arise on the water,
So should the various kinds of emanation
Of one accomplished in secret mantra be understood.

Furthermore, Lord of Secrets:

There is no sentient being, no life principle,
And no agent either;
In all things, which are empty,
It is merely delusion that appears.

Furthermore, Lord of Secrets:

Just as when someone takes a firebrand
In his own hand
And whirls it, it appears as a wheel,
So too do things arise from what is empty.

Lord of Secrets, this is the ground of the Great Vehicle, the ground equal to the unequaled, the ground of certainty, the ground of the perfectly complete Buddha, the ground for gradually ascending the Great Vehicle.

One who knows this treasure of riches,
From which various wisdoms abundantly arise,
Also knows, truly and fully, just as they are,
The distinctions of the minds of all.

From The Manifest and Complete Awakening, Magical Display, and Empowerment of the Blessed Great Vairocana, this concludes the chapter on the successive distinctions of mind.

Then once again Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, the inconceivable sphere of reality, to which the Blessed One himself has fully and perfectly awakened, wholly transcends the mind. That the Blessed One has taught it to sentient beings through various means and approaches, in keeping with their dispositions and devoted interests, is truly marvelous. Blessed One, please also explain the way of secret mantra practice, the complete performance of the great king of maṇḍalas called Arising from the Essence of Great Compassion. In the future it will bring

benefit, help, and happiness to many sentient beings."

Then the Blessed One Vairocana looked upon the maṇḍala of the entire assembly and said to Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets: "Vajrapāṇi, listen to this Dharma discourse teaching the way of conduct of the maṇḍala, which brings to completion the wisdom of omniscience."

Then the Blessed One Vairocana, his intention concerning the sphere of reality not yet fulfilled, and having made the vow to liberate the whole realm of sentient beings without exception, conferred together with all the tathāgatas and entered into equipoise in the samādhi called Arising from the Essence of Great Compassion. As soon as the Blessed One had entered equipoise, from all the limbs of his body there emerged tathāgata bodies that performed beneficial deeds for sentient beings, from the first generation of the mind up to the tenth ground. Having emerged, they circled throughout the ten directions, returned, and entered their own places within the Blessed One's body.

Then once again the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, listen to the arrangement of the maṇḍala. First of all, the master should be one whose mind has entered into the awakening mind; endowed with wisdom; steadfast and compassionate; skilled in the arts; always skilled in the way of the perfection of wisdom; knowing the distinctions of the three vehicles; skilled in the meaning of the reality of secret mantra; knowing the dispositions of others; having faith in the buddhas and bodhisattvas; and authorized and empowered to perform the work of drawing the maṇḍala.

Of noble family, in the practice of secret mantra
Diligently striving, and having ascertained it,
Skilled in the rites and resolute,
He abides in the awakening mind.

Lord of Secrets, such a master is a child of the Victors, highly praised by the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Lord of Secrets, whether others make the request to the master, or whether he does so of himself:

Having seen sentient beings
Who are fit vessels and free of faults,
Of great devotion, steadfast and faithful,
Delighting in benefiting others,

And recognizing such a disciple,
The master himself
Should summon him unasked
And, wishing to benefit him, speak thus:
"Since you are a vessel of the great way,
Come here, my son! The rite
Of the way of secret mantra practice
Of the Great Vehicle I shall truly teach you.
The perfect buddhas who have passed,
Likewise those who have not yet come,
And the protectors who have now appeared,
Who abide for the benefit of beings,
All of them, knowing this supreme
And excellent rite of secret mantra,
As heroes at the foot of the tree of awakening
Attained signless omniscience.
The practice of secret mantra is unequaled:
Through it the protector Śākyasiṃha
Vanquished the utterly terrible hosts of Māra,
Mighty armies though they were.
Therefore, to attain omniscience,
My son, make this your resolve."
With a mind suffused with compassion,
He should thus praise and encourage him many times.
Knowing the disciple to be steadfast,
He should carefully examine the ground.

Mountains with flowers and fruit,
Clean and pleasing places by water,
These are praised by all the buddhas
For the work of drawing the maṇḍala.
Where there are many flowing rivers
Adorned with geese and swans,
There the intelligent mantra practitioner
Should draw the maṇḍala Arising from Compassion.
The places frequented by the buddhas,
By the self-arisen protectors,

And likewise by the śrāvakas of the Victor
Are ever praised by the Sage.
In various other places,
Temples and fine monastic parks,
Houses and delightful upper chambers,
Ponds and beautiful gardens,
Stūpas, monastic quarters, cowsheds,
The confluences of rivers,
All the abodes of the gods,
And likewise empty houses as well,
Wishing to benefit the disciples,
He should diligently draw the maṇḍala.
Or else he may draw it
On any pleasing ground whatsoever.

Lord of Secrets, the ground to be used should be without stones, rubble, potsherds, or gravel; cleared of hair, chaff, charcoal, ashes, thorns, bones, rotten wood, and splinters; without ants, worms, or other creatures; and rid of every fault. Such a place is most auspicious for the gods.

Then, on a day endowed with the signs of an excellent lunar date, constellation, planet, karaṇa, and moment, in the morning, marked by good omens, one should pay homage to all the tathāgatas and proclaim two verses addressing the earth goddess, Pṛthivī:

"Of the distinctive way of conduct
Of all the protecting buddhas,
Of their grounds and their perfections,
Goddess, you have been the witness.
Just as the protector Śākyasiṃha
Vanquished the hosts of Māra,
So shall I be victorious
Over Māra, and I draw the maṇḍala."

Touching the ground with the hand
And addressing her thus many times,
Placing both knees upon the ground,
One should make offering with flowers and incense.
Having made offering, the mantra practitioner

Should then bow to the tathāgatas,
And then, by means of these rites,
The wise one should purify the ground.

Then Vajrapāṇi touched his head to the feet of the Blessed One and addressed the Blessed One thus:

"The Buddha is without signs
And abides in the body of Dharma.
Since you teach the Dharma that is unequaled,
Signless and unconditioned,
Why, O great hero,
Do you teach this rite endowed with signs,
The practice of secret mantra?
This is not the way of the nature of reality."

When he had requested this, the Blessed One,
The Great Vairocana,
Then said to Vajrapāṇi,
"Listen to this characteristic of Dharma.
Dharma is free of conceptualization;
It is the abandonment of all conceptual thought.
In it the conceptions of mind
And mental factors are entirely abandoned.
The Dharma to which I fully awakened
Has arisen from space;
Childish beings, whose domain
Is wrong conception, do not know it.
Those obscured by darkness
Accept place, time, signs, and the like;
In order to take them in,
This rite too is spoken.
There is no place and no time,
No deed and no doer either;
In all phenomena there is nothing whatsoever:
Phenomena are merely partial.
Nevertheless, Lord of Secrets,
In the future there will appear
Sentient beings of feeble intellect,

Deluded by mere activity,
Attached to the objects of things.
Not knowing a way such as this,
Through place, time, and deed,
And through signs of virtue and nonvirtue,
The deluded seek results.
For their sake, great being,
This rite is spoken."

Lord of Secrets, in whichever of the places described, the ground should be firmly tamped and smeared with cow dung that has not fallen to the earth, mixed with cow urine. Then one should sprinkle it for purification with this mantra and consecrate it:

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ apratisame gagana samatānugate prakṛti viśuddhe dharmma dhātu viśodhani svāhā

After that the mantra practitioner
Should rise and imagine me in its center,
Seated upon a white lotus seat,
Wearing a topknot and a crown,
Encircled on every side
By light rays of various colors.
Then the intelligent one should imagine
Four perfect buddhas in the directions.
The Tathāgata Ratnaketu
He should imagine like the rising sun.
In the south is the heroic Victor
Called Saṃkusumita,
Blazing with a golden color,
Abiding in the samādhi that vanquishes faults.
In the north is Akṣobhya,
Abiding in the samādhi free of sickness.
In the west is Amitābha.
Having imagined these five Victors,
The mantra practitioner, then
Remaining in the Victors' place at the center,
Should take possession of the ground
With the secret mantra, accomplishing all aims,

Of Acala, the great being,
Or else of Trailokyavijaya.
In the center, excellent maṇḍalas
Are to be made with sandalwood:
The first one is mine;
The second is that of all the protectors.

The third, to be made equal to it,
Is without doubt that of the Mother.
The fourth is that of Padmapāṇi,
The fifth is for Vajrapāṇi,
The sixth is that of the protector Acala;
And further, below, these should be well made.
Recollecting the tathāgatas,
Offering flowers, incense, and the like,
Composed in meditation, with reverence,
One should speak these words:
"Protectors, whose nature is compassion,
All of you, please heed me.
Tomorrow, when midday has passed,
Together with your heirs, take possession of this ground."
Having spoken these words,
One should recite this secret mantra:

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ sarbba tathāgatādhiṣṭhānādhiṣṭhate acale vimale smaraṇe prakṛti pariśuddhe svāhā

Then the mantra practitioner should rise,
And with a mind suffused with compassion,
Remaining on the western side,
His inner self thoroughly purified,
Should set his mind on awakening
And lie down in that very place.
Then the mantra practitioner should watch for a dream.
He may see a bodhisattva of great renown,
Or else a buddha, a blessed one,
For the sake of benefiting sentient beings,
Exerting himself with every effort
In the tasks of drawing the maṇḍala;

Or he may see one encouraging him,
Saying to him, "Great being,
My son, well done! Draw the maṇḍala quickly!"
Then on the following day,
Disciples who are faithful and of noble family,
Likewise having faith in the Three Jewels,
Endowed with profound intelligence,
Of great enthusiasm and moral discipline,
Patient and free of avarice,
Courageous and firm in their commitments,
Ten, or eight, or seven, or five,
One, two, or four, or even more,
Should be accepted without the need for examination.

Then once again Vajrapāṇi asked the Blessed One, "Blessed One, what is the name of this maṇḍala? Why is it called a maṇḍala?"

The Blessed One said, "Lord of Secrets, this maṇḍala is the source of the buddhas. Its center is called the essence, and its circle is completeness: since there is no other essence beyond it, it is therefore called a maṇḍala. Nevertheless, Lord of Secrets, this extensive maṇḍala, because it fully protects the indeterminate realm of sentient beings, is called Arising from the Essence of Great Compassion. It has been empowered by the tathāgatas, who accomplished unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening over countless eons. Therefore, Lord of Secrets, by this explanation as well, you should understand it thus: the tathāgatas do not fully and perfectly awaken for the sake of one sentient being, nor for the sake of two, nor for the sake of three. Rather, under the sway of great compassion, they fully and perfectly awaken in order to protect the entire realm of sentient beings without exception, and they teach the Dharma to sentient beings in accordance with the dispositions of the many kinds of beings.

"Lord of Secrets, when those who have not grown accustomed to the Great Vehicle see or hear of the way of secret mantra practice, not even a little joy or faith truly arises in their minds. Lord of Secrets, those who have in the past grown accustomed to accomplishing the infinite gateways of the way of practice of the secret mantra of the Great Vehicle are Vajrasattvas, and it is for their sake that this limit on numbers was set. Nevertheless, the master who is endowed with great compassion should simply vow to liberate the entire realm

of sentient beings without exception, and therefore he should accept limitless sentient beings, so that it may become the cause of the awakening mind.

"Then, having summoned them, he should have them go for refuge to the Three, and also instruct them not to commit evil deeds. Then he should give them incense, flowers, and so on, and have them also take up the vow of wisdom that is unobstructed in the three times.

Having had them take it up, the mantra practitioner
Should then give them tooth-sticks as well.
Single-pointed and composed,
Facing east or north,
They should chew the tooth-sticks
Of udumbara or aśvattha,
Of very good quality, well protected,
And anointed with flowers, scents, and the like.
Whether a being is a fit vessel or not a fit vessel
Is to be examined from how the stick is thrown.
Then upon the left hand
A thread with three knots
Should be tied well
By him, composed in meditation.
To the disciples thus accepted,
Who are without fault,
In order to make their resolve firm,
He should arouse their enthusiasm thus:
"Great beings, you have today
Obtained an unequaled gain,
Because all the Victors with their heirs,
All the great beings,
Have accepted all of you
Into this teaching, and you are being born.
Therefore tomorrow you will be
Truly born into the Great Vehicle.
If in your dreams you see
Temples and fine monastic parks,
Various fine houses,
And likewise upper chambers,
Swords and wish-fulfilling jewels,

Parasols and various flowers,
Fine women dressed in white,
Dear kinsmen and children,
Volumes of scripture, likewise brahmins,
Buddhas and pratyekabuddhas,
Likewise the śrāvakas of the Victor,
And bodhisattvas, great beings;
If you see fruits being obtained,
Or lakes and oceans being crossed;
And likewise if from the sky
Auspicious and pleasing words resound
That the desired fruit will come about,
Such dreams as these
Are to be considered good.
The wise should know dreams
Contrary to these to be bad.
You of excellent discipline,
In the morning tell me everything."
Having instructed those disciples thus,
He should also explain the Dharma:
"This supreme path, from which
The Great Vehicle greatly arises, is glorious.
By having gone upon it, you,
Self-arisen and of great fortune,
Will become tathāgatas,
Knowers of the whole world.
Beyond existence and nonexistence,
Stainless like space,
Profound, never realized
By any reasoning, without abode,
Free of all elaboration,
Yet elaborated through elaborations,
Free of action, deed, and the like,
Abiding in the two truths:
This supreme among excellent vehicles
Is attained if one abides in its way."

Then the Vajra Holder, abiding without elaboration, addressed the Blessed One thus:

"Blessed One, please explain the vow of wisdom unobstructed in the three times, abiding in which bodhisattvas will please the buddhas and bodhisattvas."

When he had made this request, the Blessed One said to the Vajra Holder, who abides without elaboration: "Son of noble family, listen to the vow in which body, speech, and mind engage as one, and which is without undertaking and without activity toward any phenomenon. What is it? It is the complete giving up of one's own body to the buddhas and bodhisattvas. Why is that? Whoever gives up his own body has given up three things. And what are the three things given up? They are body, speech, and mind. Therefore, son of noble family, a bodhisattva should be restrained by the vow of the three, body, speech, and mind. Why is that? Because bodhisattvas do not uphold the training without having fully given up body, speech, and mind."

Then on the following day, having paid homage to the Blessed One Vairocana and empowered himself as Vajrasattva, the wise one should take a vase filled with scented water, consecrate it with the mantra of Trailokyavijaya, place it at the first gate, and with it sprinkle all the people for purification. Then, to purify their minds, he should have them drink pure scented water.

Then Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One thus:

"When the masters of the maṇḍala
Strive to accomplish secret mantra,
At what time in the maṇḍala
Does the great being bestow his blessing?
The time and the measure, O Omniscient One,
Supreme among speakers, please declare."
When he had asked this, the Blessed One
Said to the Vajra Holder:
"For one who undertakes the maṇḍala,
The cord should always be stretched at night."

The second section.

Vajrapāṇi, that master, having paid homage to all the buddhas, should take up a cord of various colors and empower himself as the Blessed One Vairocana.

Stretching the cord toward the east,
He should hold it level with the navel,
Holding it in the air.
Then, having gone to the south,
He should stretch it toward the north.
Then a second cord
He should take up himself, and in that very place,
Recollecting the tathāgatas
And facing east, he should stretch it.
Then, having gone to the south,
He should stretch it toward the north.
Then the intelligent one should return,
And standing in the direction of Nairṛti,
He should stretch it toward the north.
Then he should turn to the right,
And having turned, remaining there,
He should stretch it toward the south.
Then, leaving that place
And standing in the direction of Agni,
The mantra practitioner, abiding in the rite of secret mantra,
Should stretch the cord toward the east.
Then likewise, going to the direction of Īśāna
And facing west,
As far as the direction of Vāyu
He should stretch it on the north.
In this way the mantra practitioner
Should make it square and even all around.
Then, entering the center,
He should divide it into three parts.
Having divided all the ground
Everywhere into three parts,
He should again divide
Each of the parts into three.
One part is to be made
The path for circumambulation;
The remaining two parts
Are to be fixed as the places of the deities.
The intelligent one, in the four directions,

In each direction's portion, the gateway enclosures;
The one who strives in restraint should diligently
Make the places of the chief deities.
When, well divided in sequence,
All these have been made,
In the center is the supreme white lotus,
Which is proclaimed to be the essence.
All the maṇḍalas arising from the essence
Are thereby made to possess an essence.
Its measure is said to be
Sixteen finger-widths and upward.
Eight-petaled, perfectly complete,
With anthers, most excellent;
Between all the petals,
Vajras should be drawn all around.
In the center of its heart,
The supreme Victor, the chief, golden in color,
With blazing topknot and crown,
Encircled on all sides by rays of light,
The protector free of sickness,
Should be drawn abiding in samādhi.
To its east the intelligent one
Should draw, with great care,
The mudrā of the buddhas,
A triangle, entirely pure white,
Upon a lotus, surrounded all around,
Encircled by white rays of light.
To its north the wise
Should draw the Mother of all the protectors,
Golden in color and blazing,
Wearing white garments,
Illuminating everything,
Abiding in samādhi.
On the northern side of the protector,
The hero, the lord Avalokiteśvara,
Seated on a white lotus seat,
Like a conch, a kunda flower, or the moon,

With Amitābha seated upon his head,
His face gently smiling, should be drawn.
To his right, the goddess
Tārā, of great renown,
Virtuous, the dispeller of fear,
Blue-green, of various forms,
With the build of a young woman,
Palms joined, holding an utpala flower,
Encircled all around by rays of light,
Wearing white garments, should be drawn.
To his left, the goddess Bhṛkuṭī,
Holding in her hand the rosary of that mantra,
Three-eyed and with a topknot,
White in color,
Encircled by rays of white,
Yellow, and red, should be drawn.
Close to Bhṛkuṭī
Is the one of great might, holding a lotus,
Of great love, clad in white,
Encircled by rays of light:
The hero should be drawn exactly so,
And his lotus is not yet opened.
Near him the intelligent one
Should draw the vidyā goddess Yaśovatī,
Like gold in color,
Adorned with every ornament,
Holding in her left hand
A lovely sprig of priyaṅgu.
In the retinue of Tārā
The intelligent one should draw Pāṇḍaravāsinī,
With a topknot, wearing white garments,
Holding a lotus in her hand.
Below him the mantra practitioner
Should draw the vidyā king of great strength,
Colored like the rising sun,
Adorned with a white lotus,
With a garland of flames, unbearable,

His hair standing like a lion's mane,
Renowned as Hayagrīva,
Of the wise lord Avalokiteśvara.
To the south of the buddhas' mudrā,
The mudrā of the protecting bodhisattvas,
Renowned as the wish-fulfilling jewel,
Of great fortune,
Fulfilling every hope,
Should be drawn resting on a white lotus.
To the south of the protector, the Great Vairocana,
Is the Vajra Holder,
Who fulfills every hope,
His color like priyaṅgu,
Greenish yellow, or like an emerald,

Light blue, the protector wearing a crown,
The great being, adorned
With every ornament, with vajras
Vast in reach, extending without end,
Should be drawn encircled by rays of light.
To his right, the goddess by name
Called Māmakī,
Adorned with vajra ornaments,
Should be drawn holding a vajra in her hand.
Below her, the goddess
Vajra Point, of great strength,
Surrounded on all sides by messengers,
Her face faintly smiling, should be drawn.
On the left the mantra practitioner
Should draw the one called Vajra Chain (Vajraśṛṅkhalā),
Vajrapāṇi's Vajra Chain,
Surrounded by her own messengers,
Greenish yellow in color like priyaṅgu,
Well marked with the sign of the vajra.
Below Vajrapāṇi
Is the one called Krodhacandra, the Lord,
Who pacifies the great obstructors, the enemies,

The wrathful one renowned throughout the three worlds,
Three-eyed and with four fangs,
His color like a summer rain cloud,
Letting out a sound of fierce laughter,
Adorned with vajra ornaments;
His retinue, surrounding him on all sides,
Are the boundless lords of the wrathful ones;
With a hundred thousand arms
He holds and brandishes various weapons.
Such a great wrathful one
Should be drawn seated upon a lotus.
Going to the west of him,
Many vajra holders,
Holding various weapons in their hands,
Of various colors and of great strength,
Encircled by rays of light,
Should be drawn working for the benefit of all sentient beings.
Below the protector of secret mantra,
In the quarter of Nairṛti, the southwest,
Is the one called Acala, who in his hands
Firmly holds a sword and a noose,
A lock of hair hanging to the left of the crown of his head,
Richly adorned, with one eye squinting,
Abiding within his own light,
Wrathful, seated on a rock,
His face deeply furrowed in wrath,
With the form of a youth, sturdy of build.
Having drawn him, the wise one
Goes to the quarter of Vāyu, the northwest,
And there the Blessed One's
Wrathful one, Trailokyavijaya,
With a garland of flames, unbearable,
The foremost attendant and ornament of Vajrapāṇi,
Seated as though receiving his command,
Abiding like the time of the world's ending,
Should be drawn with diligence.
Thus the drawing of the inner area

Has been explained in full.
Then the mantra practitioner, coming outward,
In the second section,
Within the eastern quarter,
Dividing it into two parts,
Inside the gateway enclosure,
The mantra practitioner should draw the Victor Śākyamuni,
Golden in color and blazing,
Endowed with the thirty-two supreme marks,
The protector clad in saffron robes,
The all-pervading lord who accomplishes the aim of the teaching,
Seated on a white lotus seat;
He should be drawn seated in the manner of teaching the Dharma.
To his right is the goddess
Called Buddhalocanā,
The goddess with a gently smiling face,
With a maṇḍala of light a fathom wide,
Her matchless body utterly serene;
She is the Mother of Śākyamuni.
To her right is the goddess
Renowned as the vidyā Ūrṇā,
Seated upon a lotus,
Her color like a conch, the moon, or kunda jasmine,
Holding a wish-fulfilling jewel in her hand;
She should be drawn bringing every hope to fulfillment.
Then the mantra practitioner, on the left,
Should properly draw the five uṣṇīṣas
Of Śākyasiṃha, the protector,
Radiant and of great diligence:
White Parasol (Sitātapatra), the Victor's Crown (Jaya),
Vijayoṣṇīṣa itself,
Tejorāśi of great fortune,
And the one widely renowned as Vikiraṇa.
These five uṣṇīṣas
Of the mighty Crest of the Śākyas
Should be drawn with close attention,
Each in its own of five places.

Going to the north of these,
One should draw the gods of the Pure Abodes:
Īśvara, Samantakusuma,
Garland of Light,
Manojava, and Far-Renowned;
All of these should be well drawn.
To the right of Ūrṇā,
The Great Uṣṇīṣa, Greatly Arising,
Likewise Upward Arising,
And Anantasvaraghoṣa:
These three uṣṇīṣas alone
Should be properly drawn with close attention.
The five uṣṇīṣas of great power
Should be made white, pale yellow, and yellow;
The other three should be made
White, yellow, and red.
All of them have many rays of light,
And are adorned with every ornament;
Their aspirations are of great power,
Bringing every hope to fulfillment.

Then the mantra practitioner, in the quarter of Agni, the southeast,
Should draw Agni together with the great sages,
Seated within fire,
Marked with three finger-lines of ash,
The hero entirely deep red,
His heart marked with a triangle,
Seated in the midst of blazing flames,
Holding a rosary and a water pot.
Then, in the southern quarter,
Yama, the lord, holding in his hand
A staff, and riding a buffalo,
His color like a summer rain cloud,
Should be drawn surrounded by the mātṛkās, by Kālarātri,
And by the lords of death.
In the quarter of Nairṛti, Nairṛti,
Terrifying, with a sword in his hand, should be drawn.

Then, too, the wise one,
Going swiftly to the northern quarter,
Should draw the king of the gods (Indra),
Seated on Mount Meru and surrounded by gods,
Holding a vajra in his hand, wearing a diadem,
And adorned with every ornament.
Then, to his east,
Varuṇa should be drawn holding a noose in his hand.
Further east of him again,
The Sun should be drawn seated on a chariot.
To his right and to his left
Jaya and Vijaya should be drawn.
To his right, Brahmā,
Four-faced, wearing a topknot,
Devoted to the syllable called oṃ,
Should be drawn seated upon a goose and a lotus.
To the west of him, one should draw
Pṛthivī, the earth goddess, and Sarasvatī,
Viṣṇu, Skanda, and likewise Vāyu,
Śaṅkara, and likewise the Moon;
Placing them in the western quarter,
One should draw them with great care.
Having drawn these, the mantra practitioner then,
With mind free of confusion,
Below the protector of secret mantra,
Should draw the great wrathful one called Aparājita,
And the goddess
Aparājitā,
And the lord of the earth, holding a vase in his hand,
Properly placed, in an attitude of reverence.
The great nāgas Nanda and Upananda
Should be drawn with great care
At the two doorways of Śākyasiṃha, the protector,
Facing outward.
Moreover, whatever mantras and mudrās
Are taught for the maṇḍala
In all the tantras of Śākyamuni,

Those, too, the learned one should draw.
The mantra practitioner then, coming outward,
In the third section, as prescribed,
Should draw the Giver of the Supreme Vajra,
Whose color is like saffron,
With five locks of hair on the crown of his head,
Having the form of a young boy,
Holding in his left hand
A blue utpala bearing a vajra,
Seated on a white lotus seat,
Abiding with a broadly smiling face;
The mantra practitioner should draw him
Encircled all around by rays of excellent character.
To the north of him, the youth
Jālinīprabha, holding in his hand
A net of jewels,
Adorned with ornaments of many kinds,
Seated on a red lotus seat,
Should be drawn gazing at the Victor's son.
To the left of the Giver of the Supreme Vajra
Five female messengers should be drawn:
Keśinī and Upakeśinī,
Citrā and Vasumatī,
And likewise the one called Ākarṣaṇī;
These are the wise female messengers.
Just below them
The five female servants
And the two attendants
Of the youth Jālinīprabha should also be drawn.
Then the mantra practitioner, in the southern quarter,
Should draw the bodhisattva of great renown,
The lord Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin,
Holding a wish-fulfilling jewel.
Leaving two spaces beside him,
The learned one should draw these eight:
The Wondrous Hero,
Sarvasattvābhayaṃdada, giver of fearlessness to all beings,

Sarvāpāyajaha, who abandons all lower realms,
Likewise Paritrāṇāśayamati, of protecting intent,
The wise Karuṇāmṛdita, tender with compassion,
Maitryabhyudgata, in whom loving-kindness arises,
Sarvadāhapraśamin, who quells all burning torment,
And likewise Acintyamati, of inconceivable intelligence.
Going to the northern quarter,
One should draw Kṣitigarbha, blazing,
Perfect in patience and gentleness.
His seat, the learned one should make
Endowed with every source of treasure,
Adorned with all kinds of jewels;
Upon it, a lotus of four jewels,
Properly placed,
Should be imagined, delightful to the mind;
The bodhisattva of great renown
Should be drawn seated upon it.
His retinue, foremost in good qualities,
Is infinite, utterly beyond count;
Among them are the bodhisattvas
Ratnākara, Ratnapāṇi,
Dharaṇiṃdhara, and
Ratnamudrāhasta,
And Dṛḍhādhyāśaya, of steadfast resolve:
These of great renown should be drawn.
Likewise, the mantra practitioner, in the western quarter,
Should imagine the hero Ākāśagarbha,
Of great splendor, clad in white garments,
Holding a sword in his hand;
The Victor's son should be drawn
Well seated upon a lotus seat.
In the retinue of that great being
The renowned ones should also be drawn.
His retinue, the great heroes,
Are Gaganāmala and Gaganamati,
Viśuddhamati,
Cāritramati,

And the one called Sthiramati.
They should be drawn with great care,
And one should always contemplate them
Together with these heroes, in their proper order.

Then the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, having looked at the entire assembly, gazed at the Blessed One Vairocana for a long while without blinking, and spoke forth this inspired utterance in these words:

"In the world, the omniscient ones,
Like the udumbara flower,
Arise only rarely, once in a hundred times,
And at times do not arise at all.
The way of conduct of secret mantra appearing
Is rarer even than that.
Whatever evil has been committed
Over many tens of millions of eons,
All of it is purified
By seeing a maṇḍala such as this;
What need, then, to mention one who abides
In the way of mantra conduct, of boundless renown?
If one recites the protector's secret mantra,
One will reach the unsurpassed state.
Those whose intelligence
Is utterly unwavering in this supreme conduct
Cut off completely the stream of the lower realms,
Suffering and its origin."

At that time that entire assembly and those vajra holders spoke with one voice, in unison:

"Master of the conduct of secret mantra,
Great hero, excellent, excellent!
Whatever you have in mind,
Ask of the peerless Omniscient One.
The other bodhisattvas
Who fully understand the mantra tantra,
And all of us who abide in the fruit of mantra practice,
Shall thereby gain mastery."

Then again Vajrapāṇi spoke thus to the Blessed One:

"What is it that is called color?
Why is this called color?
How should the colors be laid out?
Which should be applied first?
The porticoes, and likewise
The measure of the gateway enclosures,
And how the measure of the gates should be made,
May the Protector please explain.
The food offerings, flowers, unguents, and incense,
And the vases too, please teach in full:
How the disciple is to be led in,
And how he is to be empowered,
The offering of the fee to the master,
And the place of the fire offering, please tell me.
What is the characteristic of secret mantra?
What is it that is held to be samādhi?"

When he had asked this, the Blessed One,
The Sage, lord of all dharmas,
Spoke thus to the Vajra Holder:
"Listen here with a single-pointed mind!
The supreme way of the conduct of secret mantra,
From which the fruit of the Great Vehicle arises,
Whatever you, great being,
Have asked, I shall explain.
The realm of sentient beings clings to it,
And that it is the flavor of the dharmadhātu
The buddhas taught of old;
Therefore it is called color.
The colors should be laid out from within;
The colors are not laid out from outside.
White should be applied first;
After it, red;
Then yellow should be applied;
After that, green is applied;
The innermost of all is black.
Thus is the rite of the colors explained.

The measure of the porticoes, too,
Is equal to the central maṇḍala;
The gateway enclosures also equal it.
The lotus is said to be sixteen finger-widths.
The first gate is said to be
Equal to the maṇḍala of the heart.
Increasing them in succession, O fearless one,
Know the others to be larger than that.
Between the gates
The gatekeepers should be placed.
Samādhi, in brief, is said to be
The mind's perfect contentment.
Great being, as to its distinctions,
Gather your mind to a single point and listen.
The samādhi of all the buddhas
The Victor has called emptiness.
It is attained from fully knowing the mind,
And not from anything else.
Having abandoned all those others,
It is held to be that of the perfect buddhas.
It is called the great emptiness,
That which perfects the gnosis of omniscience.
Therefore, in every respect,
One should always keep emptiness in mind."

Then the Blessed One Vairocana, having conferred together with all the buddhas, taught the samādhis of the śrāvakas, the pratyekabuddhas, and the bodhisattvas, each in its own manner. At that time he also entered into equipoise in the samādhi called the Force of the Power of Being of One Continuum with All Buddhas. Then again the Blessed One spoke to the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi:

"Having sat at the seat of awakening,
Because I had vanquished the four kinds of māras,
Then the hosts of gods, Brahmā and the rest,
Joyfully proclaimed
The sound of freedom from all fear,
Calling me 'Great Hero.'

From then on I, the hero,
Have been renowned as the Great Hero.
The unborn that I realized
Has left behind the domains of words,
Is free of every fault,
And is free of causes and conditions.
The gnosis of emptiness, like space,
Free of all darkness,
Utterly stainless, reality itself,
Just as it is, came forth from me.
To abide in the mode of sheer omniscience
Is the defining mark of an omniscient buddha.
This supreme reality of mine
Illuminates the world;
By the power of blessing,
Having shown it in the form of syllables,
Out of compassion for sentient beings
I have explained everything in full."

Then the glorious Vajra Holder,
Filled with wonder, his eyes wide open,
Bowed his head to the Omniscient One
And spoke these words:
"The skillful means of all the buddhas
And their inconceivable wisdom are greatly wondrous!
Having realized the Dharma
Free from all elaboration, the self-arisen ones
Teach what brings to complete fulfillment
Every hope of the whole world.
If any being knows
Such a characteristic of secret mantra,
Abiding well in the two truths,
He becomes an object of worship for the whole world."

Then the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, having spoken these verses, gazed at the Blessed One Vairocana with an unblinking gaze and remained silent. Then the Blessed One spoke thus to the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi: "Moreover, Lord of Secrets, the way of samādhi of the bodhisattvas bound to one more birth, who

abide on the ground of a buddha, is this:

Free from doubt,
Having understood the characteristics of the world,
Those who abide on the ground of the purpose
Abide on the ground of a buddha.

"Moreover, Lord of Secrets, the way of samādhi of the bodhisattvas who are lords of the eighth ground is this:

Not apprehending any phenomena at all,
Having abandoned becoming and birth,
Knowing the world to be like an illusion,
The world holds them to be masters of the world.

"Moreover, Lord of Secrets, the śrāvakas who abide on the ground that has an object, having understood arising and perishing, demolish the two extremes, and because they do not apprehend a cause, they do not engage in the wisdom of utter nonentity. This is the way of samādhi of the śrāvakas.

"Lord of Secrets, the pratyekabuddhas, having demolished cause and effect, abide in the way of the inexpressible Dharma and enter the wisdom that thinks, 'All phenomena are inexpressible.' This full understanding of the samādhi of the complete cessation of speech is the way of samādhi of the pratyekabuddhas.

"Moreover, Lord of Secrets, worldly people conceive of results arising from causes and of things arising from karma or ceasing, and through dependence on others a samādhi of emptiness arises in them. This is the way of samādhi of worldly people.

"Lord of Secrets, this is the way of samādhi.
Abiding in it, the buddhas and the pratyekabuddhas,
The protecting bodhisattvas,
And those gentle śrāvakas
Who are renowned as vanquishers of evil,
And whatever worldly gods there are:
Wishing to benefit sentient beings,
The hero then teaches
The way of the rite of the practice of secret mantra."

Then again the Blessed One spoke to the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi: "Lord of Secrets, listen to the characteristics of the secret mantras." He replied,

"Blessed One, I shall do so," and listened to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One said this:

"Lord of Secrets, here,
The secret mantras of the perfect buddhas
Are marked by words, names, and conventional signs.
Because one has gained mastery of those words,
They accomplish every aim of secret mantra.
Some are endowed with words of exhortation;
Some state their own name first.
Those endowed with hūṃ and phaṭ
Are proclaimed to be those of the uṣṇīṣas.
Those that say 'Seize! Devour! Crush!'
And 'Strike! Kill! Liberate!'
The Guide has declared to be the secret mantras
Of the servants and of the wrathful ones.
Those endowed with namaḥ svāhā and the like,
Marked by the realization of samādhi,
With peaceful, thoroughly pure syllables,
Fulfilling every hope,
Are the secret mantras of all the buddhas
And of the protecting bodhisattvas.
The secret mantras of the śrāvakas
Are single, resting on a single basis;
Those of the pratyekabuddhas are likewise.
If their distinction is to be explained,
By the distinction of their samādhi
It is called the purification of karmic life.

"Moreover, Lord of Secrets, as for the characteristic of the secret mantras, they were not made by all the buddhas, nor did the buddhas cause them to be made, nor did they rejoice in their making. Why is that? Because this is the nature of reality of phenomena. Thus, whether tathāgatas appear or do not appear, this nature of reality of phenomena abides from the very beginning; and in the same way this is the secret-mantra nature of reality of the secret mantras.

"Lord of Secrets, whenever a perfectly complete buddha, omniscient and all-seeing, appears in the world, at that time, through various methods and various intentions, for sentient beings of various dispositions, he blesses that

nature of reality into various words: into various syllables, various expressions in the usage of particular regions, and various sounds that can be understood. Thus he teaches the way of secret mantra.

"How is it that the tathāgatas bless the way of secret mantra into syllables? Lord of Secrets, whatever words of truth the tathāgatas fully accomplished over many hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of eons: the four noble truths, the four applications of mindfulness, the four bases of miraculous power, the ten powers of a tathāgata, the six perfections, the seven precious factors of awakening, the four abodes of Brahmā, and the eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha; Lord of Secrets, in brief, whatever is the gnosis of omniscience of the tathāgatas, all of it, having been blessed through the tathāgatas' own power of merit and gnosis, the power of knowing their former aspirations, and the power of the blessing of the dharmadhātu, they fully and properly teach the rite of secret mantra to sentient beings in accordance with their fortune.

"And what is that rite of secret mantra?
a is the gateway to all phenomena, because they are unborn from the very beginning.
ka is the gateway to all phenomena, because they are free from intention.
kha is the gateway to all phenomena, because, like space, they cannot be apprehended.
ga is the gateway to all phenomena, because no going whatever can be apprehended.
gha is the gateway to all phenomena, because utter ruin cannot be apprehended.
ca is the gateway to all phenomena, because they are free from all death and transmigration.
cha is the gateway to all phenomena, because they are like all shadows.
ja is the gateway to all phenomena, because birth cannot be apprehended.
jha is the gateway to all phenomena, because stain cannot be apprehended.
ṭa is the gateway to all phenomena, because pride cannot be apprehended.
ṭha is the gateway to all phenomena, because producing cannot be apprehended.
ḍa is the gateway to all phenomena, because disturbance cannot be apprehended.
ḍha is the gateway to all phenomena, because they are completely free from deception.

ta is the gateway to all phenomena, because suchness cannot be apprehended.
tha is the gateway to all phenomena, because a place cannot be apprehended.
da is the gateway to all phenomena, because discipline cannot be apprehended.
dha is the gateway to all phenomena, because the element cannot be apprehended.
pa is the gateway to all phenomena, because the ultimate truth cannot be apprehended.
pha is the gateway to all phenomena, because, like a bubble, they are without core.
ba is the gateway to all phenomena, because they are free from the path of speech.
bha is the gateway to all phenomena, because no existence whatever can be apprehended.
ma is the gateway to all phenomena, because death cannot be apprehended.
ya is the gateway to all phenomena, because no vehicle whatever can be apprehended.
ra is the gateway to all phenomena, because they are free from all dust.
la is the gateway to all phenomena, because characteristics are not apprehended.
ṣa is the gateway to all phenomena, because they are peaceful by nature.
ṣa is the gateway to all phenomena, because they are dull by nature.
sa is the gateway to all phenomena, because no truth whatever can be apprehended.
ha is the gateway to all phenomena, because a cause cannot be apprehended.

"Lord of Secrets, ṇa, ña, ṇa, na, and ma hold sway over all samādhis. They possess every power, and they swiftly accomplish whatever aims are needed.

"Lord of Secrets, this gateway of samādhi, the way of secret mantra, brings every hope to complete fulfillment. It is the inconceivable fruit of the ripening of all the tathāgatas, endowed with the supreme of all aspects, the definitive meaning of the reality of secret mantra, utterly transcending the three times, and stainless like space.

It abides on the ground of inconceivable mind,
And arises from actions and deeds.
Having attained the ground of conduct,

It bestows inconceivable fruit.
This is the supreme reality,
Fully taught by all the buddhas.
Knowing this rite of secret mantra,
The mantra practitioner will gain accomplishment.
What is called sound is the supreme reality,
The mark of the secret mantras.
If the mantra practitioner holds it in mind,
He will attain the state beyond death and transmigration."

Then the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, it is wondrous that the Blessed One has taught this inconceivable discourse on the way of the characteristics of secret mantra. It is not shared with any śrāvakas or pratyekabuddhas. Blessed One, those sentient beings who have faith in this way of secret mantra will also come to possess qualities that are not shared. Blessed One, please explain further the rite of the requisites of the maṇḍala."

When he had made this request, the Blessed One spoke thus to the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi:

"Then that mantra practitioner,
With yellow, white, and red flowers,
Pleasing ones, should diligently
Make offerings to the deities.
Lotus, or else utpala,
Nāgakesara, punnāga,
Campaka, aśoka, tilaka,
Pāṭala, or even śāla:
Flowers such as these,
Pleasing and lovely to behold,
And auspicious, the mantra practitioner,
The learned one, should diligently offer.
Sandalwood, tagara, spṛkkā,
Saffron, or costus too:
Supreme fragrances, most excellent,
Of many pleasing kinds, should be offered.
Aloeswood, or pine resin,
Camphor and sandalwood,

The auspicious resin of the śāla tree,
Or śrīvāsaka too,
And other incense of various kinds,
Auspicious and renowned in the world,
Pleasing ones, the mantra practitioner, according to the rite,
Should offer to the deities.
Then, further, great being,
Listen to the rite of the food offerings.
Milk porridge, rice mixed with curd,
Radishes and pale cakes,
Pleasing gorbö and sugar,
Fine sweets of khaṇḍa sugar,
Pūrikā and kārikā,
Likewise mathuśira,
Phena, aśokavarti,
And parpaṭa should be offered too.
Foods such as these,
And fruits of various kinds,
Hvak and lumps of sugar candy,
Molasses, honey, and butter,
Drinks of various kinds,
And curd and milk should be offered in abundance.
Lamps of various kinds,
Filled to the brim
With clean and most excellent oil,
Richly fragrant, should be offered.
In all directions, parasols and banners
Of various colors should be raised high.
Fine porticoes, too,
Should be offered, hung with bells.
Or else, offerings of the mind,
All of them, should be diligently produced and made.
Then, taking eight vases,
Or sixteen in full,
Pour into them medicines and every kind of jewel,
And fill them with scented water.
Adorn their mouths with sprigs of plants,

And fill their mouths with fruits as well.
Adorned with flowers, incense, and the like,
Well protected,
Their necks tied with cloth,
The learned one should arrange them.
To each of the chief deities
A pair of cloths should be offered;
To the other great beings,
The offering of a single one each is proclaimed.
Having made the offerings in this way,
Summon the disciple before the maṇḍala;
The mantra practitioner should sprinkle him with water,
And give him scent and flowers.
Having had him recollect the tathāgatas,
Have him take up the mind of awakening.
Thereby all of them
Will be born into the virtuous family of the victors.
Bind on them the mudrās
That arise from the dharmadhātu;
Having bound the Dharma wheel as well,
Bless them with Vajrasattva.
Then the one disciplined in vows binds them
With the samaya of all the buddhas.
Then, according to the rite of the mantra,
He should consecrate the cloth three times,
And with a mind filled with compassion
Cover their faces.
Having recited the samaya three times,
On the crown of the head the syllable ra,
With the anusvāra, majestic,
Radiating a garland of flames,
White in color
Like the rising moon, should be placed.
Then, before all the protectors,
Have him cast a flower;
On whichever deity the flower falls,
That one the mantra practitioner should give to him.

At the gate of the first maṇḍala,
In the central part of the gateway enclosure,
Between the two gates of the maṇḍala,
The disciple should be stationed.
For him, abiding there, all the rites
Should be performed well, in proper order.
Having thus properly led in
All the disciples, free of evil,
In order to pacify them,
Perform a fire offering according to the rite.
In front of the maṇḍala of the heart,
Behind the second maṇḍala,
In the central part of the maṇḍala,
One should do it with undistracted mind.
The hearth is proclaimed to be
One cubit in measure;
The rim should be made four finger-widths,
And in the center one should visualize a vajra.
Then, on the mantra practitioner's right side,
The requisites for the fire offering should be placed;
On the left side the disciples
Should be made to sit squatting.
The one disciplined in vows himself sits on the ground,
On a seat spread with kuśa grass.
Or else, taking the finest red pigment,
Of the most excellent kind,
With it the mantra practitioner should draw
All the places of the fire in triangular form.
With kuśa grass, beginning from the right,
Strewing it all around,
It should be strewn so as to encircle it many times,
And sprinkled with scented water.
Then, imagining Agni, who benefits beings,
Within the hearth,
The one of excellent discipline should give
The supreme ladle offerings with this secret mantra:
namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ agnaye svāhā

Then, for each disciple in turn,
The learned one, with his left hand
Holding the disciple's right thumb,
Should perform the fire offering in equipoise.
With mind settled in equipoise,
And with each burnt offering,
Reciting the secret mantra according to the rite,
He should perform twenty-one fire offerings:
namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ oṃ mahāśāntagata śāntikara praśama dharmma nirajāta abhāva svabhāva dharmma samatā prāpte svāhā
After the fire offering, the mantra practitioner
Should request a fee from the disciples:

Gold and silver and jewels,
Horses and likewise elephants,
Camels, cattle, buffalo, and cloth,
Or any other goods whatsoever.
Then the disciple, respectfully,
Fully endowed with faith,
Having brought forth joy in his mind,
Should offer the fee to the guru.
Or else, in whatever way he can,
He should make that guru fully pleased.
Having done so, guarding himself,
The master calls the disciple and instructs him:
"This is the field of merit,"
For the sake of all sentient beings,
All the protectors have declared.
To the Saṅgha, rich in pure qualities,
All have given;
What is offered to the Saṅgha bears great fruit.
Those wise persons
Who offer gifts to the Saṅgha
Will be born to great and inexhaustible wealth,
Esteemed in the world.
Therefore, all in harmony,
Having brought forth joy in their minds,

For the Saṅgha praised by the buddhas
Should hold a feast of offerings as best they can.

Then the Blessed One Vairocana said to the bodhisattva mahāsattva Vajrapāṇi:

Great being, the empowerment
Taught by the buddhas of the past
I shall now explain in full.
With mind one-pointed, listen well.

Lord of Secrets, for this the master should leave a space of two cubits in front of the root maṇḍala and, on the ground outside it, draw a second maṇḍala, square, with a single gate. In its four corners he should place four vajra holders. Which four? They are Niṣprapañcavihārin, Gaganāmala, Vimalanetra, and Vicitrāmbara. In the center he should set a great eight-petaled lotus with its anthers. On four of the petals he should draw four bodhisattvas who are companions, endowed with the power of their former aspirations: namely, Dhāraṇīśvararāja, the One Possessed of Mindfulness and Vigilance, the One of Beneficent Superior Intention, and the Compassionate One. On the other petals he should draw four emblems. Which four? They are: Engaging in the Distinction of Mind, Fulfiller of Desires, Non-attachment, and Liberation. In the center he should place the form of the inconceivable dharmadhātu. Then he confers empowerment from the crown of the head with four jeweled vases filled with jewels and all the medicines, blessed by Samantabhadra, Maitreya, Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin, and Sarvāpāyajaha.

On that lotus petal
The mantra practitioner himself places the disciple;
He should worship him with incense and flowers
And present lamps and offering water.
With parasols, victory banners, and pennants,
With the pleasing sound of drums,
And with auspicious, vast, and melodious
Words, he should rejoice well.
In the presence of the protectors
He empowers him with full attention.
With fine incense and flowers
He should once more make offerings to him.

Then, holding a golden probe,
And seated in front of him,
He should speak these words,
Which sink into the disciple's heart:
"Just as the king of physicians of old
Removed the cataracts of the world,
So, my son, the Victors
Have removed your cataract of ignorance."
Then, taking up a mirror,
He should explain the characteristic of phenomena:
"Phenomena are like reflections,
Clear and pure, without turbidity,
Ungraspable and inexpressible,
Arisen from causes and from action,
Without essential nature, without abode."
Thus he should explain their characteristic.
"Having understood this Dharma in this way,
Work incomparably for the benefit of sentient beings,
And you will be born as a child of the buddhas."
Then, between the disciple's feet,
He should place a wheel of Dharma.
Then, in his right hand as well,
He gives a most excellent conch:
"Sounding the unsurpassed conch of Dharma
Far and wide in every direction,
From this day onward, in the world,
Turn the wheel of the protectors.
Without doubt or hesitation,
With a mind free of misgiving,
Proclaim throughout this world
The supreme way of practicing the secret mantra.
If you do so, it is called
Repaying the kindness of the buddhas.
And all those vajra holders
Will protect you in every way."
Then, raising the disciple up,
The mantra practitioner, with a mind

Become compassion, brings him inside
And should teach him the commitments:
"From this day onward, my son,
The sacred Dharma and the mind of awakening
You must never, from now on,
Give up, even for the sake of your life.
You must not be miserly,
Nor do any harm to sentient beings.
These commitments the buddhas
Have taught to you, who keep the excellent observance.
Just as you guard your own life,
So you must guard these."
The disciple, at the guru's feet,
Prostrates with faith and respect,
And with a mind of utter certainty
Should accept them all.

Then again the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, how much merit should we understand to be amassed by a son or daughter of good family who has entered the commitment of this great king of maṇḍalas, Arising from the Essence of Great Compassion?"

When he had asked this, the Blessed One said to the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, "However much merit, arising from the Tathāgata, is amassed from the first generation of the mind of awakening onward, the merit amassed by that son or daughter of good family should be understood to be just as much. Lord of Secrets, by this enumeration too you should regard it in this way: those sons and daughters of good family should be known to be heirs born from the speech and the heart of the Tathāgata. In whatever direction those sons and daughters of good family dwell, there the Tathāgata need no longer be greatly concerned. Therefore, Lord of Secrets, sons and daughters of good family who wish to make offerings to the Tathāgata should make offerings to them. Those who wish to see the Tathāgata should look upon them."

Then the vajra holders headed by Vajrapāṇi and the bodhisattva mahāsattvas headed by Samantabhadra spoke with one voice: "Blessed One, from this day onward we shall serve and honor those sons and daughters of good family."

"Blessed One, why is this? It is because those sons and daughters of good family are themselves to be regarded as the buddhas, the blessed ones."

Then again the Blessed One Vairocana looked upon that entire assembly and said to the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi, to those vajra holders, and to the entire assembly, "Sons of good family, there exist, arisen from the vast entry into the boundless maṇḍala of the wheel of speech that is the secret mantra words of the tathāgatas, those that are like a jewel of manifold forms, fulfilling every hope, amassing immeasurable stores of merit, abiding in unobstructed understanding, and endowed with a power unattached throughout the three times."

When he had said this, the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi, those vajra holders, and that entire assembly spoke with one voice: "Blessed One, now is the time for it. Sugata, now is the occasion for it."

Then at that time the Blessed One, by an emanation of his tongue that fulfills all desires, covered every buddha-field entirely and entered into the meditative absorption called Gazing at the Pure Summit of the Vast Crest of the Victory Banner of Dharma. The very moment the Blessed One entered into it, all the tathāgatas spoke this great queen of vidyā-mantras, the One of Great Power, the Great Protection, which pervades the dharmadhātu and sends forth a sound that fully protects the realm of sentient beings without exception:

namaḥ sarbba tathāgatebhyaḥ sarbba bhaya bigatebhyo biśva mukhebhyaḥ sarbbathā khaṃ rakṣa mahā bale sarbba tathāgata puṇya nirjāte hūṃ hūṃ trata trata apratihate svāhā

The moment all the learned buddhas
Had spoken this vidyā-mantra,
Then these buddha-fields
Shook in six ways.
All those bodhisattvas,
Their eyes opened wide in wonder,
In the presence of all the buddhas
Spoke these pleasing words:
"How wonderful! This protection of exceeding power
Has been spoken by all the buddhas
In order to guard all sentient beings,
To protect them and to shelter them.

Those in whose hearts this protection abides
Have nothing to fear.
When this secret mantra of great might is called to mind,
Obstructors and all vināyakas,
And rākṣasas of terrifying form,
All of them will be destroyed."

Then again the Blessed One, having blessed the dharmadhātu as vast, at that time entered into the meditative absorption called Possessing the Essence of the Treasury of the Dharmadhātu. The very moment the Blessed One entered into that meditative absorption, this vidyā-mantra for entering the commitment came forth:

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ asame trisame samaye svāhā

Then, immediately, throughout all the buddha-fields and all the maṇḍalas of the bodhisattva assemblies, there resounded the sound of the vidyā-mantra for entering the commitment, on hearing which the wise will not transgress any of the teachings.

Then again the Blessed One spoke the secret mantras arising from the dharmadhātu:

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ dharmma dhātu svabhāva ātmako'haṃ
This is for blessing oneself as the dharmadhātu.

namaḥ smanta vajrāṇāṃ vajra ātmako'haṃ
This is for blessing oneself as Vajrasattva.

namaḥ smanta vajrāṇāṃ vajra kavaca hūṃ
This is the vajra armor.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ tathāgata cakṣur byavalokāya svāhā
This is the eye of the Tathāgata.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ biśuddha gandhoddhaba svāhā
This is the mantra of the scented ointment.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ mahā maitrya bhyudgata svāhā
This is the mantra of the flowers.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ dharmma dhātvanugata svāhā
This is the mantra of the incense.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ sarbba tathāgata raci spharaṇa ababhāsa gaganottarebhyaḥ svāhā
This is the mantra of the lamp.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ gagana sama sama svāhā
This is the mantra of the offering water.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ gagana nānda spharaṇa biśuddha dharmma nirjata svāhā
This is the mantra of the uṣṇīṣa.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ pracaṇḍa vajra jvala bisphura hūṃ
This is the armor of the Tathāgata.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ jvāla mālin tathāgata raci svāhā
This is the All-Blazing.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ mahā tathāgata jihvasya dharmma pratiṣṭhita svāhā
This is the mantra of the tongue of the Tathāgata.

This is the treasury of mantras to be set out in the maṇḍala.

Fascicle three.

Then again Vajrapāṇi asked the Blessed One Vairocana, "Blessed One, how is it

That when the maṇḍala is drawn,
The obstructors will be pacified?
And when the secret mantra is practiced,
That the vināyakas will be absent?
How are the secret mantras to be accomplished?
And what kind of fruit will they bear?"
When he had asked this, at that time
The Blessed One, the great Vairocana,
Spoke these words:

"Excellent, excellent, great being!
All that you have asked
I shall teach to you.
Because of miserliness indulged in the past,
Obstructors arise from one's own mind.
In order to destroy their cause,

That in which all the conceptions
Of mind and mental factors are abandoned,
And in which all the elaborations
Arising from conceptual thought come to cessation,
Is what is called the mind of awakening.
The mantra practitioner, recalling the mind of awakening,
Recites Acala inwardly;
If he binds Acala's mudrā,
All the obstructors will be destroyed."

Lord of Secrets, now listen to this binding of the wind:

"Transforming oneself into the syllable a,
One recites the syllable ha inwardly.
Stationed in the quarter of the wind,
One should neatly make on the ground
Exactly seven dots of incense
And cover them with an earthen bowl.
One should imagine the bowl, again and again,
As the great Mount Meru.
Above it one should visualize the syllable a,
Together with its anusvāra, spreading wide.
Such a great binding of the wind
Was taught by the victors of the past.
Great being, now listen to that of water too,
With your mind gathered to a single point.
The mantra practitioner should imagine the syllable ra
As wholly red and of great power,
Garlanded with flames, unbearable,
A wrathful one holding a sword in his hand.
Having drawn the form of a cloud on the ground,
He should stamp it with the sword mudrā.
The clouds that have risen from every direction
Will at once be destroyed.
Or else the mantra practitioner, undistracted,
Should strike them with pegs:
The learned one, having become a vajra,
Strikes them all with vajra pegs.

Or again, the pacifying
Of all the obstructors is taught as well.
The mantra practitioner, stationed at the center of the maṇḍala,
Should imagine the secret mantra Acala, of great power,
Utterly unbearable,
Abiding in the maṇḍalas of secret mantra.
Having made an effigy of the obstructor,
He presses the crown of its head with his left foot.
Then it will either be pacified,
Or without doubt it will die.
Having made an effigy of it,
And smeared it with mustard, poison, and blood mixed together,
The mantra practitioner dries it,
And that graha will swiftly burn.
If it is dried over a fire
And smeared with poison, then certainly
Even Brahmā, or even Śakra (Indra),
Would swiftly burn on the spot."

Then Vajrapāṇi said to the Blessed One, "As I understand the meaning of what the Blessed One has said, I see it in this way. Blessed One, when the deities abide in the places of their own maṇḍala, they confer blessing. Abiding just there, they do not transgress the command of the Tathāgata. Why is that? Blessed One, abiding in this way in one's own family is the commitment of all the secret mantras. Bodhisattvas who practice the conduct of a bodhisattva by way of secret mantra, too, accomplish all aims while abiding in their own place."

The Blessed One said, "Lord of Secrets, so it is. It is just as you have said. Lord of Secrets, furthermore:

Whatever color has been taught for any deity,
That itself is its maṇḍala;
Such are the forms of the deities
Taught by the buddhas of the past.

Lord of Secrets, in time to come there will appear sentient beings of feeble intellect and without faith, who will not have faith in this teaching, who are full of doubt and hesitation, who take mere learning as the essence, and who are

not inclined toward practice. They are not only ruined themselves but also bring others to ruin. They will say, 'This is found among the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas); it was not taught by the buddhas.' But those foolish people do not know that the Blessed One, the omniscient, who has gained mastery over all phenomena and has fully understood the aims of sentient beings, taught all of these in the past out of the wish to benefit sentient beings.

The Dharma-mark of phenomena,
Those fools do not know it.
The characteristic of all phenomena
Has been truly declared to be emptiness.
The mantra practitioner, ever abiding in that,
Should perform the rites with complete certainty."

This concludes the detailed exposition of the stages for pacifying obstructors.

Then the vajra holders headed by Vajrapāṇi and the bodhisattvas headed by Samantabhadra prostrated to the Blessed One Vairocana and, wishing to speak secret mantras in words that would express, each in his own words, how they had realized the gateway of the pure dharmadhātu here in this great maṇḍala Arising from Great Compassion, they made a request to the Blessed One.

Then the Blessed One Vairocana blessed those bodhisattvas and those vajra holders into the unfailing nature of reality and said, "Sons of good family, speak the secret mantra words that purify the realm of sentient beings, in accordance with how you have realized the dharmadhātu."

Then, at that time, the bodhisattva Samantabhadra entered into the meditative absorption called the Domain of the Buddha's Adornment and spoke the secret mantra of unobstructed power:

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ samantānugati baraja dharmma nirjāta mahā mahā svāhā
This is Samantabhadra's.

Then the bodhisattva Maitreya entered into the meditative absorption called the Universal Arising of Great Loving-kindness and spoke his own heart mantra:

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ ajatanjayā sarbba satva āśayānugata svāhā
This is Maitreya's.

Then again the bodhisattva Ākāśagarbha entered into the meditative absorption called the Pure Domain and spoke the secret mantra:

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ ākāśa samatānugata bicitraṃ bara dhara svāhā
This is Ākāśagarbha's.

Then the bodhisattva Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin entered into the meditative absorption called the Fortitude of Great Compassion and spoke the secret mantra:

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ āsatāhṛta aṅbhudgata trāṃ trāṃ rāṃ rāṃ svāhā
This is Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin's.

Then the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara entered into the meditative absorption called Looking Everywhere and spoke his own heart mantra, together with those of his retinue:

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ sarbba tathāgata abalokita kāruṇā māyā ra ra ra hūṃ jaḥ svāhā
This is Avalokiteśvara's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ jaṃ jaṃ sa svāhā
This is Mahāsthāmaprāpta's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ kāruṇoṅbhabe tāre tāriṇi svāhā
This is the goddess Tārā's.

namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ sarbba bhaya trāsani hūṃ sphoṭaya svāhā
This is Bhṛkuṭī's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ tathāgata biśaya saṃbhabe padma mālini svāhā
This is Pāṇḍaravāsinī's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ hūṃ khada bandha sphoṭaya svāhā
This is Hayagrīva's.

Then the bodhisattva Kṣitigarbha entered into the meditative absorption called the Domain of Indestructible Vajra Discernment and spoke the secret mantra:

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ ha ha ha sutanu svāhā
This is Kṣitigarbha's.

Then the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī Kumārabhūta entered into the meditative absorption called the Miraculous Display of the Buddha's Blessing and spoke his own heart mantra:

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ he he he kumāraka bimukti sathasthiti smara smara pratitana svāhā
This is Mañjuśrī's.

Then the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi entered into the meditative absorption called the Invincible and spoke his own heart mantra, together with those of his retinue:

namaḥ smanta vajrāṇāṃ caṇḍa mahā roṣaṇa hūṃ
This is Vajrapāṇi's.

namaḥ smanta vajrāṇāṃ triṭa triṭa jayanti svāhā
This is Māmakī's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ hūṃ bandhaya bandhaya moṭaya moṭaya vajroṅbhabe sarbbatra apratihate svāhā
This is the Vajra Chain's.

namaḥ smanta vajrāṇāṃ hrīḥ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā
This is the Chief of the Wrathful Moon's.

namaḥ smanta vajrāṇāṃ sarbba dharmma nirbhedni vajra suci barade svāhā
This is the Vajra Point's.

namaḥ smanta vajrāṇāṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ jaṃ jaṃ svāhā
This is that of all the vajra holders.

namaḥ smanta vajrāṇāṃ he he kiñcirāyasi gṛhṇa gṛhṇa khāda khāda paripūraya sapratijñāna svāhā
This is that of all the attendants.

Then, at that time, the Blessed One Śākyamuni entered into the meditative absorption called the Source of Jewels and spoke his own heart mantra, together with those of his retinue:

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ sarbba kleśa niśuddhāna sarbba dharmma baśita prāpta gagana sama sama svāhā
This is Śākyamuni's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ barade bara prāpte hūṃ
This is that of the ūrṇā.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ baṃ baṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā
This is that of all the uṣṇīṣas.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ dhriṃ dhriṃ riṃ riṃ jri jri svāhā
This is that of the wrathful one called Aparājita.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ aparājita jālanati jhaṭita svāhā
This is Aparājita's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ prithibyai svāhā
This is the Earth's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ biṣṇabe svāhā
This is Viṣṇu's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ rudrāya svāhā
This is Rudra's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ bāyabe svāhā
This is Vāyu's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ sarasvatyai svāhā
This is Sarasvatī's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ rākṣasādhipataye svāhā
This is Nairṛti's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ baibasatvāya svāhā
This is Yama's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ mṛtaye svāhā
This is Mṛtyu's, the lord of death.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ kālarātriye svāhā
This is Kālarātri's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ matribhyaḥ svāhā
This is that of the mātṛkās.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ śakrāya svāhā
This is Śakra's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ apāṃpataye svāhā
This is Varuṇa's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ ādityāya svāhā
This is the Sun's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ prajapataye svāhā
This is Brahmā's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ candrāya svāhā
This is the Moon's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ mebhaśaniye svāhā
This is that of Nanda and Upananda.

Then again the Blessed One Vairocana, wishing his teaching to be accomplished as meaningful, spoke the queen of vidyā-mantras, the mother of all the buddhas and bodhisattvas:

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ gagana bara lakṣaṇe gagana sama sarbbodagata tisara saṃbhabe jvala namo amoghānān svāhā
This is that of Gaganalocanā, the mother of all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Then again the Blessed One Vairocana, in order to pacify all obstructors, entered into the meditative absorption called the Source of Splendor and spoke these secret mantras that crush the great obstructors:

namaḥ smanta vajrāṇāṃ caṇḍa mahā roṣaṇa sphoṭaya hūṃ trag ha mā
This is the noble Acala's.

namaḥ smanta vajrāṇāṃ ha ha ha bismaye sarbba tathāgana biṣaya saṃbhaya trailokya bijaya hūṃ ja svāhā
This is Trailokyavijaya's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ hetu pratyaya bigate dharmma nirājata hūṃ
This is that of the śrāvakas.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ tha
This is that of the pratyekabuddhas.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ sarbba buddha bodhisatva hṛdayaṃ nibeśani namaḥ sarbba bidyā svāhā
This is the common heart mantra of all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ loka loka karāya sarbba deba nāga yakṣa gandharbā asura garuḍa kinra mahoraga hṛdayan nyakariṣaya bicitra gati svāhā
This is the common heart mantra of the gods and the others.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ sarbathā bīmati bikiraṇa dharmma dhātu nirjāta saṃ saṃ ha svāhā
This is that of all the bodhisattvas.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ dundānta mahā roṣaṇa khāṭaya sarbbān tathāgata ājñāṃ kuru svāhā

This is that of the gatekeeper called Durdānta.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ he mahā pracanḍa abhimukha grihṇa khādaya kiñcirāyasi samaya manusmara svāhā
This is that of the gatekeeper Abhimukha.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ sarbbatra anugate bandha sīmāṃ mahā samaya nirjāte smaraṇe apratihate dhaka dhaka cara cara bhandha bhandha daśa diśan sarbba tathāgata anugate prabara dharmma labṅha bijaye bhagabati bikuri bikule lelu bupri svāhā
This is that of sealing the great boundary.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ a
This is that of awakening.
ā
This is that of conduct.
oṃ
This is that of perfect buddhahood.
a
This is that of nirvāṇa.

namaḥ samanta vajrāṇāṃ hā
This is Trailokyavijaya's.

namaḥ smanta vajrāṇāṃ hāṃ
This is that of the noble protector Acala.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ a
This is Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ sa
This is Avalokiteśvara's.

namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ
This is Vajrapāṇi's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ manomā
This is Mañjuśrī's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ ga
This is Gaganalocanā's.

namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ raṃ
This is that of the dharmadhātu.

namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ khāṃ
This is that of the Great Hero.

namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ jaṃ
This is that of the Lord of Waters.

namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ taṃ
This is the goddess Tārā's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ
This is Bhṛkuṭī's.

namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ paṃ
This is Pāṇḍaravāsinī's.

namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ saṃ
This is Mahāsthāmaprāpta's.

namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ haṃ
This is Hayagrīva's.

namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ yaṃ
This is Yaśodharā's.

namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ saṃ
This is Ratnapāṇi's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ
This is Jālinīprabha's.

namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ bha
This is Śākyamuni's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ hāṃ nyaṃ ruṃ
This is that of the three uṣṇīṣas.

namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ laṃ
This is that of the White Parasol.

namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ śaṃ
This is Jayoṣṇīṣa's.

namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ saṃ
This is Vijayoṣṇīṣa's.

namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ triṃ
This is Tejorāśi's.

namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ
This is Vikiraṇa's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ hūṃ
This is Aparājita's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ
This is the Earth's.

namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ kili
This is Keśinī's.

namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ dili
This is Upakeśinī's.

namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ mili
This is Citrā's.

namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ hili
This is Vasumatī's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ hasanāṃ
This is that of the Wondrous One.

namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ rasanāṃ
This is that of the Giver of Fearlessness to All Beings.

namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ darśanāṃ
This is that of the Purifier of All Lower Realms.

namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ bihasanāṃ
This is Paritrāṇāśayamati's.

namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ ṭhaṃ
This is that of the Manifest Arising of Great Loving-kindness.

namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ yaṃ
This is that of the One Tormented by Compassion.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ
This is that of the Pacifier of All Torment.

namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ
This is Acintyamati's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ traṃ
This is Ratnākara's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ ṣaṃ
This is Ratnapāṇi's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ ṭaṃ
This is Dharaṇiṃdhara's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ aṃ
This is that of the One Who Has Attained Dhāraṇī.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ ḍhaṃ
This is that of the One with the Jewel Mudrā in His Hand.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ naṃ
This is that of the One of Firm Intention.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ hāṃ
This is Gaganāmala's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ rāṃ
This is Gaganamati's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ gataṃ
This is Viśuddhamati's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ ṅhīṃ
This is Cāritramati's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ hūṃ
This is Sthiramati's.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ ṅhriṃ śriṃ haṃ braṃ
This is that of the attendants.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ kṣa da ha ra yaṃ kaṃ
This is that of the bodhisattvas as they have been described.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ mano māye dharmma saṃbhabe bibhabe kaṭhane saṃsane
This is that of the gods of the Pure Abodes.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ kraṃ keri
This is that of the rākṣasas.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ hrīḥ h
This is that of the ḍākinīs.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ yakṣa bīrya dhari
This is that of the yakṣas.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ mici mici
This is that of the piśācīs.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ guṃ guṃ iṃ iṃ
This is that of the bhūtas.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ raṭaṃ raṭaṃ braṃṭaṃ braṃṭaṃ
This is that of the asuras.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ garalaṃ biralaṃ
This is that of the mahoragas.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ hasanāṃ bīasanāṃ
This is that of the kinnaras.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ aticalārana manomai
This is that of humans.

"Lord of Secrets, I have explained the secret mantras of all these and the others. Now, among them, listen with a tranquil mind to the heart of all the secret mantras:

The syllable a is truly declared
To be the heart of all mantras.
In it all the secret mantras abide;
Thus are the mantras ascertained."

From The Manifest and Complete Awakening of the Great Vairocana, Its Magical Display and Blessing, this concludes the detailed exposition of the treasury of common secret mantras.

Then again the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, "Lord of Secrets, listen to how secret mantras are accomplished and what the fruit of accomplishing them is:

Syllable joined with syllable,
And likewise basis turned into basis,
With strict restraint, inwardly,
One should perform a hundred thousand recitations."

"The syllable is the mind of awakening;
The second is what is called sound.
The basis is the placing of one's own deity;

This is done at the site of one's own body.
The second basis should be known
As the perfect Buddha, supreme among two-legged beings.
The mantrin should imagine him abiding
Upon a perfectly pure disk of the moon.
In its center one should set out well
The syllables in their proper sequence.
Then press them down with the words of drawing back in,
And thoroughly purify life-force and exertion (prāṇāyāma).
What is called life-force is explained as wind;
Exertion is what is called mindfulness.
Having restrained these two,
One should first carry out the approach well.
Then for one month the mantrin,
Under strict restraint, should perform the recitation.
The preliminary practice of secret mantra
Proceeds from the one basis into the other.
All the buddhas of great renown
Have explained this as the preliminary practice.
From then on, offering whatever little one has,
Flowers, incense, and so forth,
In order to attain buddhahood itself,
One should at that time also dedicate it to awakening.
The mantrin, fearless in this way,
Should perform the recitation in the second month.
Then, at the time of the full moon,
That person should enter into accomplishment.
On a mountain peak, in a cowshed,
Likewise at the confluence of rivers,
At a crossroads, at a shrine of a single liṅga,
At a shrine of the mātṛkās, or at a peaceful place,
One should carefully draw the maṇḍala
And make it entirely a vajra enclosure.
Having then guarded the site there,
One should apply oneself diligently to accomplishment.
There, at midnight,
Or else at the time the Sun rises,

Portents such as these will occur,
And one endowed with intelligence should recognize them:
The sound hūṃ, the sound of drums,
Likewise the quaking of the Earth,
Or else pleasing words;
If these resound from the sky,
By those signs one should know
That success has followed according to one's wish.
The buddhas, supreme among two-legged beings,
Have rightly declared this to be its fruit.
One who abides thus in the way of mantra
Will certainly become a buddha.
Therefore, in every way,
One should always keep the mantra itself in mind.
The buddhas of the past, of great power,
Have also taught that it is to be kept in mind."

From The Manifest and Complete Awakening of the Great Vairocana, Its Magical Display and Blessing, this concludes the chapter on the stages of accomplishing worldly attainments.

Then again the Blessed One Vairocana, looking upon the entire assembled retinue, spoke these words of Dharma, which fulfill all hopes and bring to perfection the wisdom that ascertains the gateway of the boundless three times:

"Stainless like space, devoid of essential nature,
It bestows wisdom of manifold kinds in many ways.
By its essential nature it is ever emptiness;
Dependent on conditions, it is profound and hard to see.
Above all, to beings it constantly
Grants the supreme fruit they have conceived.
Just as space, a sphere of activity free of attachment,
Has become the abode of all beings,
So this perfectly pure nature of reality
Brings forth the prosperity of all three realms of existence without exception.
Any wise one of supreme birth who practices this
Will come to share one sphere of activity with all the Victors.
The nature of reality, just as the Victors have taught it,

Is utterly pure and illuminates all;
There is no other state harder to find than that.
This vast Dharma is profound and never diminishes;
Unequaled, it benefits the world:
Practice it, abandoning conceptual thought entirely."

Then, having spoken those verses, the great Blessed One Vairocana looked upon the entire assembled retinue and said to Vajrapāṇi and the other vajra holders, "Sons of good family, teach the words for accomplishing attainments, which are the power and blessing of the realm of reality of each of you, by which beings, in this very life, having found joy and contentment, will come to experience bliss."

When he had said this, the vajra holders bowed to the Blessed One Vairocana and said, "We would follow your Dharma command just as you have given it. Yet we make this request of the Blessed One himself: out of love for us, may the Blessed One himself teach the words for accomplishing attainments. Why is that? Blessed One, for us to explain in the presence of the Blessed One what we ourselves have realized is exceedingly difficult. That being so, for the sake of the welfare, benefit, and happiness of beings to come, may the Blessed One himself please explain it well and fully."

When they had made this request, the Blessed One Vairocana spoke thus to all those vajra holders: "Excellent, excellent, sons of good family! In this Dharma and Vinaya taught by the Tathāgata there is one quality of great benefit, namely, a sense of shame. For a son of good family or a daughter of good family who possesses a sense of shame, two things come about very swiftly in this very life. What are the two? Not doing deeds that should not be done, and being praised by the holy ones. There are two more: understanding what had not been understood, and attaining the company of the buddhas and bodhisattvas. There are two more: becoming firmly established in moral discipline, and attaining birth among gods and humans. Therefore, keep this well in mind. I shall now explain the words of application for accomplishment by which bodhisattvas who practice the conduct of a bodhisattva by way of secret mantra will swiftly attain the accomplishment of secret mantra from the secret mantras: the words of application that bring the practice of secret mantra to success."

"In this, first of all, one must have seen the maṇḍala, have received the guru's permission to practice secret mantra, have generated the mind set on awakening, be endowed with faith and free of avarice, be compassionate and disciplined, be skilled in analyzing dependent origination, have taken up the vows, and abide in one's own training.

Skilled in means and very steadfast,
One knows what is timely and what is untimely;
Fearless, learned, and generous,
Patient, with a mind of loving-kindness,
Thoroughly diligent in the conduct of secret mantra,
Skilled in the meaning of the reality of secret mantra,
And delighting in the practice of meditative concentration:
Such a practitioner is auspicious for accomplishment.

"Lord of Secrets, the lord of the desire realm has a vidyā-mantra called Intoxicating. With it he makes all the gods who dwell in the desire realm faint with intoxication. He also displays delightful places filled with many and various flowers, and he magically emanates enjoyments and pleasures of every different kind, which he gives also to the gods of the heaven Controlling Others' Emanations, and enjoys himself as well.

"Likewise, the god Maheśvara (Śiva) has a vidyā-mantra called Swift as Thought. With it he accomplishes the needs of beings in the great trichiliocosm world system, and he magically emanates all kinds of pleasures and enjoyments, which he gives also to the gods of the realm of the Pure Abodes, and enjoys himself as well.

"Likewise, for example, a magician by means of mantras displays pleasure groves, lakes, rivers, people, and things of every different kind. Likewise, for example, the asuras display the illusions of secret mantra. Likewise, for example, through secret mantras poison, fever, and the like are made to cease. Likewise, the goddesses called mātṛkās send contagious disease upon beings by means of secret mantra. Likewise, for example, by means of secret mantra the heat of fire is removed and it is made cool. Sons of good family, through these words of example you should come to have faith in the power of secret mantra.

"What, then, is this power of secret mantra? It does not arise from the secret mantras, it does not come in from substances, and it is not the performer's focusing on the act. Nevertheless, sons of good family, it does not go beyond

the arising of the nature of reality that is the blessing of secret mantra, because it transcends the three times, and because it comes about from profound and inconceivable dependent origination. Therefore, sons of good family, having understood the realization of the inconceivable essential nature through the nature of reality, you should always, without interruption, follow the way of secret mantra."

Then again the Blessed One entered the meditative absorption called Possessing the Essence of the Pure Adornment of the Inconceivable Abode of the Tathāgata, which blesses the basis of the powers that are unattached in the three times. As soon as the Blessed One had entered that absorption, from the sounds that make known the entire realm of reality, as much as there is, there came forth the power of the abode of the realm of reality, the power equal to the unequaled, arisen from the resolve of the perfectly complete Buddha, arisen from the single tone of the four states, pervading the entire realm of reality and become equal to space:
namaḥ sarbba tathāgatebhyo biśva mukhebhyaḥ sarbbathā a ā aṃ aḥ
As soon as these essences of the perfectly complete Buddha had come forth, then again, from the gateways that proclaim the entire realm of reality, the sounds of the tones of knowledge, marked with the words of the essence of the perfectly complete Buddha, resounded one after another.

The bodhisattvas, hearing this,
Opened eyes filled with wonder,
And to the Omniscient One, free of all ills,
They addressed these sweet words:
"How wonderful! Through the practice of secret mantra
The buddhas, supreme among two-legged beings,
Have brought forth the great and vast wisdom
By which all this is pervaded.
Therefore, in every way,
With an inner self made wholly pure,
One should always strive earnestly
In the essence praised by the buddhas."

Next comes the accomplishment of the essences of the perfectly complete Buddha. In a pleasure garden, in a temple, in a cave, or wherever the mind finds solitude, one should cultivate the awakening mind and remain there until the signs appear. Then, taking up any one of those essences, one should accomplish the basis until one is free of doubt. Then, placing the essence at

the heart, one should accomplish the mind: gazing upon it as utterly pure, stainless, firm, completely unmoving, nonconceptual, like a mirror, and exceedingly subtle, one should continue with the practice of constant familiarization until one sees one's own body as the body of one's own deity.

"The second basis is the perfectly complete Buddha. Within that very mirror disk he is seated upon a great king of lotuses, absorbed in a meditative absorption as if dwelling in a cave, encircled by his topknot, his crown ornament, and infinite rays of light, free of all thought and conceptualization, peaceful from the very beginning like space. One should imagine the sound abiding in him, and recite in meditative equipoise.

Then the preliminary approach
Is said to be done a hundred thousand times.
Then in the second month
One should offer flowers, scents, and so forth,
And bring about benefit of many kinds
For sentient beings;
Completely setting aside gain and loss,
One should recite in a further month.
There, at that time, this application
Should be contemplated in meditative equipoise:
'By the power of my merit
May all sentient beings be happy!
May all of them be free of illness!
Or else may they have the perfection of desires
That the Tathāgatas have praised!
Or else may all sentient beings
Have all their hopes completely fulfilled,
Accomplished without hindrance,
In a manner free of obscuration!
May the suffering of animals
Devouring one another never arise!
May food, drink, and the like
Come to the hungry ghosts without hindrance!
Whatever sufferings the beings in hell endure,
Unbearable and of every kind,
By the power of my merit
May they swiftly be pacified!'

Generating great compassion
For all suffering beings,
One should contemplate again and again
That accomplishment and others as well.
In order to accomplish things as one has contemplated them,
With the three places of blessing
One should bless all of these,
And recite the mantra mentally:
'Through the power of my merit,
The power of the Tathāgatas' blessing,
And the power of the realm of reality,
By benefiting sentient beings,
Whatever aims have been contemplated,
Here, in the realm of beings without exception,
May they all, each as is fitting,
Come about without hindrance!'"

Then at that time the Blessed One spoke the queen of vidyā-mantras, whose power is like space, called the Arising of the Sky Treasury:
namaḥ sarbba tathāgatebhyo biśva mukhebhyaḥ sarba tad khaṃ uṭgate spharaṇa imaṃ gagana khaṃ svāhā
"If one recites this three times, all aims, just as one has contemplated them, will come about without hindrance.
Then, at the time of the full moon,
That person should enter into accomplishment.
On a mountain peak, in a cowshed,
At a river confluence, or in a charnel ground,
At a crossroads, or at the foot of a solitary tree,
At a shrine of the mātṛkās, or in a peaceful place,
Listen with a gentle mind to the maṇḍala
That makes all obstructors swoon.
Square on every side,
With a single door and with a border,
All in the color yellow:
Having drawn this supreme vajra maṇḍala,
In the manner of a chain of vajras
The vajras should be linked one to another.

At the door draw two door guardians,
Hard to Tame and Abhimukha,
With red eyes and wrathful,
Drawn angry and menacing.
In the corners tridents
Should be drawn with care.
In the center draw a lovely vajra seat
Facing in every direction,
And upon it a great lotus
With eight petals and with anthers.
Having paid homage to all the Victors
And made aspirations,
Binding the vajra mudrā
Of the wise Vajrapāṇi,
Having set up protection there, one should sit there,
And, taking up the purified substance,
With an inner self made wholly pure,
One should recite throughout an entire night.
There, at midnight,
Or else at the time the Sun rises,
The substance becomes transformed,
Like the splendor of a garland of flames.
If the mantrin himself then takes it up,
He will travel through the sky.
He lives for an eon, of great splendor;
That heir of the Victors dies when he wishes,
And goes to other world systems too,
A lord who takes on various forms.
Through accomplishing the mantra that arises from the substance
He makes glorious offerings.
This is declared to be the accomplishment
Of substance that does not decline.

"Lord of Secrets, taking this procedure as their reason, the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly complete buddhas dwelling in all world systems, who have realized and understood the perfection of skillful means, though they know that very procedure to be empty of intrinsic nature, through the power of

the perfection of skillful means designate the unconditioned by designations. And so that beings may dwell happily in this very life by way of transformation, they reveal with certainty to beings the great power and blessing of the realm of reality. Through this, those beings become delighted in mind and also attain long life; they play and enjoy themselves with the five qualities of sense pleasure, make offerings to the buddhas, the blessed ones, and accomplish this path, which runs counter to the whole world.

"The Tathāgatas and bodhisattvas, too, seeing this purpose, explain as they please the rite of the way of practicing secret mantra. Why is that? Because what is not attained even by striving over many eons and making the effort to undertake austerities, that is attained in this single life by bodhisattvas who practice the bodhisattva conduct by way of secret mantra.

"Lord of Secrets, further, if a bodhisattva who practices the bodhisattva conduct by way of secret mantra takes a tathāgata's banner, a sword, a parasol, sandals, a wish-fulfilling jewel, eye ointment, or bezoar, performs three hundred thousand recitations, and accomplishes it in that way, it will be accomplished accordingly.

"Lord of Secrets, further, if a son of good family or a daughter of good family who is endowed with skillful means accomplishes the things the mind desires, they will be fully accomplished solely through the mere power of their own mind.

"Lord of Secrets, those foolish people who expect a fruit from a cause, Lord of Secrets, do not truly know the defining characteristic of secret mantra in the secret mantras."

"Why is that?
The cause is not said to be an agent,
Nor does the fruit exist within it.
When a cause is empty of being a cause,
How could it ever become a cause?
Therefore the fruit of secret mantra
Should be known as free of cause and of action.
When one truly touches
The meditative absorption of signlessness,
Then the mantrin obtains
Accomplishment that truly arises from the mind."

Then again Vajrapāṇi said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, please explain also the words for accomplishing as attainments the bases of the perfectly complete Buddha, through which sons of good family and daughters of good family may delight in this very life and abide experiencing bliss, without contradicting the realm of reality. Why is that, Blessed One? The realm of reality is an inconceivable realm, and this too has been taught by the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly complete buddhas. Blessed One, that being so, since bodhisattvas practice the bodhisattva conduct by way of secret mantra, they need to come to understand the realization of the indivisible realm of reality."

When he had made this request, the Blessed One said to Vajrapāṇi, "Excellent, excellent, Lord of Secrets! Lord of Secrets, that you think to ask the Tathāgata about this matter is excellent as well. Therefore listen, and keep it well in mind, and I shall explain it to you."

Saying, "Excellent, Blessed One," the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi listened to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One said this to him: "Lord of Secrets, here there is the accomplishment called A. In a temple, in a cave, or in any place at all, one should place the A on all one's limbs and perform three hundred thousand recitations. Then, at the time of the full moon, having made offerings as far as one's means allow, one should recite until the bodhisattva Samantabhadra, or Mañjuśrī, or any one of the great vajra holders comes and strokes one's head or says, 'Excellent!' Then, if one bows and presents a guest offering, one will attain the meditative absorption of not forgetting the awakening mind.

"Likewise, if one cultivates lightness of mind and lightness of body and recites, one's body will become pure and one's mind will become pure. If one sets out the A and recites, one's ears will become pure. If one wishes to hold on to life, one should join the A with the breath of life and contemplate it at the three times of day; one will then live long. If one places the anusvāra dot upon that same A, it draws out all poisons, both stationary and moving.

"Then, if one wishes to bring a person of splendor under one's control:
Make the syllable A into oneself,
And likewise from PA make the lord of men;
On the one place a lotus,
And on the other place a conch;
If they look each other in the face,
At that very moment he comes under control."

Then the Blessed One Vairocana, looking upon the entire assembled retinue, said to the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi, "Vajrapāṇi, there is a teaching called Arisen from the Heart of the Tathāgatas: the extensive chapter on the music of conduct that plays through acts and activities, gathered into the complete gathering of the four elements, abiding in the king of mind, all-pervading like space, abounding in seen and unseen fruits, directly evident to all śrāvakas, pratyekabuddhas, and bodhisattvas, fulfilling all the hopes of those who practice the bodhisattva conduct by way of secret mantra, endowed with various activities, and beneficial to all sentient beings. Listen to it, keep it well in mind, and I shall explain it to you.

"Vajrapāṇi, what then is this music of conduct, abounding in fruits that bring acts and activities to accomplishment, and directly evident to all embodied beings?

One who knows the rite should first
Carry out the reality of the self in sequence.
The mantrin, seated as before,
Having called the Tathāgata to mind,
Should make himself the syllable A,
With the anusvāra, and expanded,
All a deep and lovely yellow,
Marked with a square and with a vajra.
Abiding there, the mantrin should fully
Imagine the lord of all buddhas.
This, all the buddhas have declared,
Is the reality of the self.
When the mantrin is free of doubt
About the reality of the self,
Then he becomes one who brings
Benefit to the whole world.
Endowed with wonders of every kind,
He abides in the state of a magician.
When the mantrin rests in equipoise
And existence narrows greatly,
All the karma accumulated through ignorance
Since beginningless time is exhausted.
When he cultivates that mind,
The unsurpassed awakening mind,

Then too the mantrin, the yogin,
Like a lotus in the water,
Is not stained by the concepts of karma
That bring forth fruits of virtue and nonvirtue.
If he transforms this very self
Into the supreme Victor, what need is there to speak of it?"

Fascicle four.

Then the Blessed One Vairocana entered the meditative absorption called Vajra Play Victorious over the Four Māras, and spoke these vajra syllable-words, which are victorious over the four māras, liberate from the six realms of existence, and bring the wisdom of omniscience to perfection:
namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ a bīra hūṃ khaṃ
Then again the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi, those vajra holders, the bodhisattvas Samantabhadra and the rest, and that whole assembled retinue, every one of them filled with wonder, gazing without blinking, bowed their heads to the Omniscient One and spoke these words:

"You who are the treasured wealth
Of the protecting bodhisattvas and of all the buddhas!
Through this, those buddhas,
Protecting bodhisattvas,
Pratyekabuddhas, and śrāvakas,
The wise ones, here in this world,
Having attained the unsurpassed wisdom of the buddhas,
The incomparable wisdom,
Displaying miraculous powers of every kind,
Range across the whole face of the earth.
Therefore, the extensive rites
Of each of these, and all the arrangements
Of the various activities,
Please explain in this teaching.
Through that, sentient beings, rejoicing
In the unsurpassed Great Vehicle
Of the practice of secret mantra,
Will come to abide in the reality of this very life."
When they had made this request, the Blessed One
Spoke these words in a gentle voice:

"All of you, in harmony, one-pointedly,
Rest in equipoise and listen to this!"

At that time he blessed the ground as a great vajra, and wishing to reveal the essence of awakening from his own body, he spoke:

"A should be known as supreme;
It possesses the Mahendra maṇḍala.
Both outwardly and inwardly
It should be known as the vajra maṇḍala.
Seated there, one should contemplate everything;
This is declared to be the seat of yoga.
A is the most excellent breath of life,
Declared supreme for summoning.
When it is pressed down by the anusvāra,
It becomes the dispeller for all embodied beings.
When the mantrin for one month,
Having bound the seal of the vajra holder,
Recites at the three times of day,
The city of ignorance will be destroyed.
Even by gods and asuras
He cannot be split; he becomes utterly firm.
In order to accomplish gain for oneself,
Whatever rites of increase there may be,
All of these the mantrin should always
Perform in the center of the maṇḍala.
Golden in color and blazing,
Wearing a topknot and a crown ornament,
The perfect Buddha absorbed in meditative absorption:
This is called the basis of Mahendra.
A vajra, a lotus, a sword,
And likewise what is called clear,
Gold, and earth,
Or else a wish-fulfilling jewel:
Such substances as these
One should accomplish by meditating on them as Mahendra.
I shall also explain the pressings down;
Listen to this in meditative equipoise.

In brief, the mantrin should imagine
Mount Meru with eight peaks.
Upon it one should place a lotus,
And after that, a vajra.
Upon that the yogin places
The supreme syllable, the chief;
If he presses it down on someone's crown,
That one will remain unmoving.
Again, if one recites a hundred times over medicine
And a person drinks it,
The illnesses he suffers
That arise from former karma will be driven out.
Then further, gentle one,
Hear of the supreme syllable VA.
Like snow, milk, and conch,
It arises from the center of the navel.
A white lotus with its petals:
In its center abides
The supreme protector, utterly peaceful,
Like the light of the autumn moon.
Its maṇḍala is wondrous,
So the perfect buddhas have declared.
One should imagine it all white,
Encircled by nine concentric rings,
Pacifying every torment,
Abiding within gathered mist and dew.
Like milk, like garlands of white pearls,
Like crystal and the light of the moon,
Streams of water pour down
On every side, all around:
If the mantrin imagines this in his mind,
He will be freed from every torment.
In meditative equipoise one should accomplish
These things here in this maṇḍala:
Fresh butter, milk, garlands of pearls,
Likewise a bull, or crystal,
Curd, or else water:

Such substances one should accomplish
For the accomplishment of various attainments.
Life becomes long,
Form becomes greatly wondrous,
One is freed from all illnesses,
One's good fortune becomes supreme,
One becomes able to retain with a keen mind,
And wisdom becomes utterly stainless:
Through these substances of accomplishment
All of these are swiftly accomplished.
This glorious maṇḍala
Is declared to bring pacification.
When it is made together with the anusvāra,
It becomes supreme for dispelling.
The syllable RA, truly supreme,
Is called the light of all luminous things.
Through it, whatever karma there may be,
Even that arising from the five acts of immediate retribution,
If the yogin contemplates it
In deep meditative equipoise, will all be exhausted.
Lovely and all deep red,
It abides in the form of a triangle,
Peaceful, wreathed in garlands of flame;
One should place it at the heart, marked with the sign of the triple junction.
The yogin, seated there,
Should imagine RA together with the anusvāra.
With it, the fearless one
Accomplishes those things as is fitting."

With the Sun and all the planets,
And likewise, with focused mind, with fire,
The substances for bringing under control,
Or else for causing enmity,
For drying up and for killing,
And likewise for separating and for harming:
If one applies this together with fire,
One will accomplish all of these.

The syllable called ha, holy and supreme,
Is wind, from which all things truly arise.
Cause, action and result,
And that from which seeds are born:
If this is applied together with the anusvāra,
It destroys all of these.
Its form, too, is explained:
Black in color, of great radiance,
Wreathed in garlands of unbearable flame,
Sweeping everything away on every side.
The wise one should imagine it
Abiding in a maṇḍala between the eyebrows.
That maṇḍala is dark blue, like a crescent moon,
With a crest, and banners fluttering.
The mantra practitioner should imagine
The utterly unchanging syllable abiding there.
In the center of that maṇḍala,
For one who merely sees it,
The things that accomplish the welfare of sentient beings
Are at that time accomplished.
Going through the sky,
Or the bases of miraculous power,
The divine eye and the divine ear,
Which the mantra practitioner likewise attains,
Invisibility and all the rest,
And whatever divisions have been taught:
The mantra practitioner in meditative equipoise,
Abiding in the maṇḍala, accomplishes them all.
Here, at this heart of awakening,
The bodhisattvas of great renown,
By not apprehending any cause at all,
Gain victory over Māra.
Since there is no cause, there is no result either,
And action, too, does not exist;
Since these three things are absent,
One attains the wisdom of emptiness.
The perfect Buddha of great power

Has correctly explained its form:
Joined with the anusvāra,
khaṃ is called the supreme of emptiness.
With the mudrā of the sword
One surely accomplishes what is to be accomplished.
Sword, noose and wheel,
Iron arrow and likewise hammer:
When one is equipped with these implements,
One accomplishes the supreme state.

Then again the Blessed One Vairocana declared to Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets: "Lord of Secrets, when a bodhisattva who practices the conduct of a bodhisattva by way of secret mantra has transformed himself into the very nature of the syllable called a, no longer looks to any things, whether outer or inner, regards clods of earth, stones and gold as equal, and has abandoned faults such as attachment and aversion, as well as sinful actions,
Then at that time he becomes pure,
Like the Sage, the perfect Buddha.
He is capable of all activities
And has abandoned every fault.
Then, devoted to the other mantra yoga,
Knowing the ritual procedure,
Wishing to benefit sentient beings,
One should perform the rite of the syllable called va.
With a mind born of compassion,
Focusing on the suffering of the world,
That protector should fill
His own body entirely
With a stream of white,
Like snow or cow's milk.
Then, having generated certainty,
From all the pores
Of all his limbs
He should send forth streams of utterly stainless water.
With that water this whole earth,
Without remainder, should be entirely filled.
Whoever drinks this water,

Or even touches it with the hand,
All of them will surely
Attain awakening; of this there is no doubt.
The syllable called ra throughout the limbs,
Wreathed in peaceful garlands of flame,
Radiating on every side:
This one should imagine in deep meditative equipoise.
Then, if the yogin sends outward
A blaze that illuminates everything,
Through the emanations of ra
The mantra practitioner does whatever he wishes.
The syllable called ra in the upper body,
The syllable called va at the navel:
Blazing fire and streaming water
Are then displayed at one and the same time.
The sufferings of the cold hells
Are utterly pacified by ra;
The mantra practitioner, abiding in the way of mantra,
Pacifies heat and the like by va as well.
The syllable called ha, together with a banner,
Should be placed beneath the syllable called ra.
By it even people laden with sin
Swiftly accomplish the rites.
The mantra practitioner, seated upon Mahendra,
Should undertake the rite of water;
Dispelling and all the rest
He will perform; of this there is no doubt.
Wind is declared to go everywhere;
It is also what destroys all things.
The rites that arise from the divisions
Of activities of many different kinds
Should be performed by this ritual
In the center of the maṇḍala of form.

If one thoroughly purifies the mind and recites, the mind will become completely pure. If one trains the body in lightness and recites while walking, one will attain the bases of miraculous power. If one sits squatting, sets out the syllable called a, and recites for one month, one will attain the divine ear.

Lord of Secrets, such states of accomplishment and the rest arise from the mind. Lord of Secrets, see how, through mere contemplation alone, out of the many different formations of things that are without form, the activity of the seeds of all things arises from mere verbal utterance.

Lord of Secrets, furthermore, in conformity with all the tathāgatas and in harmony with the intentions of all sentient beings, fully delighting sentient beings, he abides like a reflection before the bodhisattvas who perform all activities and practice the conduct of secret mantra. That Tathāgata is free of conceptual thought and has wholly transcended the domain of the mind; yet although he has left behind time, place, deed, action, Dharma and what is not Dharma,

He bestows the state of omniscience
That arises from the practice of secret mantra.
Therefore one should accomplish
The siddhi of omniscience and the supreme state."
Then the glorious Vajradhara,
Filled with wonder, his eyes wide open,
At that time brandished his vajra,
Its light rays flying out like sparks,
And, having illuminated
This entire buddha field,
He addressed these sweet words
To the Sage, the lord of all dharmas:

"Though the entry into mantra has been explained,
That entry is still not understood.
Where secret mantra comes from
And where it goes, O Lord,
Please explain all of this to me.
There is no supreme state apart from you;
Just as the ocean is for all the waters,
So in you all dharmas abide."
When he had said this, the Blessed One declared to the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi:
"Great being, the abode
Of the maṇḍala is said to be the mind.
If one knows that the heart
Is the abode of secret mantra, one will attain the result.
White, yellow or red:

Whatever the mind conceives,
And the discernment of it,
That is the activity of mind.
Mind, satisfied and become certain,
Is what is called the heart.
The secret mantras abiding there
Will bestow vast results.
There one should imagine a lotus
Of eight petals, with its stamens,
And on it the syllable called a, wreathed in garlands of blaze.
The excellent one abiding there,
Peaceful, flickers on every side.
The Lord, possessed of manifold forms,
Like a thousand flashes of lightning,
Displays light on every side,
Like one abiding within a mirror,
Like the image of the moon in water;
In all things he abides before one.
The mantra practitioner, dwelling in the abode of secret mantra,
Having thus understood the mind,
Then, within emptiness,
In the center of the expanse of the brain,
Should imagine there the syllable called a,
Marked with the anusvāra.
Seeing it stainless and pure,
Like crystal, the moon or snow:
This is the peaceful body whose nature is Dharma,
Called the ground of all.
From it the siddhis of secret mantra,
Of manifold forms, are attained.
If one sees the abode of the Tathāgata,
One attains the higher realms and liberation through awakening.
Placing in the eyes the syllable called ra,
Blazing like a lamp,
Bending the neck slightly,
And joining the tongue to the palate,
Gazing into the center of the heart,

In equipoise one should look at the mind:
Stainless, utterly pure,
Ever abiding like a mirror.
This itself, the Victors of the past
Declared, is the true reality of mind.
On the path illuminated by the mind,
Consciousness becomes manifest.
Then the mantra practitioner
Will see the perfect Buddha, the lord of two-footed beings.
Having seen him, the mantra practitioner
Will constantly attain siddhi.
Then, transforming it as above,
The syllable to be fully contemplated,
The syllable called la with the anusvāra,
Should be imagined in the place of the eyes.
If one sees all this as empty,
One will attain the state that does not decline.
Mighty wisdom,
Or else the five superknowledges,
The siddhi of becoming a vidyādhara,
And becoming long-lived and youthful:
If one wishes to attain these,
As long as one has not performed the approach of this,
So long will one not attain them.
Arising from the wisdom of secret mantra,
This is that very supreme wisdom,
The protector of bodhisattvas,
The precious treasure of all the buddhas.
Buddhas, bodhisattvas
And the gentle śrāvakas as well,
Having attained the supreme wisdom of the buddhas,
Wisdom beyond compare,
Through it abide all over the earth,
And they speak of it there."
This concludes the extensive chapter on the reality of accomplishing siddhi from The Manifest Awakening, Emanation and Empowerment of the Great Vairocana.

Then again the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, please explain the empowerment of the deity's form, by which bodhisattvas who practice the conduct of a bodhisattva by way of secret mantra, focusing on the deity's form and transforming themselves into the form of their own deity, will attain siddhi without any doubt."

When he had said this, the Blessed One Vairocana declared to the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi: "Lord of Secrets, it is excellent, excellent that you ask me about this matter. Therefore listen well and keep it firmly in mind, and I shall explain it to you."

"Blessed One, so be it," he replied, and the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi listened to the Blessed One. The Blessed One then declared: "Lord of Secrets, the form of the deity is of three kinds: syllable, mudrā and image. The syllable, in turn, is of two kinds: sound and the awakening mind. The form of the mudrā is also of two kinds: with form and without form. Lord of Secrets, the form of the deity is likewise of two kinds: completely pure and not completely pure. The completely pure is of the nature of nonconceptuality, free of all signs. The not completely pure is form with signs, that is, color and shape. Through these two kinds of deity form two kinds of purpose are achieved: through the one with signs, siddhi with signs; through the signless, even siddhi with signs will be achieved.

The supreme Victors hold that through what has signs
Comes the siddhi that has signs;
By abiding in the signless,
One can accomplish what has signs as well.
Therefore, in every way,
One should rely on the signless."

This concludes the chapter on ascertaining the samādhi of the deity from The Manifest Awakening, Emanation and Empowerment of the Great Vairocana.

Then again the Blessed One declared to the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi: "Lord of Secrets, a bodhisattva who practices the conduct of a bodhisattva by way of secret mantra and wishes to accomplish the signless samādhi should reflect as follows: From where have signs arisen? Have they arisen from my body, or from my mind, or from my mentation? Now, the body is born of karma; like grass, wood or clods of earth, it has by its own nature no activity. It should be regarded as like an image made by craft, something inert, a mere external shape. If a man, enraged at such a crafted image, were to destroy it, burn it or cut it with fire, poison, weapons, water or a vajra, it would feel not the slightest

displeasure; and even if one were to honor it with food, drink, washing, ointments, incense, garlands, clothing, sandalwood, camphor and the many other kinds of requisites of gods and humans, it would not become pleased with that man.

Why is that? Whoever makes offerings to, or does harm to, that form which is empty of essential nature, out of false conception born of the error of fully grasping it with his own conceit, is of a childish nature. Lord of Secrets, in this way one should cultivate mindfulness that follows the body in the body as empty of essential nature.

Lord of Secrets, furthermore, one should reflect that the mind is without essential nature, free of all signs, and empty of essential nature. Lord of Secrets, in the mind there are no three times. One should reflect: 'What is free of the three times is by its essential nature free of signs.'

Lord of Secrets, furthermore, ordinary childish beings conceive the mentation as having signs; this is a mere verbal designation of false imagination. They do not understand that what is unreal is unborn.

Lord of Secrets, when a bodhisattva who practices the conduct of a bodhisattva by way of secret mantra reflects in this way, he will attain the signless samādhi. Lord of Secrets, when he comes to abide in the signless samādhi, then the secret mantras spoken by the Tathāgata will turn toward him and incline to him."

This concludes the chapter on the signless samādhi from The Manifest Awakening, Emanation and Empowerment of the Great Vairocana.

"Lord of Secrets, furthermore, I shall explain the secret of recitation.

By oneself alone, singly, or one by one,
One should recite mentally,
Or else in a whisper, in two ways;
This the supreme yogin should examine.
The mantra practitioner should not recite
In any other way, with its limbs left deficient.
The four-limbed recitation that I have taught,
Through outer and inner application,
Is worldly;
That which has a focus is unsurpassed.
Restrained by the words of withdrawal,
With a mind that follows the deity,
Reciting in a whisper is supreme;

This has been taught for the one that has a focus.
Know the mental one to be supramundane:
Withdrawal and the rest are wholly abandoned.
Making oneself one with the deity,
With a mind that holds them as not different,
One should make one's nature indivisible;
It is not to be done otherwise.
The count of secret mantra, three hundred thousand,
That I have generally taught
Is the number of recitations taught
For the pure mantra practitioner,
An embodied one free of sin;
It is not to be done otherwise."
This concludes the chapter on the reality of worldly and supramundane recitation from The Manifest Awakening, Emanation and Empowerment of the Great Vairocana.

Then again the Blessed One Vairocana, having looked upon the assembled retinue complete in every respect, and looking also with his two eyes of loving-kindness and great compassion upon all realms of sentient beings, entered into the samādhi called Source of Nectar. As soon as the Blessed One had entered into absorption, from all his limbs there came forth the queen of vidyā-mantras called the Powerful One Unattached in the Three Times:
tadyathā gaganasame apratisame sarbatathāgatasamatānugagate gaganabaralakṣaṇe svāhā
"Son of noble family, this queen of vidyā-mantras has a sphere of activity that is nondual with the body of all the tathāgatas.
Empowered by it, the buddhas
And the bodhisattvas of great renown
Attain the unattached nature of reality
Wherein suffering comes to cease."
Then the Blessed One Vairocana, bringing all the tathāgatas to mind, empowered both himself and Vajrapāṇi as primordially unborn, and declared to Vajrapāṇi and the other vajra holders: "Sons of noble family, listen to the extensive chapter on the practice of the maṇḍala called the Turning of the Wheel of Syllables, which, through the deeds of the buddhas, is present to each of the bodhisattvas who practice the conduct of a bodhisattva by way of

secret mantra."
Then again Vajrapāṇi bowed to the Blessed One Vairocana, descended from that vajra lotus seat in the manner of a vajra descending, and praised the Blessed One:
"Homage to you, awakening mind!
Homage to you, source of awakening!
To you, the form of conduct, and to the grounds
And the perfections, I pay homage.
Homage to you who make the beginning!
Bowing to emptiness, I pay homage."
Having praised the Blessed One in these words, the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, Lord of the Dharma, out of compassion for us, please explain those qualities which, if we possess them, will enable us to act for the benefit of sentient beings and to bring the practice of secret mantra to completion just as you have taught it."
When he had said this, the Blessed One Vairocana declared to the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi:
"I am the one proclaimed
The protector of the world, the first in the world.
I teach the Dharma that is unsurpassed,
Primordially peaceful, and without equal."
Then, having spoken those verses, the Blessed One performed an empowerment of such a kind that, empowered by it, those bodhisattvas and those vajra holders would see the Blessed One, seated upon the supreme and sacred seat of awakening, free of elaboration like space, in accordance with the karmic ripening that has the characteristic of the yoga nondual in conduct.

At that time, from the limbs of the Blessed One and from the whole body of the Tathāgata, there came forth this, which is like the life breath of all that is worldly and beyond the world, of śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, of intention and of what is to be done in meditative concentration, and of all who strive to accomplish siddhi; which has become the sustenance of all syllables, become their life breath, become their refuge, and become their ally:
namaḥ smantabuddhānāṃ a
"Sons of noble family, this, empowered by all the tathāgatas, is the deed of the buddhas present to each of the bodhisattvas who practice the conduct of a bodhisattva by way of secret mantra: all dharmas enter by way of the syllable called a. Lord of Secrets, therefore a bodhisattva who practices the conduct of

a bodhisattva by way of secret mantra, who wishes to see the tathāgatas, who wishes to make offerings, who wishes to realize the awakening mind directly, who wishes to keep company with bodhisattvas, who wishes to act for the benefit of sentient beings, who longs for siddhi, and who wishes to attain omniscience in all its aspects in every way, should apply himself to this heart of the tathāgatas."

Then, as to what the Blessed One Vairocana taught concerning the arrangement of the rite of this king of maṇḍalas, the Arising from the Heart of Great Compassion, the determination of the places of the deities, the emanation of samādhi, the practice of secret mantra and what is to be visualized: the master, abiding in the syllable called a, the gateway of omniscience, takes the cord and, having bowed to all the buddhas, stretches the cord along the eastern side and goes around clockwise; facing north he stretches the cord, and, facing west, he turns it and lays down the lines.

Then, empowering himself as Vajrasattva Vajrapāṇi with his mudrā or with the syllable called va, he should enter inside and draw the heart maṇḍala. Likewise for the second maṇḍala: empowering himself in this way as primordially peaceful, the form of nondual yoga, the very essence of the form of the Tathāgata, and then making manifest the abiding of the Tathāgata, he stretches the cord. Of that outer maṇḍala he should set two thirds as the place of the deities and make one third the place of the retinue. The remaining two maṇḍalas should likewise be divided and the places of the deities set out.

Then again, empowering himself as the Blessed One Vairocana with his mudrā, and empowering the vast dharmadhātu, he should first take the white pigment and empower it as follows:

"This is the pure dharmadhātu,
Which purifies the realm of sentient beings;
This is the self, the Tathāgata,
Who has abandoned every fault."

When the wise one has reflected thus,
There he should imagine the syllable called ra,
Peaceful in hue, with a garland of flames,
Like a conch, the moon or a kunda flower.
Then the second pigment,
The red, he should take, and diligently
Imagine the syllable called a,
Blazing, together with the anusvāra:
The Victor, holy and hard to overcome,

Like the sun when it first rises.
Then the mantra practitioner should take the third pigment,
Yellow in color.
Then the wise one should imagine the syllable called ga
At that time, according to the rite.
Likewise the Sage of golden light,
Golden in color and blazing,
Abiding in samādhi, destroyer of sin,
Illuminates all around.
Then the pigment like emerald,
Which liberates from saṃsāra:
There he should place the syllable called va.
The great Sage of the heart of awakening,
The hero, green in color,
Makes all fearless everywhere.
Then that black pigment
The wise one should take,
And there imagine the syllable called hā,
Radiating garlands of flame,
Unbearable like the fire at the end of time:
Vajrapāṇi, adorned with pointed tips,
Threatens in every way
All the hostile hosts of Māra.

Then the Blessed One Vairocana at that time arose from that samādhi and entered into the samādhi called Infinite Victory. As soon as the Blessed One Vairocana had entered into that samādhi, he brought forth this queen of vidyā-mantras called Unobstructed Power Everywhere, which arises from the domain of all the tathāgatas:

namaḥ sarbbatathāgatebhyaḥ sarbbamukhebhyaḥ asamebarame acale gagane smaraṇe sarbatrānugate svāhā

Then, having empowered the rite of the colors, one should read or bow to the Blessed Mother Prajñāpāramitā and recite this queen of vidyā-mantras eight times. Then one should rise, circumambulate the maṇḍala and enter inside; and, focusing on the practitioner through the power of great love and great compassion, one should empower oneself with the syllable called va as the Vajrasattva of activity, and, together with the bestowal of the sacred vajra, draw the maṇḍala Arising from the Heart of Great Compassion.

Now, this is the arrangement of the inner maṇḍala. In the center is the Blessed One, the Great Vairocana, seated on a white lotus, with a topknot of hair and a crown, wearing a lower garment of silk or cotton and an upper garment of fine silk, golden in color and wreathed in garlands of flame. He is drawn as a mudrā, as a form or as a seed syllable:

a

In the east is the essence of the dharmakāya of all the buddhas, the syllable called a together with the anusvāra:

aṃ

In the direction of Īśāna, the northeast, one should draw the mother of all the buddhas, the Blessed Lady Gaganalocanā, or else draw the syllable called ga:

ga

In the direction of fire, the southeast, one should draw the mudrā of all the bodhisattvas, the wish-fulfilling jewel, or the syllable called ka:

ka

In the north one should draw Padmapāṇi with his retinue, together with the bodhisattvas bound to one more birth, as the lotus mudrā or the syllable called sa:

sa

In the south, leaving three parts, one should draw the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi with his retinue, as the vajra mudrā or the syllable called va:

va

Leaving three parts beyond that, one should draw all the vajra holders as their mudrās or syllables.

Their seed syllable is:

hūṃ

Then, in the direction of Nairṛti, the southwest, below the Blessed One Vairocana, one should draw Acala, seated on a rock, holding a sword and a noose in his hands, wreathed in garlands of flame, threatening all obstructors, as his mudrā or his syllable. His seed syllable is:

haṃ

In the direction of the wind, the northwest, one should draw the one called Trailokyavijaya, the destroyer of the great obstructors, with garlands of upward-blazing flame, like the form of the fire at the time of the great destruction, who terrifies even the terrifying, holding in his hand a vajra that radiates light, as his mudrā or his syllable. His seed syllable is this:

ha

Then the four great protectresses are arranged in the four directions. In the east one should draw the great protectress called Fearless, golden in color, wearing white clothing, her face slightly wrathful, holding a staff in her hand, as her mudrā or her syllable. Her seed syllable is this:

ca

In the north one should draw the protectress called Remover of All Fears, white in color, holding a sword in her hand and wearing white clothing, blazing, free of all fear, as her mudrā or her syllable. Her seed syllable is this:

pa

In the west one should draw the protectress called Hard to Tame, the color of a red aśoka flower, wearing red clothing, smiling, gazing upon the maṇḍala of the complete retinue, as her mudrā or her syllable. Her seed syllable is this:

sa

In the south one should draw the great protectress called Vajra Tamer of the Untamed, black in color, her face wrinkled in wrath, wearing a black lower garment, with a topknot and a diadem, illuminating with her own blaze the whole world system complete in every respect, holding a staff in her hand, eliminating the great obstructors, as her mudrā or her syllable. Her seed syllable is this:

kṣa

All of these, too, together with their retinues and attendants, should be drawn seated on white lotuses.

When the intelligent one has arranged them thus,
The mantra practitioner devoted to mantra
Goes out according to the rite,
And in its proper place in the second section
Should draw the King of Sages,
Who brings delight to the Śākya clan:
The Protector, wearing saffron robes,
Endowed with the thirty-two supreme marks,
The god who acts for the sake of the teaching,
Who grants fearlessness to all sentient beings.
When the mantra practitioner sets out his mudrā,
It is the alms bowl, the robes and so forth;
Or else the wise one sets it down as a syllable.
This is its sacred rite:

bha

Then, in the outer maṇḍala, empowering himself as the essential nature of the dharmadhātu, with a mind that has become the awakening mind, he leaves three parts, recollects the Blessed One Vairocana three times, takes that same pigment, and in the third section on the east draws, as his mudrā or his syllable, the Bestower of the Sacred Vajra in youthful form, holding in his left hand a vajra atop a blue utpala, adorned with all ornaments, wearing a lower garment of silk or cotton and an upper garment of fine silk, colored like saffron, with five locks of hair on the crown of his head. His mantra is this:

namaḥ smantabuddhānāṃ maṃ

To his right one should draw Jālinīprabha in youthful form, endowed with the finest of all aspects, holding in his hand a net of jewels or a hook, as a mudrā or a seed syllable. His seed syllable is this:

cha

Then in the south one should draw the bodhisattva called Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin, golden in color, with a topknot and a diadem, holding a wish-fulfilling jewel in his hand, as his mudrā or his syllable. His seed syllable is this:

ā

Then in the north one should draw the bodhisattva called Kṣitigarbha, green in body color, holding a lotus in his hand, adorned with all ornaments, as his mudrā or his syllable. His syllable is this:

ī

In the west one should draw the bodhisattva called Ākāśagarbha, endowed with the finest of all aspects, wearing white clothing, blazing, holding a sword in his hand, as his mudrā or his syllable. His seed syllable is this:

ī

Then the mantra practitioner devoted to the dharmadhātu,
Having taken his seat,
With a mind become the awakening mind
Whose nature is the dharmadhātu,
Remaining facing the east,
Binds the vajra mudrā,
And then, having become the vajra of activity,
Should diligently make offerings.
With an all-pervading mind,
Having displayed the mudrā called

The Pledge of All the Buddhas, the Protectors,
He should recite the secret mantra three times.
The disciples, pure and according to the rite,
Are called before the maṇḍala
And made to go for refuge to the Three.
Then the awakening mind is generated as well.
He should bind all of them
With those mudrās whose nature is the dharmadhātu.
Then he binds the mudrā of the wheel of Dharma,
And, transforming their form with his mind,
Covers their faces with a cloth.
With a mind that has become compassion,
So that they may complete the accumulations for awakening,
He should not let their hands be empty.
This sacred pledge
He proclaims into the ears of all of them;
Then he himself binds them
To the pledge of the buddhas.
With a mind become the awakening mind,
He then has them cast a flower.
Wherever the flower falls,
That the mantra practitioner bestows on him.
For the sake of the pledge for all embodied beings,
The rite should be performed in this way.
Then the glorious Vajradhara
Again asked that Lord:
"O Protector, supreme among speakers,
Please teach the rite of empowerment."
When he had requested this, the Blessed One,
Devoted to the dharmadhātu,
Spoke thus to Vajradhara:
"For the sake of mastery over all dharmas,
I shall explain the supreme rite;
With mind gathered to one point, listen to the rite.
Lord of Secrets, the master should empower himself as the form of the Tathāgata with his mantra or his mudrā. Then he should call the disciples, place them upon the great king of lotuses whose essential nature is the

dharmadhātu, bind the mudrā of the Source of All Limbs, and confer empowerment upon them from the crown of the head with water from vases of four kinds of jewels, empowered by the four great bodhisattvas.

The wise one, having placed the syllable a
Together with the anusvāra upon the crown of the head,
Should place the one called a at the heart,
And place the one called ra at the chest.
Or else, place a everywhere.
Blazing with a golden color,
With topknot and crown,
Seated upon a white lotus seat,
The supreme Victor abides in meditative absorption.

This concludes the extensive chapter on the arrangement of the wheel of letters.

Then the Blessed Vairocana looked upon the assembled retinue, complete in every respect, and spoke thus to the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets: "Lord of Secrets, there is an extensive arrangement of mudrās that are the ornaments of the tathāgatas, the tathāgata ornaments that are the signs of realizing the dharmadhātu. When bodhisattvas adorned with them wander in saṃsāra, then, because in every realm of beings they are marked with the sign of the great awakening of all the tathāgatas, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, humans and nonhumans will give way before them, and those beings will also heed their words. Listen to it, and bear it thoroughly and well in mind, and I shall explain it to you."

When he had spoken thus, Vajrapāṇi said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, now is the time for it. Sugata, now is the occasion for it."

Then, at that moment, the Blessed One entered into the meditative absorption called Empowerment of the Abode of Unobstructed Power. As soon as the Blessed One had entered into it, there arose the queen of vidyā-mantras, possessed of Unobstructed Power Everywhere, possessed of power equal to the unequaled, who brings about entry into the samaya, and who is endowed with the three powers:

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ a same trisame samaye svāhā

Lord of Secrets, this queen of vidyā-mantras is the one through which all the tathāgatas teach perfectly, which keeps one from transgressing the boundaries of the path of the three dharmas, and which brings the grounds and the perfections to completion. Its mudrā is this: join the two hands with the palms hollowed, and raise the two thumbs.

This seal is the great mudrā
Of all the buddhas, the protectors.
The samaya of all the buddhas
Abides firmly in this mudrā.

The intelligent one should make
Both of the hands into fists,
Place the two thumbs inside,
And raise the two index fingers.
This seal is the great mudrā,
The full practice of the dharmadhātu.

The mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ dharmmadhātusvabhāva ātmako 'haṃ

Likewise, turn back all the fingers of the two hands, interlace them, and touch the two thumbs together.

This glorious mudrā
Is proclaimed the Wheel of Dharma.
With it the protectors, the lords of the world,
Turn the wheel in full.

The mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ vajra ātmako 'haṃ

Likewise, join the two hands with the palms together in homage, and place the two index fingers upon the two thumbs, making it like a sword.

The sword seal is the great mudrā
Of all the buddhas, the protectors.
With it one cuts through
The innate view of the transitory collection.

The mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ mahākhaḍga viraja dharmma sandarśika sahaja sadkāya dṛṣṭi cchedaka tathāgatādhimukti nirjāta virāga dharmma nirjāta hūṃ

Likewise, join the two hands with the palms hollowed, and wrap the two index fingers around the two thumbs, making it like a conch.

This supreme and glorious mudrā
Is proclaimed the Conch of Dharma.
With it, in these worlds,
The buddhas and bodhisattvas
Teach the stainless Dharma
That leads to peace, to nirvāṇa.

The mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ sarbbathā oṃ

Likewise, from the joined palms extend all the fingers of the two hands, making it like a bell; touch the tips of the two thumbs and the two little fingers together, and touch the two index fingers to the middle fingers.

This supreme and glorious lotus
Is the indestructible vajra seat
Of all the buddhas, the protectors.
Upon it the guides attain awakening,
And the Victors and all their heirs
Are born from it and attain awakening.

The mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ a

Likewise, make the two hands into fists, raise the two middle fingers side by side, bend the two index fingers and place them at the two sides, making it like a vajra. Raise the two thumbs and the two little fingers and set them so, and put the two ring fingers inside the hands.

The great mudrā, the vajra seal,
Destroys the city of ignorance.
This wisdom of the buddhas
Is revealed, empowered by itself.

The mantra is: namaḥ smanta vajrāṇāṃ hūṃ

Likewise, make the two hands into fists, raise the middle fingers side by side, and bend the two index fingers from the sides and join them.

The uṣṇīṣa mudrā is a great seal;
It is proclaimed the Uṣṇīṣa.
Merely by binding it,
One becomes a supreme Victor.

Its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ hūṃ hūṃ

Make the right hand into a fist and place it between the eyebrows.

This mudrā the holy Victors
Have proclaimed the Ūrṇā, the curl between the brows.
Merely by binding it,
One becomes a supreme Victor.

Its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ a haṃ jaḥ

The wise one, abiding in the manner of yoga,
Should hold the two hands level with the navel
In the manner of holding an alms bowl;
This is proclaimed the alms bowl mudrā.
This seal belongs to Śākyamuni
And is called the Great Alms Bowl.

Its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ bha

Likewise, raise the right hand upward, as in granting fearlessness.

Through it fearlessness
Is granted to all sentient beings.
When one binds that great seal,
It is proclaimed the mudrā of fearlessness.

Its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ sarbbathā jina jina bhayanāśana svāhā

Likewise, lower the right hand, as in granting the supreme boon.

This is the seal of granting the supreme,
So the protectors of the world have proclaimed.
Merely by binding it,
The supreme Victors will bestow the highest.

Its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ varada vajra ātmako 'haṃ svāhā

Make the right hand into a fist, extend the index finger, and make the brow like a wrathful frown.

This great mudrā, this great seal
Of all the buddhas, the protectors,
Is called Threatening Māra;
It destroys all who bring ruin.

Merely by binding it,
The utterly terrible hosts of Māra,
Obstructors and other vināyakas as well
Will flee, without any doubt.

Its mantra is this: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ mahābalavati daśabala tejodbhave mahāmaitryaṅhyudagate svāhā

Likewise, make the right hand into a fist, extend the two middle fingers and the two ring fingers, and place the thumb near them.

This is the eye, arisen from compassion,
Of the buddhas, the protectors.
The wise one should place it upon the eyes;
Through it one gains the eye of a buddha.

Its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ gagana vara lakṣaṇa karuṇamāya tathāgata cakṣuḥ svāhā

Likewise, join the two hands together and bind a fist with the fingers interlaced; raise the two index fingers, bend them, touch them together and make them round.

This is known as the supreme noose;
It destroys all who are hostile.
When the mantra practitioner binds it,
The hostile are bound forever.

Its mantra is this: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ he he mahāpāśa prasarodārya satvadhātu vimocaka tathāgata adhimukti nirajata svāhā

Likewise, join the two hands together and make fists; raise the index finger and bend its third joint, and let the rest remain in the manner of a bracelet.

This is explained as the hook
Of all the buddhas, the protectors.
Great-souled bodhisattvas
Who dwell on the ten grounds,
And others with hostile minds as well,
It summons them all.

Its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ a sarbbatra apratihata tathāgata aṃkuśa bodhicārya paripūraka svāhā

From the hook mudrā, bend the two middle fingers and join them right there. This is the mudrā of the Tathāgata's heart, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ jñānodbhava svāhā

From that same mudrā, raise the two ring fingers and keep the rest as they were. This is the mudrā of the Tathāgata's navel, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ amṛtoddhava svāhā

From that same mudrā, raise the little fingers and keep the rest as they were. This is the mudrā of the waist, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ tathāgata gati saṃbhava svāhā

Likewise, join the two hands with the palms hollowed; bend the two index fingers and put them inside, and do the same with the two ring fingers. Bend the thumbs and the two little fingers slightly, and raise the two middle fingers side by side. This is the mudrā of the Tathāgata's treasury, and its mantra is: namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ raṃ raṃ raṃ svāhā

From that same mudrā, take out the two ring fingers, raise them and set them so. This is the mudrā of sealing the great boundary, and its mantra is this: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ velupuri vikuri vikule svāhā This is the sealing of the great boundary.

From that, bend the two middle fingers and raise the two thumbs. This is the mudrā of great protection, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ tathāgatebhyaḥ sarbbabhayevigatebhyo viśvamukhebhyaḥ sarbathā haṃ khaṃ rakṣa mahābale sarbbatathāgata puṇya nirjāte hūṃ hūṃ traṭa traṭa apratihate svāhā This is the great protectress called Unbearable.

Likewise, extend the two index fingers and put the two thumbs inside. This is the mudrā called Blazing All Around, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ jvālamālini tathāgata arci svāhā This is Blazing All Around.

Likewise, join the two hands with the palms hollowed, and wrap them from the sides with the two index fingers. This is the mudrā of the Tathāgata's armor, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ pracaṇḍa vajra jaya visphura hūṃ This is the Tathāgata's armor.

From that same mudrā, join the two index fingers and the two thumbs together. This is the mudrā of the Tathāgata's tongue, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ tathāgata jihva siddhi dharmma pratiṣṭhite svāhā This is the Tathāgata's tongue.

From that same mudrā, bend the two index fingers and the two ring fingers and join them inside. Raise the two thumbs and bend them slightly, so that their tips face the middle fingers. Extend the two little fingers, and keep the two thumbs as before. This is the mudrā of the Tathāgata's great mouth, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ tathāgata mahāvāktre vijñāna mahodaya svāhā This is the Tathāgata's mouth.

From that same mudrā, release the index fingers, put them inside, make them crooked, and hold them pointed. This is the mudrā of the Tathāgata's fangs, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ tathāgata mahādaṃṣṭra sarasarāgra samaprabhāka sarbbatathāgata viṣaya saṃbhava svāhā These are the Tathāgata's fangs.

From that same mudrā, raise and hold the two index fingers, and bend their third joints. This is the mudrā of the Tathāgata's specific knowledges, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ acinta andhuta rūpa pāvaga saṃprati vidyā viśuddha svara svāhā These are the Tathāgata's specific knowledges.

Likewise, join the two hands together with the palms hollowed, put the two thumbs and the two little fingers inside, and touch them together. This is the mudrā of the ten powers, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ daśabala gadhara hūṃ saṃ jaṃ svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of the ten powers.

From that same mudrā, bend the two index fingers and join them to the tips of the two thumbs. This is the mudrā of the applications of mindfulness, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ tathāgata smṛti satva hita abhyuṅgata gagana sama sama svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of the applications of mindfulness.

From that same mudrā, hold the two ring fingers upon the thumbs. The mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ sarbbadharmma samatā prāpta tathāgata anugata svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra that bring realization of the sameness of all phenomena.

Likewise, join the two hands together, wrap the two middle fingers with the two index fingers, and keep the rest as they were. This is the mudrā of Samantabhadra's wish-fulfilling jewel, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ samantānugata virāja dharmma nirjāta mahā mahā svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of the wish-fulfilling jewel.

From that same mudrā, bend the two index fingers inside the two middle fingers and set them so; the rest are as before. Its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ aciteñjaya sarbbasatvāśayānugata svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of Maitreya.

From that same mudrā, put the two thumbs inside. The mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ ākāśa samatānugata vicitraṃ vara dhara svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of Ākāśagarbha.

From that same mudrā, put the two ring fingers and the two little fingers inside, and join the two index fingers together with the two middle fingers. The mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ ata satvahita abhyuṅgata traṃ traṃ raṃ raṃ svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin.

The fifth fascicle.

Likewise, join the two hands together and open all the fingers so that they are like a bell. Join the two thumbs and the two little fingers together, and make the rest like a lotus. The mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ sarbbatathāgata avalokita karuṇāmāya ra ra ra hūṃ jaḥ svāhā These are the lotus mudrā and the mantra of Avalokiteśvara.

Likewise, join the two hands with the palms hollowed, and make them like an unopened lotus. This is the lotus mudrā, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ jaṃ jaṃ sa svāhā These are the lotus mudrā and the mantra of Mahāsthāmaprāpta.

Likewise, make the two hands into fists and raise the two index fingers to a point, and place the two thumbs near them as well. The mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ tāre tāreṇi karuṇoṅbhave svāhā This is that of the goddess Tārā.

From that same mudrā, twist the two index fingers and raise them; the rest are as before. The mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ sarbbabhāva santrāsani hūṃ sphoṭaya svāhā This is that of Bhṛkuṭī.

Likewise, join the two hands with the palms hollowed, and put the two ring fingers and the two thumbs inside. The mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ tathāgata viṣaya sambhava padma mālīnī svāhā This is that of Pāṇḍaravāsinī.

From that same mudrā, raise the two thumbs upward, and set the tips of the two index fingers near them, separated by a gap of about a barleycorn. The mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ khāda bhañjasphoṭaya svāhā These are

the mudrā and the mantra of Hayagrīva.

From that same mudrā, raise the two ring fingers and the two little fingers upward as well, and keep the rest as they were, in the manner of a clenched fist. Its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ ha ha ha sunatanu svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of Kṣitigarbha.

Likewise, join the two hands with the palms hollowed, wrap the two ring fingers with the two middle fingers, and bend the two index fingers and set them upon the two thumbs; the rest are as before. The mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ he he kumāraka vimukti pathe stiṣṭhate smara smara pratijñāna svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of Mañjuśrī.

Make the left hand into a fist and bend the index finger. This is the hook mudrā of Jālinīprabha, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ he he kumāra yagata svabhāva sthita svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of Jālinīprabha.

From that same mudrā, make all the fingers crooked. This is the utpala mudrā of the youth Vimalaprabha, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ he he kumāra vicitra gati kumāra pratijñāmanusmara svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of Vimalaprabha.

Likewise, make the right hand into a fist, and raise the index finger and the middle finger upward side by side. This is the mudrā of Keśinī, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ he he kumāri kleśa cchedaya ājñānān smara pratijñāna svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of Keśinī.

Likewise, make the right hand into a fist and raise the middle finger upward, making it like the point of a spear. This is the spear-point mudrā of Upakeśinī, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ baṃndhaya ajñā he kumārike svāhā These are the spear-point mudrā and the mantra of Upakeśinī.

Make the two hands into fists, extend the two middle fingers, and join the two index fingers at their sides. This is the staff mudrā of Citrā, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ he kumārike ājñāna pura vidvaṃsani svāhā

Likewise, make the left hand into a fist and raise the ring finger and the little finger. This is the banner mudrā of Vasumatī, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ he sphura jñāna ketu svāhā These are the banner mudrā and the mantra of Vasumatī.

Make the right hand into a fist, raise the index finger, and bend its tip. This is the hook mudrā of Ākarṣaṇī, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ

ākarṣaya sarbbaṃ kuru ājñāna kumārasya svāhā These are the hook mudrā and the mantra of Ākarṣaṇī.

Likewise, make the two hands into fists, raise the two index fingers, and bend their third joints. The mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ avismayaniye svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of the female attendants.

Likewise, make the right hand into a fist, raise the middle finger, and bend its third joint. This is the vajra mudrā of the Wondrous One, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ vimaticchedaka svāhā These are the vajra mudrā and the mantra of the Wondrous One.

Likewise, raise the right upper arm and make the hand as in granting fearlessness. This is the mudrā of granting fearlessness, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ abhayandāta svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of granting fearlessness.

Make that same hand as though drawing something up from below. This is the mudrā of Apāyajaha, the Abandoner of the Lower Realms, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ abhyuṅdhara satvadhātuna svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of Apāyajaha.

Place that same hand at the chest. This is the mudrā of Paritrāṇāśayamati, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ he mahā mahā smara pratijñā svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of Paritrāṇāśayamati.

Make that same hand as though holding a flower. The mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ satve vajroddhava svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of Maitryabhyudgata.

Place that same hand at the heart and bend the middle finger inward. The mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ karuṇodbhava svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of Karuṇāmṛdita.

Likewise, make the right hand in the manner of granting the supreme boon. The mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ he he varada vara prāpta svāhā This is that of the Pacifier of All Torment.

Make that same hand in the manner of holding a wish-fulfilling jewel. The mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ sarbbaśa paripūraka svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of Acintyamati.

Likewise, make the two hands into fists, and bring out and extend the two middle fingers. This is the flower mudrā of Kṣitigarbha, and its mantra is:

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ ha ha ha vismaye svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of Kṣitigarbha.

Make the right hand into a fist and extend three fingers. This is the mudrā of Ratnākara, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ he he mahā mahā svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of Ratnākara.

From that same hand, extend the ring finger and raise it upward. The mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ radbhava svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of Ratnapāṇi.

Likewise, cross the two hands and join them back to back. With the left thumb hook the right little finger, and likewise with the right hook the left, and make the rest like a vajra. This is the mudrā of Dharaṇiṃdhara, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ dharaṇī prāpta svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of Dharaṇiṃdhara.

The mudrā of the One with the Jewel Mudrā in His Hand is the five-pointed vajra, as before. The mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ ratna nirjāte svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of the One with the Jewel Mudrā in His Hand.

From that same mudrā, spread the fingers apart. This is the mudrā of the One of Firm Intention, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ vajra saṃbhava svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of the One of Firm Intention.

Making the two hands in the same way is the sword mudrā of Ākāśagarbha, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ gagana nānta cara svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of the noble Ākāśagarbha.

The wheel mudrā, made as before, is the mudrā of Gaganamati, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ cakravarti svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of Gaganamati.

The conch mudrā, made as before, is the mudrā of Viśuddhamati, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ dharmma saṃbhava svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of Viśuddhamati.

The lotus mudrā, made as before, is the mudrā of Cāritramati, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ padma mālāya svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of Cāritramati.

The utpala mudrā as before, made unopened, is the mudrā of Gaganāmala, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ jñānodbhava svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of Gaganāmala.

The vajra, made as before, is the mudrā of Sthiramati, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ vajra kāra svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of Sthiramati.

Likewise, join the two hands together and put the two ring fingers inside. Raise the middle fingers, the two thumbs and the two little fingers, and bend the two index fingers at the sides of the middle fingers, keeping them apart by about a barleycorn so that they do not touch. This is the mudrā of Vajrapāṇi, the vajra, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta vajrāṇān caṇḍa mahāroṣaṇa hūṃ This is that of Vajradhara.

From that same mudrā, put the two thumbs and the two little fingers inside. This is the mudrā of Māmakī, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta vajrāṇāṃ triṭa triṭa jayanti svāhā This is that of Māmakī.

Likewise, join the two hands back to back, interlace the fingers with one another, twist them and bind them tight, pressing down the right thumb with the left thumb, and bind them. This is the mudrā of Vajraśṛṅkhalā, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta vajrāṇāṃ hūṃ bandha bandha moṭaya moṭaya vajrodbhave sarbbatra pratihate svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of Vajraśṛṅkhalā.

From that same vajra mudrā, bend the two thumbs slightly, and turn the two index fingers toward them as well. This is the vajra mudrā of Krodhacandra, the chief, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta vajrāṇāṃ hrīḥ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā This is that of Krodhacandra, the chief.

Likewise, make the two hands into fists and raise the two index fingers side by side. This is the mudrā of Vajra Point, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta vajrāṇāṃ sarbbadharmma nidana vajrā sūci varade svāhā This is that of Vajra Point.

Likewise, make the two hands into fists and place them at the heart. This is the mudrā of Vajramuṣṭi, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta vajrāṇāṃ ṭaya vajra saṃbhave svāhā This is that of Vajramuṣṭi.

Making the left hand into a fist, raising its index finger upward, and threatening as though in wrath is the mudrā of Hard to Tame, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta vajrāṇāṃ durdānta mahāroṣaṇa lādaya sarbban kuru

tathāgata ājñāna svāhā This is that of Hard to Tame.

Make the right hand into a fist, in the manner of striking.

This is the hammer mudrā of Abhimukha, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta vajrāṇāṃ he abhimukha mahācaṇḍa grīhṇa khādaya kiñcirayasi samayamanusmara svāhā This is that of Abhimukha.

Making the hand in the manner of holding an alms bowl, as before, is the alms bowl mudrā of Śākyamuni, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ sarbbakleśa nisūdana sarbbadharmma paśīta prāpta gagana sama svāhā This is that of Śākyamuni.

The ūrṇā mudrā is as before.

Join the tips of all the fingers of the right hand and place it upon the crown of the head. This is the mudrā of all the uṣṇīṣas, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ vaṃ vaṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā These are the mudrā and the mantra of all the uṣṇīṣas.

Make the left hand into a fist and extend the middle and index fingers, placing the thumb upon the tips of the ring finger and little finger. Put the index and middle fingers of the right hand into the left palm, and make the thumb as before as well. This is the mudrā of the protector Acala, the sword placed in its sheath.

That of Trailokyavijaya is the vajra, as before.

Likewise, join the two hands together and put the two ring fingers and the two little fingers inside. Raise the two middle fingers side by side, bend the two index fingers and place them at the third joints of the middle fingers, and make the two thumbs like eyes. This is the mudrā of the Mother of the buddhas and bodhisattvas; it is the uṣṇīṣa.

Extend the left hand with the palm facing down, make the right hand into a fist, and hold the index finger like a parasol. This is the mudrā of Sitātapatra, the White Parasol: the parasol. khaṃ

That of Jayoṣṇīṣa, the Victorious Uṣṇīṣa, is the sword, as before. śaṃ

That of Vijaya is the wheel, as before. siṃ

That of Vikiraṇa is the hook: make the right hand into a fist, bend the index finger, and set it so. hūṃ

That of Tejorāśi is the uṣṇīṣa, as before. The mantra is: tṛṃ

The mudrā of Mahodgata
Is known as the vajra mudrā. uṃ
The mudrā of Abhyudgata
Is the excellent lotus, as before. tuṃ
For Anantasvaraghoṣa,
I have explained, it is the conch. ruṃ

Making the right hand into a fist and placing it between the eyebrows is the ūrṇā mudrā, the wish-fulfilling jewel.

That of the Eye is the uṣṇīṣa, as before, but distinguished by being marked with a vajra. ga

Placing the right hand at the heart in the manner of holding a lotus, and extending the left hand as though slapping with the palm, is the mudrā of Aparājita. The mantra is: dhiṃ dhiṃ riṃ riṃ jiri jiri

Make the two hands into fists, and from raising the two thumbs upward, bend them. This is the mouth mudrā of the one called Aparājita. aparajita jayanti ṭite svāhā

Showing the right hand at the cheek is the mudrā of Īśvara.

From that same mudrā, hold the middle finger and index finger as though twisted. This is the mudrā of Samantakusuma.

From that same mudrā, put the thumb inside. This is the mudrā of Raśmimālin.

From that same mudrā, make the index finger and little finger as though holding a flower. This is the mudrā of Swift as Thought.

Place the thumb of the right hand upon the ring finger, extend the three, the index finger, middle finger and little finger, and place them above the ear; do the same with the left hand. This is the mudrā of Proclaimer of Sound.

Joining the two hands together, touching the tips of the two thumbs to make a circle, and bending the tips of the remaining fingers is the vase mudrā.

Likewise, making the right hand in the manner of granting fearlessness and placing the thumb inside is the mudrā of the One Without a Frown.

Make that same hand as in granting fearlessness, and place the thumb at the second joint of the little finger. This is the general mudrā of the sages; their order should be as is fitting.

Likewise, joining the two hands together, putting the two index fingers and the two little fingers inside, gathering the rest together and holding them raised is the club mudrā of Yama.

Turning the right hand face down and making it like a bell is the mudrā of Mṛtyu, the Lord of Death: the bell.

Likewise, making the left hand into a fist and raising the index finger and middle finger is the mudrā of Kālarātri.

From that same mudrā, raising the middle finger upward is the mudrā of Raudrī: the trident.

From that same mudrā, making it in the manner of holding a lotus is the mudrā of Brahmā.

From that same mudrā, joining the index finger to the third joint at the back of the middle finger is the short spear mudrā of Kaumārī.

From that same mudrā, place the index finger at the tip of the thumb. This is the wheel mudrā of Vaiṣṇavī.

From that same mudrā, raise the thumb upward. This is the mudrā of Vārāhī: the hammer.

From that same mudrā, make the hand like a vessel. This is the mudrā of Cāmuṇḍī: the skull cup.

The sword mudrā of Nairṛti is as before. The wheel mudrā of Viṣṇu is also as before.

Likewise, raising the two hands from the left side and circling them is the cloud mudrā of Nanda and Upananda.

From that same mudrā, raising three fingers upward is the trident mudrā of Śaṃkara.

From that same mudrā, making those fingers straight is the mudrā of Umāpati.

The mudrā of the Moon is the lotus, as before, but it should be made white in particular.

Place both of those hands side by side, palms turned up, and bend the two index fingers and the two ring fingers at the sides. This is the mudrā of the Sun: the chariot.

Join both of those hands together palm to palm, and make the middle fingers and the two ring fingers like a bow. This is the mudrā of Jayā and Vijayā.

The banner mudrā, as before, is that of Vāyu.

Likewise, turn the left hand up toward the navel, raise two fingers, and hold it so; turn the right hand toward it, and making it as though playing a vīṇā is the mudrā of Sarasvatī: the vīṇā.

The mudrā of Varuṇa is the noose, as before.

From that same mudrā of Sarasvatī, bend the index finger. This is the mudrā of the asuras, and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ garalayaṃ svāhā

From that same mudrā, extend the ring finger. This is the mudrā of the gandharvas, and its mantra is: viśuddha svara vahine svāhā

From that same mudrā, bend the index finger.

This is the mudrā of all the yakṣas, and its mantra is: yakṣeśvara svāhā

From that same mudrā, join the tips of the thumbs and the little fingers. This is the mudrā of the yakṣiṇīs, and its mantra is: yakṣa vidyādhārī svāhā

From that same mudrā, extend the middle finger. This is the mudrā of the piśācas, flesh-eating spirits, and its mantra is: piśāce gati svāhā

Bend that same middle finger and hold it so. This is the mudrā of the piśācīs, and its mantra is: mici mici svāhā

Likewise, join the two hands together and hold them with the two thumbs raised upward. This is the mudrā of all the planets (grahas), and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ graheśvarya prāpta jyotirmaya svāhā

From that same mudrā, join the middle fingers and the thumbs, turned back. This is the mudrā of all the lunar mansions (nakṣatras), and its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ nakṣadra niranādanīye svāhā

From that same mudrā, bend the two ring fingers and place them in the palm. Its mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ rākśasādhipataye svāhā This is the mudrā and mantra of the rākṣasas.

Place the right hand at the mouth so that it touches the tongue. This is the mudrā of the ḍākinīs, and its mantra is: namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ

Lord of Secrets, these and others like them are the countless mudrās of the tathāgatas, arisen from the tathāgatas' resolve, which have become the signs

of the bodhisattvas. Yet, Lord of Secrets, however many movements of the limbs there may be, all of them should be understood as extensive mudrās; and however many movements of the tongue there may be, all of them should be understood as the teaching of mantra.

Therefore, Lord of Secrets, bodhisattvas who practice the bodhisattva conduct by way of the gateway of mantra should, with a mind endowed with the awakening mind, abide on the ground of the Tathāgata and draw the maṇḍala. Should they do otherwise, they would deceive the buddhas and the bodhisattvas, and awakening as well; and because they have transgressed the sacred commitment, they will certainly go to the lower realms.

From The Manifest Awakening of the Great Vairocana, His Miraculous Manifestation and Empowerment, the extensive chapter on the sequence of the mudrās.

Then the Blessed One spoke to the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi: "Lord of Secrets, listen to the Dharma discourse on the gateway that enters everything. Lord of Secrets, here the bodhisattva should abide in the syllable called a and accomplish every aim.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ aḥ namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ saḥ namaḥ smanta vajrāṇāṃ vaḥ ka kha ga gha ca cha ja jha ṭa ṭha ḍa ḍha ta tha da dha pa pha ba bha ma ya ra la va śa ṣa sa ha ṅa ña ṇa na

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ a namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ sā namaḥ smanta vajrāṇāṃ vā kā khā gā ghā cā chā jā jhā ṭā ṭhā ḍā ḍhā tā thā dā dhā pā phā bā bhā mā yā rā lā vā śā ṣā sā hā dā ñā ṇā nā

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ aṃ namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ saṃ namaḥ smanta vajrāṇāṃ paṃ kaṃ khaṃ gaṃ ghaṃ caṃ chaṃ jaṃ jhaṃ ṭaṃ ṭhaṃ ḍaṃ ḍhaṃ taṃ thaṃ daṃ dhaṃ paṃ phaṃ baṃ bhaṃ maṃ yaṃ raṃ laṃ vaṃ śaṃ ṣaṃ saṃ haṃ ṅaṃ ñaṃ ṇaṃ naṃ

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ aḥ namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ saḥ namaḥ smanta vajrāṇāṃ vaḥ ka kha ga gha ca cha ja jha ṭa ṭha ḍa ḍha ta tha da dha pa pha ba bha ma ya ra la va śa ṣa sa ha ṅa ña ṇa na i ī u ū e ai o au

"Lord of Secrets, thus this is the Dharma discourse on skill in the way of letters. It is the rite of abiding in the way of mantra, the rite of taking up the deity; it is blessed with the blessing of all the tathāgatas, it is skill in the way of the perfectly awakened buddhas, and it is the music of practicing the bodhisattva conduct. The buddhas, the blessed ones, of the past, present and

future have taught it, teach it, and will teach it. Lord of Secrets, I have not seen any among the countless buddhafields in which this Dharma discourse, the gateway that enters the tathāgatas in all their aspects, is not taught.

"Therefore, Lord of Secrets, bodhisattvas who practice the bodhisattva conduct by way of the gateway of mantra, if they wish to know the rites of mantra, should apply themselves diligently to this Dharma discourse on the gateway that enters everything. When ka, ca, ṭa, ta and pa are joined with a first, a last and a middle, then, by entering the host of meditative absorptions, they bring about the attainment of awakening, of the conduct, and of perfect buddhahood together with nirvāṇa. Therefore, in the rites of mantra, those letters that bear the designations 'first' and so on should be understood as occurring together with a first, a last and a middle, and one should apply them to each and every word of the mantras as one wishes.

When they are understood by the intellect,
They are the unsurpassed and supreme state.

"Thus this is a single wheel; revolving all around like a wheel, it is the wheel of letters. If a mantra practitioner knows this wheel of letters, he will always shine with splendor, just as the Blessed One Vairocana does when he turns the wheel."

The sequence of the way of letters, the Dharma gateway that enters all aspects.

Then again the Blessed One, having gazed upon all the realms of sentient beings with the eye of a tathāgata, in order to fulfill completely his vow to rescue all sentient beings without exception by this very display of the inexhaustible array of the dharma realm and by this accomplishment of the conduct of mantra, entered into the meditative absorption called Possessing the Essence of the Array of the Tathāgatas' Equality, the Empowering Might of the Treasury of the Dharma Realm. As soon as the Blessed One had entered into absorption, at that very moment, from all his pores, the gateways that bring about the deliverance of every realm of sentient beings without exception, there came forth bodies born of the dharma realm, which, in accordance with their wishes, gratify each and every sentient being individually, in the forms, colors, shapes, voices, gaits, conduct and definitive words of those who experience the fruits of action, lifespan and karmic maturation and of those who cause them to be experienced.

Having come forth, they made it known with a single voice, pervading the dharma realm, throughout the countless world systems equal to space, and proclaimed this verse on the coming forth of the tathāgatas:

"That characteristic of dharmas from which
All dharmas without exception,
The buddhas and the śrāvakas,
The protectors who are pratyekabuddhas,
The heroic bodhisattvas,
And likewise the supreme victors,
Sentient beings and the vessel world,
Arise in sequence as designations,
And from which the arising and abiding
Of dharmas always come forth:
This path, endowed with wisdom and means,
Free from doubt and hesitation,
And well taught by the perfect buddhas,
Is the path that you should cultivate."

Then those tathāgata bodies that had arisen from the dharma realm filled the entire dharma realm completely with clouds of emanations that made their own bodies known, and by the mere power of the mind of the Blessed One Vairocana they blessed the arising of buddhas, one after another in succession, from all his pores, and then entered each into its own place in the dharma realm.

Then again the Blessed One spoke to the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi: "Lord of Secrets, there is the arrangement of the secret maṇḍala, the contemplation of the places of the deities as properly established, marked with their seed syllables. Listen to it, and keep it well and thoroughly in mind, and I shall explain it to you."

When he had spoken thus, the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi listened to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One said to him:

"First the mantra practitioner
Should set out that maṇḍala upon his own body.
From the feet up to the navel
He should imagine it as earth.
Then above that, as far as the heart,
The one diligent in vows should imagine water.

Above the water is that of fire,
And above the fire is wind.
Having imagined this, the wise one
Should then set up the image on the ground."

Then Vajrapāṇi, having entered the ground of the body, speech and mind of the Blessed One Vairocana, looked upon the equality of dharmas, and, considering the people of the future, spoke this king of vidyā-mantras that cuts off all doubts:

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ asamapati dharmma dhātu kārya gati gatānāṃ sarvvathā aṃ khaṃ aṃ a saṃ sa haṃ ha raṃ ra vaṃ va svāhā hūṃ mahā svāhā raṃ ra svāhā

As soon as the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi had spoken this great king of mantras, all the tathāgatas dwelling in the world systems of the ten directions stretched out their right hands, placed them on the crown of Vajrapāṇi's head, gave their approval with "Excellent!" and spoke these words:

"Son of noble family, excellent, excellent, that you, having entered the ground of the body, speech and mind of the Blessed One Vairocana, have spoken this king of mantras out of the wish to make it manifest to the bodhisattvas who abide in equality in the way of mantra in every respect! Why is that? The Blessed One Vairocana, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, seated at the seat of awakening, examined the dharma realm by means of these twelve words and defeated the four māras. These words, arisen from the dharma realm, came forth from the three places, and the evil māras were subdued. Then the Blessed One, having attained the equality of body, speech and mind, attained a measureless body, because space is measureless; and likewise he also attained measureless speech and mind. Thus, being endowed with measureless wisdom and having gained mastery over all dharmas, he teaches the Dharma on the basis of these very twelve words, the king of mantras. Son of noble family, because you too have entered the equality of the body, speech and mind of the Blessed One Vairocana, you appear just like a perfect buddha.

"Ask the omniscient, perfect Buddha,
The Blessed Vairocana,
For the supreme words of mantra practice,
And he will declare the rite in full.

We too, in the past, by means of these,
Realized unsurpassed awakening
And taught the incomparable Dharma
Of the path by which beings go to nirvāṇa;
The perfect buddhas dwelling
In the world systems were our witnesses."

Then glorious Vajradhara,
His mind supremely delighted,
Blessed by the perfect buddhas,
Spoke these words:
"These dharmas are without characteristics,
Without essential nature, without abode,
Liberated from action and from life,
And are held to be like the perfect buddhas.
Through the skillful means of the protectors,
Who wield the sovereignty of compassion,
By their emanations, these characteristics
Of dharmas come to be realized."

Then the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi, having spoken that verse of inspired utterance, looked upon the beings of the future, and, in order to cut off doubts about this great maṇḍala arisen from the essence of great compassion, made this request of the Blessed One Vairocana:

"For the sake of all sentient beings,
O Omniscient One, free from all ailment,

You who cut off every doubt,
O Guide, this is what I ask of you:
What is to be done before the maṇḍala?
May the Guide declare it.
Great Sage, of how many kinds
Are the master and the disciple said to be?
What sort of ground should be sought,
And how should it be purified?
How does the ground become pure,
And how is it made stable?
By what is the disciple's purpose served?

May the Guide declare the purification too.
What are the signs of purity like,
And by what are they to be protected?
By what is the ground to be blessed,
And by what is it first examined there?
To lay out the lines on the portions of the ground,
How many kinds of thread are needed?
How many kinds of offering are needed?
What sort of flowers and incense,
And how should flowers and incense
Be offered? May the Guide tell this.
The food offerings and the rites of fire offering,
With which rites, and how, are they performed?
And the seats of the deities,
Tell for whom, and with what, they are made.
Their colors, shapes and forms as well,
May the Protector tell them in their order.
The deities and the mudrās,
And the measure of the seats, please explain.
From where have the mudrās arisen,
And why are they called mudrās?
How many kinds of empowerment are needed?
How many kinds of sacred commitment are there?
How does the mantra practitioner,
Diligent in the practice of mantra,
Become a bodhisattva and omniscient?
How does he come to see the truth?
How many kinds of accomplishment are needed?
Please declare the time of accomplishment as well.
Having accomplished it, how does one travel through the sky,
And how does one become invisible?
And, O Lord, without casting off this body,
How does one obtain the body of a god?
The various emanations,
From where do they arise for him?
Sun and moon, fire and the directions,
The lunar mansions, the planets and the stars,

The moments and the instants,
Old age, death and decline,
And all ill omens,
How is it that they do not arise for him?
How is the mantra practitioner never parted
From the Buddha, chief of the two-footed?
The rites of fire offering and the fires,
How many kinds of satisfying offering are needed?
And the individual essential nature
Of the deities, may the Guide tell.
Of the worldly mantras
And likewise of the transcendent ones,
The measures, the fruits and the numbers,
The distinctions of meditative absorption,
Where does each kind of karma ripen,
And how does it not ripen?
When will the mantra practitioners
Be liberated from karma and from life?"

Then the omniscient, perfect Buddha,
The Blessed One free from all ailment,
Spoke these words to Vajradhara:
"Arising from the root of great compassion,
The arrangement of the secret maṇḍala,
The precise determination of the deities,
The supreme state of the Great Vehicle,
Fully taught by the perfect buddhas:
Great hero, what you have asked
Is excellent indeed.
To you, Vajrapāṇi of great strength,
I shall explain it in brief.
The things to be done before the maṇḍala,
Listen to them with a gentle mind.
Wishing for their individual rites,
One who knows the method should, as is fitting,
Abide in his own meditative absorption
And recite, in proper order,

The king of vidyā-mantras of great might,
From which the twelve-limbed words arise.
The master who has realized and knows the mantras and mudrās
Should be known to be of two kinds;
By the distinction of profound and not profound
His characteristics should be known.
The one who knows the profound vastly
Places no trust in embodied things;
He is the supreme son of the buddhas,
Having wholly given up the things of this life.
The second, intoxicated
By the things of this life, has a reference point.
The buddhas, supreme among the two-footed,
So that he may draw
All the worldly maṇḍalas,
Give him their permission and confer empowerment as well.
By the distinction of timely and untimely,
Disciples should be known to be of four kinds:
One is to be accomplished at once,
One is accomplished in two stages, and one is neither.
The disciple complete in every characteristic
Is the most excellent of the victors.
The ground that is to be known first
Should be explained as the ground of mind.
The purification was taught before;
By that it should be purified completely.
When it is free of faults,
The ground of mind is without fear;
Then it is pure,
Having wholly given up every fault.
Because it sees manifest awakening,
Therefore it is called stable.
Purifying the ground in any other way,
It will not become pure.
Whatever mantra practitioner
Purifies the ground while abiding in conceptual thought,
Because he has abandoned the awakening mind,

O Lord of Secrets, it is not cleansed.
Therefore, having given up conceptual thought,
One should purify every ground.
Of the extensive rite of the maṇḍalas
That I have taught,
What was taught at the very beginning
The deluded do not understand:
As long as conceptual thought,
Which has become the cause of suffering, is not given up,
There is no buddha in this world,
Nor is anyone to be called omniscient.
The disciples should be diligently
Purified with the awakening mind.
Protection should be performed by the protector Acala
Or by Trailokyavijaya, victor over the three realms.
When the disciple, by his focus,
Never wavers at all,
Then, like stainless space,
He becomes perfectly pure.
The first blessing of the ground
Is said to be done by the perfect buddhas;
The second is by the power of the mind;
Here it is not done otherwise.
The threads are taught to be of four kinds:
White, yellow, red,
And black, so they are declared;
The fifth is taught to be like space.
Holding it in the sky,
One should examine the maṇḍala there.
With the second kind of thread
One should lay out the maṇḍala on the ground.
The seat of all the buddhas
And of their wise sons
Is the supreme lotus born of mind,
Auspicious and praised by the worlds.
The pratyekabuddhas and the arhats,
Renowned for their partial knowledge,

Should be known to have as their seat
A petal grown from the lotus.
Whatever worldly gods there are,
Brahmā and the others renowned in the world,
Their seat is a red lotus,
Praised by kings.

Those of the ordinary deities are as befits them,
Or follow the distinctions of their ground.
Offerings should be known to be of four kinds:
Prostration with palms joined together,
Likewise love and compassion,
And the worldly flowers and incense.
The flowers that arise from the fingers
Should be offered to all the protectors.
Binding the mudrā from which all limbs arise,
Cultivate the awakening mind,
And to each and every protector
And to their sons, perform it with diligence.
These are flowers without fault,
Most fragrant and lovely,
Trees of the dharma realm
That have arisen to honor the victors;
Transformed by the power of meditative absorption,
They are blessed by mantra.
Arising from the dharma realm,
Many vast and sublime clouds
Then fall continually like rain
Before the eyes of the buddhas.
For the other, ordinary deities
These flowers are proclaimed;
One who knows his own mantra tantra in full
Should offer them as is fitting.
Likewise flowers and scented ointments
Should be imagined as is fitting.
Joining the thumb and the ring finger
Is said to be the auspicious mudrā;

Taking up the flower with it,
Offer it from the region of one's own heart.
For the worldly deities,
It is said, from the level of the navel.
Incense, with the Vajramuṣṭi
Or else with the lotus garland,
Should be held up in the air
And offered to the protectors and saviors of the world;
And besides those, to the worldly
Deities in their proper order.
By the distinction of outer and inner,
The fire offering should be known as twofold.
Liberation from karma and from life,
And the seed arising once again:
The fire offering performed by one who wishes for this work
Is called the inner fire offering.
The outer one has three components,
Has three places, and abides in three;
Accomplishing the work of the three kinds of rite,
It is the supreme worldly fire offering.
Those who, not knowing the rite of fire offering,
Perform it in some other way,
Have abandoned the knowledge of mantra;
Such fools will not obtain the fruit.
The mantras of the tathāgatas,
And likewise those spoken by the perfect buddhas,
Should be known as white and yellow.
The mantras of all the Vajrapāṇis
And of Lokeśvara
Are white, according to the distinctions of the rites.
Square on every side,
And then, in order, circular,
Triangular, and like a half moon:
These are the shapes, well explained.
Forms should be known to be of two kinds,
Female and male.
Or else, everywhere, the colors,

Shapes and forms of all
Arise from inconceivable wisdom;
Therefore they are inconceivable.
The wisdom of the Knower of wisdom
Becomes diverse for the sake of beings.
However great the extent of the mind,
Just so great should be understood
The seats and the mudrās,
And the measure of the deities, in their order.
From that from which the buddhas arise,
From that the mudrās arise as well.
Disciples born of the Dharma
Should be sealed with the seal of the Dharma.
Therefore, in brief, the dharma realm
Is taught to be the sign and the mudrā.
Empowerment should be known to be threefold;
Therefore, listen with care.
The empowerment conferred by mudrā,
Free of rites and activities,
The empowerment of the protectors:
That is supreme, and it is the first.
The second is truly taught to be brought about
Through rites and activities.
The third should be known as mental,
Free from place and time.
Having pleased the guru well,
Whatever beneficial words he speaks:
That this empowerment is supreme
The perfect buddhas have proclaimed.
In brief, according to the buddhas,
Those who hold the sacred commitment are taught to be of five kinds.
The one who has seen this maṇḍala
Is called the first knower of the sacred commitment;
To him the mudrās are not shown,
Nor should the mantras be given.
By virtue of the awakening mind,
He takes up the mantras and the mudrās;

This one, called "seeing the maṇḍala,"
Should be known as the second holder of the commitment.
One who sees the maṇḍala and the mudrās,
And is also engaged in the rites and activities,
But has not been given the transmission by the guru,
Is also said to know the sacred commitment.
One to whom the mudrās and the drawing of the maṇḍala
Are then taught according to the rite
Is also a mantra practitioner who lacks the empowerment
From which secret wisdom arises.
The mantra practitioner empowered by the rite
In the center of the secret maṇḍala
Should be known as the fifth knower of the sacred commitment;
No other is called a holder of the commitment.
When one of excellent discipline
Cultivates the mind for the sake of awakening,
The mantra practitioner who does not apprehend the three spheres
Is a bodhisattva.
Having generated the courage of skillful means,
When he applies himself to the aims of beings,
Having attained a conduct without any reference point,
He should be known as the supreme victor.
Whoever, toward the dharmas that are peaceful from the very beginning,
That have no essential nature,
Abides with a mind like Mount Meru,
He sees the truth.
This is true, this is genuine,
And in the same way it does not deceive;
Just as the buddhas see the truth,
So did I see it in the past.
Whoever has attained the awakening mind,
What accomplishment other than that does he need?
Yet apart from that, accomplishments
Are held to be of five kinds:
Following the conduct,
Likewise subduing the grounds,
The worldly superknowledges, held to be five,

Buddhahood, and whatever else there is.
As long as karma, passing
From one continuum to another, is not exhausted,
And its ripening has not ripened,
That is held to be the time of the accomplishments.
In brief, when at one and the same time
Karma and birth have been cast away,
Then too the mantra practitioner obtains
Accomplishment truly arisen from the mind.

The sixth fascicle.

Traveling through the sky once accomplished
Is just like a fearless illusion;
Bewildering others with the net of mantra,
It is just like a great magical display.
That which has no body and no speech,
Just like a city of the gandharvas,
Is what is called becoming invisible;
He abides there in that.
Just as, in the dream of one asleep,
One goes to the Heaven of the Thirty-Three
Without casting off the body,
And yet the body itself did not go there,
So too, through yoga itself,
Mantra practitioners who abide in mantra,
Through deeds of merit,
Obtain a body like a rainbow.
Arising from body, speech and mind,
Mantra is like a wish-fulfilling jewel;
From it the aims one has conceived
Come forth even without deliberation.
Just as space in all the directions
Is not stained by any conditioned domain,
So too the mantra practitioner
Is not stained by any domain of conceptual thought.

When all of this, as mere perception,
Has been cultivated in this way,

When it is thoroughly cultivated, that mantra practitioner
Rejoices together with the perfect buddhas.
The fire offering, which the Buddha,
Chief of the two-footed, taught as twofold,
Is the outer and the inner,
Together with the satisfying offering.
Having fully known the individual
Natures of the deities,
He has well taught the measures
Of the worldly mantras:
Īśvara and the other mighty ones,
Whatever deities are honored,
The mantras and mudrās of great power
That they have made
Mostly bestow their fruit at once;
That is the measure that is taught.
Yet, being subject to arising and perishing,
They have no stability.
The transcendent mantras
Have no original maker.
Having cut off all karma and birth,
The victors free from the three faults,
The pratyekabuddhas who are like the rhinoceros,
And likewise the śrāvakas of the victors,
And the bodhisattvas too,
Taught of old the measure of mantra:
It wholly transcends the three times;
It arises from dependent origination,
Bears fruits both seen and unseen,
And arises from speech, mind and body.
The measure of the worldly fruit
Is taught to be a single eon;
The fruit of the mantras
Of the perfectly complete Buddha transcends the eons.
The meditative absorption of the buddhas, the great sages,
And of the victors' sons
Is signless and pure;

The worldly one is accompanied by signs.
In this very ripening
The fruit of karma comes to ripen.
When accomplishment is attained,
Then karma too is turned back.
Because the mind has no essential nature,
Having given up causes and effects,
Liberated from karma and from life,
It becomes like space.

"Lord of Secrets, furthermore, there is the arrangement in the form of mudrās, set out in sequence, the blessing of the presence of the deities, the perfect awakening by which the buddhas of the past manifestly and perfectly awakened, for the sake of the aims, benefit and happiness of the bodhisattvas who have realized the five meditative absorptions, who practice the bodhisattva conduct by way of the gateway of mantra, who have realized the dharma realm and made it their domain, and who have vowed to deliver the realm of sentient beings without exception. Listen to it, and keep it well and thoroughly in mind, and I shall explain it to you."

Saying, "Blessed One, I wish to hear it just as you say," Vajrapāṇi listened to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One spoke to him as follows:

"Lord of Secrets, as for what comes first, the sequential arrangement of the maṇḍala of the perfectly complete Buddha: there is the one called Arisen from the Essence of Great Compassion, from which countless worldly and transcendent maṇḍalas have arisen, more secret even than the secret. Listen to the rite for drawing it.

"On a ground square on every side,
With a single gate and a terrace,
Marked with excellent vajras,
In the center an eight-pointed vajra;
Upon it draw a lotus,
Made elaborate together with its seed syllables.
Above that a great lotus,
Beautified with the mudrā of the anusvāra,
Its eight petals well complete,
With its anthers, most excellent.

On all the petals
The twelve-limbed words are arrayed.
In their center sits the Protector,
The perfect Buddha, chief of the two-footed,
Encircled on every side
By the retinues of the eight maṇḍalas.
This maṇḍala arisen from compassion
Should be known as supreme;
The maṇḍalas according to the scriptures,
The rites, the bodies, the accomplishments,
And the arrangements too, one with a gentle mind
Should know to have arisen from this.

"Lord of Secrets, furthermore, the maṇḍala of the tathāgatas:

"Like the disk of the moon, its color
Like a conch; in its center
The triangle of all the buddhas
Rests upon a white lotus,
Inscribed with the sign together with the anusvāra
And marked with the sign of the vajra.
Without need of deliberation, all around,
Rays should be made, twofold;
Arising from the Lord of mantras,
They go forth into the ten directions.

"Lord of Secrets, furthermore,
The maṇḍala of the lord Avalokiteśvara,
Listen to it with certainty and with care.
On a ground square on every side,
In the center place something like a conch;
Above it a lotus
Should be drawn in full with its seed syllables.
Above that again a great vajra,
And above the vajra a great lotus,
All marked with seed syllables;
Apply each one's own seed syllable well.
Tārā and Bhṛkuṭī,
Likewise Pāṇḍaravāsinī,

The vidyā Bhogavatī,
And Mahāsthāmaprāpta too, with care,
All the glorious ones and the female attendants,
In the center of this maṇḍala,
The signs of their mudrās, those who have gained mastery,
Should be drawn with special care.
The place for Hayagrīva
Is set in the form of a triangle,
Inscribed with the excellent signs of the maṇḍala,
Its color like the rising sun;
Together with the vidyā kings,
The wise one should arrange it.

"Lord of Secrets, furthermore, I shall explain your own maṇḍala in brief.

"On a ground square on every side,
Marked with the signs of the vajra,
All yellow and pleasing,
In the center a lotus firmly set.
What should be made in its center
Is a vase like the light of the moon,
Marked with the signs
And adorned with the anusvāra.
Above that again the great wind,
Its color like the rain clouds of summer;
The mantra practitioner makes it with waving banners,
Adorned with the anusvāra as well.
Above that again a triangle,
Of most terrifying form,
Like the fire of destruction,
Inscribed with the sign of the three-pronged design,
Massed with garlands of flame, fearsome to behold,
Like the form of the rising sun.
In its center a great lotus,
Like the light of the fire at the end of time.
Upon the great lotus a vajra,
Radiating garlands of flame,
Resounding with the sound hūṃ,

Marked with the sublime seed syllables.
Hero, this maṇḍala of yours
Has been taught by the chief of the victors.
Māmakī and Śṛṅkhalā,
And likewise those arisen from the vajra family,
Vajrāṅkuśa and Vajra Point,
The mighty kings of mantra,
All of them should be included
Within the great maṇḍala.
So that the rites may be fully accomplished,
The mudrās, maṇḍalas, seed syllables,
And the distinctions of color, in their order,
Should be made as is fitting.

Then, furthermore, there are these great Vajradharas,
Who are taught as the chief ones:
Stainless Space, Encircled by Vajras,
Vajra Fang, the Gentle One,
The Renowned One of great fortune,
Vajra Protector, Holder of the Supreme,
Peaceful Vajra, Great Vajra,
Blue Vajra, the Other Vajra,
Vajra Lotus, the Wide-Eyed,
Excellent Vajra, Vajra Itself,
Abiding Free of Elaboration,
And Moving through Infinite Space.
Their maṇḍalas, it is rightly taught,
Are white, yellow, red,
And black.
Then, furthermore, the forms of the mudrās:
Three-pronged and single-pronged,
And also two-pronged and not two-pronged,
Like a garland, and likewise others;
They are to be known from the distinctions of color.
All of these are of great power,
And are endowed with victory.
The maṇḍala of the protector Acala

Is held to be of wind and of fire.
Below my seat,
In the direction of Nairṛti, it should be drawn.
Furnished with his own seed syllable as its sign,
The sword mudrā should be well arranged,
Or else a noose may be made;
The wise one should draw it.
And for Trailokyavijaya, the Victor over the Three Worlds,
Specifically, in the center of the wind maṇḍala,
Endowed with the emblem of the vajra bearer,
Set in three places.

Lord of Secrets, furthermore, there is the arrangement of the maṇḍala of the forms of the mothers of the bodhisattvas. There, first of all, the maṇḍala:

It is gold in color and square,
Marked with the signs of the vajra;
This is the sublime maṇḍala.
Then, furthermore, the form of the goddess:
In its center is a great lotus,
Yellow throughout and ablaze.
There too the uṣṇīṣa is to be placed,
Set in three parts;
Leaving aside the middle part,
There the Eye should be drawn,
Abiding in the midst of her own blazing light.
In brief, it should be furnished with the seed syllable.
For all the bodhisattvas
The Victor taught the wish-fulfilling jewel.
Its maṇḍala, it is taught,
Is of water, with doors on every side,
Utterly stainless, perfectly peaceful,
Fulfilling every hope.
Then, gentle one, listen also
To the maṇḍala of Śākyasiṃha.
There, the one called Mahendra,
Adorned with yellow color,
Perfectly square and even;

In its center a vajra, as before;
Upon it a lotus
Should be placed, yellow throughout;
Upon that a great alms bowl,
Marked with a vajra and ablaze;
Or else the robes and the ringed staff
Should be placed in order.
The five uṣṇīṣas that have been proclaimed:
Know their mudrās as follows.
For Sitātapatra, make a parasol.
For Jayoṣṇīṣa, the Victor's uṣṇīṣa, wise one,
The sign should be placed as a sword,
Made to radiate rays of light.
Vijaya's is a wheel;
Vikiraṇa's is held to be a hook.
That of Tejorāśi of great fortune
Is held to be an excellent uṣṇīṣa.
Mahodgata's is a vajra;
Abhyudgata's is held to be a lotus.
The conch is Anantasvaraghoṣa's,
To be known from the distinctions of color.
The ūrṇā's is the wish-fulfilling jewel.
For the Eye, listen also to this:
An uṣṇīṣa, yellow throughout,
Is marked with the signs of the vajra.
Aparājitā has
A hand holding a wondrous lotus.
The one called Aparājita
Dwells on a wide-open dark lotus.
Those known as the gods of the Pure Abodes,
Whose sphere is the realization of purity:
Gentle one, listen to the arrangement
Of the characteristics of their mudrās.
The hand of courage, the hand of virtue,
And likewise the smiling hand,
The hand holding flowers, and the hand of space:
These should be drawn according to the full rite.

The earth goddess Pṛthivī's is a vase,
In a water maṇḍala marked with a vajra.
The hand of devotion is Agni's;
It should be drawn together with the sages:
Kāśyapa and Gautama,
Mārkaṇḍa and Garga,
Vasiṣṭha and Aṅgiras,
Abiding within the place of fire.
With the Vedas in their hands, carefully,
Draw them in their order.
Yama's staff is to be drawn
Within the wind maṇḍala.
Mṛtyu's is a bell;
Kālarātri's mudrā is a banner.
Raudrī's is a trident;
Brāhmī's is remembered as a lotus;
Kaumārī's is a short spear;
Vaiṣṇavī's is a wheel;
Yama's consort is known by a mallet;
Bhairava's consort's is a human skull.
These are to be included
Within the wind maṇḍala,
Surrounded by vultures, crows,
Dogs, and jackals as well.
One who wishes the rites to be accomplished
Should draw them as is fitting.
For Nairṛti, draw a sword;
For Viṣṇu, make a wheel;
Skanda's is a short spear.
Nanda and Upananda are two clouds,
Both together with lightning,
Their forms dark blue, with water;
At the two sides of the door
Of Śākyasiṃha's maṇḍala they are to be set.
Śaṃkara's is a trident;
Umā's is taught to be a raised trident.
A white vase together with a lotus

Is remembered as the mudrā of the Moon.
The Sun's is said to be a chariot
Resting upon a Mahendra maṇḍala.
Jayā and Vijayā
Have bows bearing the Mahendra sign.
In the direction of the wind, for the Vāyus,
A banner mudrā should be drawn.
Sarasvatī's is a vīṇā.
Varuṇa, the Waters, is drawn holding a noose;
The maṇḍala of that great being
Should be known to be of water.
It should be planted with the seed syllables
And marked with the signs.
In the maṇḍala of Śākyaketu,
With these and other signs,
The maṇḍalas are made in their order;
The mudrā placed in their center
Should be furnished with the seed syllables.
Furthermore, listen carefully
To the maṇḍala of Varadavajra.
Perfectly square and even,
Marked with the signs of the vajra;
In its center is to be made
A maṇḍala arisen from fire.
In its center the mudrā to be placed
Is a beautiful utpala, as it is called,
Of wise Mañjughoṣa,
Made radiant by his own mantra.
Its place, according to the rite,
Is planted with his own seed syllable.
The outer rim, all around,
Should be covered with utpalas.
In its center are to be drawn
These heroes, in their order.

There, the mudrā of Jālinīprabha is a hook. That of the youth Ratnamukuṭa is a jewel. That of the youth Vimalaprabha is an unopened utpala.

Those who are known as the messengers
Of wise Mañjughoṣa,
Fearless one, should be known
As is fitting.
The mudrā of Keśinī
Should be known to be a sword.
Upakeśinī's is a trident;
Citrā's is taught to be a staff;
Vasumatī's is said to be a banner;
Ākarṣaṇī's is a hook.
All of these are to be marked
With the signs of the utpala.
These are the mudrās
Of the female attendants as described.
In the southern direction, with care,
The mudrā of Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin of great diligence
Is to be drawn well:
It is what is called the wish-fulfilling jewel,
Abiding within a fire maṇḍala,
Together with his retinue, in their order.
In the elaboration of the retinue,
These mudrās should be known.

The mudrā of Adbhuta is a single-pronged vajra upon a vase. That of Abhayaṃdada is the hand granting fearlessness. That of Sarvāpāyajaha should be made as a hand drawing upward as if from below. That of Paritrāṇāśayamati is the hand of compassion placed at the breast. That of Mahāmaitryabhyudgata is a hand holding a flower. That of Karuṇāmṛḍitamati is a hand placed at the heart with the middle finger bent inward. That of Sarvadāhapraśamita is a hand in the boon-granting gesture with a stream of water trickling from the fingers. The hand of the one endowed with inconceivable intelligence, Acintyamati, holds a wish-fulfilling jewel. All of these too are to rest upon lotuses and be included within the maṇḍala.

In the northern direction, the mudrā of Kṣitigarbha:
Abiding within a Mahendra maṇḍala,
The seat is to be placed as before.
Upon it is a great lotus,
Possessing every color and ablaze;

Upon that a great banner,
At whose tip a great jewel is set.
That is the supreme form;
Here it is taught as the form of the mudrā.
His retinue is countless,
The chief's qualities are infinite;
There, their mudrās as well
Are to be carefully produced and drawn.

The mudrā of Ratnākara is a three-pronged vajra resting upon a jewel. That of Ratnapāṇi is a single-pronged vajra resting upon a jewel. That of Dharaṇiṃdhara is a two-pronged vajra resting upon a jewel. The mudrā of Ratnamudrāhasta is a five-pronged vajra resting upon a jewel. That of Dṛḍhādhyāśaya is a crossed vajra resting upon a jewel. All the mudrās are to be included within the maṇḍala.

In the western direction, the mudrā of Ākāśagarbha:
In a lovely water maṇḍala,
Upon a great seat of a white lotus,
In its center a sword and a noose,
The blade supreme in the keenness of its edge,
Planted with his own seed syllables:
The learned one should place them there.
His retinue is to be drawn
As the forms of their mudrās, in their order.

There, the mudrā of Stainless Space is a wheel together with its marks, in the center of a wind maṇḍala. The mudrā of Gaganamati is a conch in the center of the maṇḍala. The mudrā of Viśuddhamati is a white lotus resting in the center of a wind maṇḍala. The mudrā of Cāritramati is an utpala placed upon a conch in the center of a wind maṇḍala. The mudrā of Sthiramati, too, rests upon a vajra lotus in the center of a wind maṇḍala.

From The Manifest and Complete Awakening of the Great Vairocana, His Miraculous Manifestation and Empowerment, this is the chapter on the secret maṇḍala.

Then again the Blessed One taught the rite for entering the secret maṇḍala:

The mantrin, thoroughly trained,
Learned in the secret maṇḍala,

Should then burn away all the disciple's wrongdoing
In accordance with the rite.
So that it may not arise again,
His very life should also be burned.
And once he has been burned and turned to ash,
He should be revived once more.
With the syllable, the immutable, burn;
With life, revive him once more.
Once all has been revived with life,
He is wholly pure and stainless.
The words of the twelve limbs
Should be set upon him at that very moment.
This pledge of the protecting bodhisattvas
And of the buddhas
Is honored by the buddhas, the śrāvakas,
And the worlds.
Whoever knows this pledge
That abides in the center of the secret maṇḍala
Has entered into all the tantras
And has mastery over every maṇḍala.
That mantra holder is like me;
The one who keeps the pledge is to be treated as no other.

This is the chapter on entering the secret maṇḍala.

Then the Blessed One Vairocana looked upon the maṇḍala of the entire assembly and said to the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi: "Lord of Secrets, for bodhisattvas who practice the conduct of a bodhisattva by way of secret mantra, there are eight secret mudrās together with their secrets, the rites by which they know themselves to have become stable in the form of the deity, and, having known this, abiding in the manner of their own deity, they attain the siddhis. They bless the place of the deity, are marked with their own secret mantras, are endowed with maṇḍalas, and are to be performed in the yoga of one's own deity. What are these eight mudrās?

"Join the two hands so that they are hollow, and spread the two little fingers and the two index fingers like flames. This is the mudrā of the arising of the Blessed One's own splendor. Its maṇḍala is triangular, marked with a triangle pattern and ablaze. The secret mantra is namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ raṃ ra

svāhā.

"From that same mudrā, bend the two index fingers and hold them upon the thumbs like a banner. This is the mudrā of the Blessed One's indestructible vajra. Its maṇḍala resembles a blazing syllable, with a blazing vajra. The secret mantra is namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ vaṃ va svāhā.

"From that same mudrā, extend the middle and ring fingers, and keep the rest as before. This is the mudrā of the lotus womb. Its maṇḍala resembles the disk of the moon and bears the sign of the lotus. The secret mantra is namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ saṃ sa svāhā.

"From that same mudrā, put the two little fingers underneath. This is the mudrā of the ornament of the array of the Buddha's voice. Its maṇḍala is like the full moon, with banners, and marked with the double dot of the visarga.

The secret mantra is namaḥ samanta buddhānāṃ haṃ ha svāhā.

"Likewise, join the two palms so that they are hollow, separate the two thumbs, and make the rest slightly cupped. This is the mudrā of the arising of all the limbs of the Blessed One. Its maṇḍala is a vase resembling the moon, marked with a vajra. The secret mantra is namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ aṃ a svāhā.

"From that same mudrā, bend the two middle fingers and keep the rest as they were. This is the mudrā of the Blessed One's dhāraṇī. Its maṇḍala resembles a rainbow and is endowed with all the signs; a vajra banner is raised. The secret mantra is namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ buddhadhāraṇi smṛtibaladhāraṇīkari dhara dhara dhāraya dhāraya sabhagavate ākārāvāti asame svāhā.

"From that same mudrā, put out the two middle fingers, bend the two little fingers with the two middle fingers, and join them at the crown of the head. This is the mudrā of the Blessed One's abiding Dharma. Its maṇḍala has all the colors of the sky and is marked with the double dot of the visarga. The secret mantra is namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ aveda vedye a svāhā.

"From that same mudrā, hold the two middle fingers crossed over each other. This is the mudrā of the Blessed One's holding of yoga. Its maṇḍala is space, especially blue, bearing the anusvāra, and majestic. The secret mantra is namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ mahāyoga yogīnī yogeśvarā khañjarike svāhā.

"Lord of Secrets, these are the secret mudrās. Since they are the utmost secret of the tathāgatas, do not give them to anyone at all other than those

who have been empowered, who are of noble family, who are enthusiastic, steadfast in their commitments, respectful toward the guru, grateful, scrupulously clean, and who have no regard even for their own body and life."

From The Manifest and Complete Awakening of the Great Vairocana, His Miraculous Manifestation and Empowerment, this is the chapter on the eight secret mudrās.

Then again, at that time, the Blessed One, the Great Vairocana, looked upon the beings of the future and entered into the samādhi called Following All. As soon as the Blessed One had entered into it, this buddhafield became level like the palm of the hand. It was adorned with archways and porticoes richly ornamented with the five kinds of jewels, made vast by raised banners of many colors, and spread with canopies of great jewels. Jeweled bells, white yak-tail whisks, and many silks and cloths were hung there, and jeweled pillars were erected in the eight directions. It was filled with lotus ponds brimming with fragrant water possessing the eight qualities, resounding with the calls of geese, ruddy geese, and swans, and adorned in the eight directions with trees bearing the various flowers of every season. It was well encircled with garlands and threads of the five kinds of jewels. Its ground was pleasant to the touch and exceedingly soft, like soft kācalindika cloth, and many kinds of delightful and melodious sounds of drums and cymbals resounded there. It came to possess seats, dwellings, and mind-born celestial palaces gathered through the merit of many bodhisattvas.

There also arose a great king of lotuses, born from the inclination of the tathāgatas and marked with the sign of the realization of the dharmadhātu. In its center abided the body of the Tathāgata, intent upon the dharmadhātu, satisfying sentient beings in accordance with their intentions and inclinations. From all the limbs of that tathāgata there arose bodies endowed with irresistible power, born from inclination toward the ten powers, adorning themselves with many kinds of colors and shapes, and produced through the merit of the perfections of generosity, moral discipline, patience, diligence, meditative concentration, and wisdom over many hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of eons. Having arisen, they made their voice heard throughout all world systems and spoke this inspired utterance:

"How wonderful! The wisdom and means
Of all the buddhas are inconceivable.
Having realized what has no abode,

They teach a Dharma that has an abode.
Those for whom the characteristic
Of the nature of dharmas is not found,
Through that knowledge attain the attainment
That all the guides have attained."

When they had spoken that inspired utterance, they entered once again into the inconceivable dharmakāya of the Tathāgata.

Then the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi: "Son of noble family, listen to the inner maṇḍala. Lord of Secrets, the ground of the body is to be blessed with the blessing of the mantra and mudrā whose nature is the dharmadhātu, because it is pure by nature. Then, having blessed oneself as the Vajrasattva of action, one should imagine the following. Free of all dust, free of the faults that are the thorns of a self, a sentient being, a life principle, a nourisher, a human being, one born of Manu, an agent, and so on, it is square with four gates, the western gate always open, and adorned with archways and terraces. In its center has arisen a great, mind-born king of lotuses, eight-petaled, with its stalk, its anthers fully developed and exceedingly beautiful. In its center, again, imagine the body, speech, and mind of the Tathāgata, transcending all worlds, having perfectly gone beyond the ground of mind and attained the ground of mind, bestowing the special fruits that are desired.

"To its east is the tathāgata Ratnaketu. To the south is the tathāgata Saṃkusumitarājendra. To the north is the tathāgata Dundubhisvara. To the west is the tathāgata Amitābha. In the southeastern quarter is the bodhisattva Samantabhadra. In the northeastern quarter is Avalokiteśvara. In the southwestern quarter is Mañjuśrī Kumārabhūta. In the northwestern quarter is Maitreya. On all the anthers draw the mothers of the bodhisattvas, the six perfections, and the samādhis. Below, draw the vidyā-mantras and the hosts of wrathful ones. On the stalk is Vajrapāṇi. All the rest is the great ocean.

Lamps, flowers, and incense,
Food offerings and fragrant smoke, arisen from the mind:
For the sake of the pledge of embodied beings,
The mantrin should imagine them all.
And on all the ground below,
The countless gods and the rest

In this maṇḍala of the great being
The mantrin should carefully generate and draw.
Having thoroughly purified his own body
By himself with the syllable called ra,
The mantrin sits upon the seat of yoga,
Recollecting the tathāgatas.
On the crowns of the disciples' heads
He places the syllable a together with the anusvāra;
Then, fearless in his own person,
He has them cast a flower.
Having examined them, he should teach them,
Or else he may give them a vidyā-mantra.
For the sake of the pledge of embodied beings,
This is held to be the chief maṇḍala.

From The Manifest and Complete Awakening of the Great Vairocana, His Miraculous Manifestation and Empowerment, this is the extensive chapter on the procedure for leading disciples into the secret maṇḍala.

Then Vajrapāṇi, for the sake of those who practice the conduct of a bodhisattva by way of secret mantra, asked the Blessed One Vairocana in melodious verse about the observance of the vidyā-mantra:

"How is the observance to be practiced?
How does one abide in moral discipline?
Wherever and however one may abide,
How does one act without attachment?
When how much time has passed
Does the observance become complete?
Please tell me what its power is,
And where it is to be carried out.
Free of time, place, and activity,
Rid of Dharma and what is not Dharma,
How does it come about swiftly?
Guide, please declare its measure too,
That by which siddhi is attained,
As the buddhas taught it in the past,
For the sake of the beings of the future.
Perfect Buddha, chief of those who walk on two feet,

I ask you, the Omniscient One;
Chief of the victors, be my witness."

When he had made this request, the Blessed One,
The Great Vairocana, at that time,
Out of love for sentient beings,
Spoke these words:
"Vajrapāṇi of great might,
Great being, excellent hero,
Keep firmly the sublime observance
Taught by the buddhas of the past.
That by which siddhi is attained
Which brings benefit to the world:
The observance arisen from the vidyā observance;
Abide in it as the buddhas do.
Having generated one's own reality,
The mind ever free of doubt,
When one is constantly in meditative equipoise,
Then the observance is practiced.
When the awakening mind, the dharmas,
The training, action, and whatever result there is
Come to possess a single characteristic,
The moral discipline that has abandoned deeds and activity
Is called discipline like that of the buddhas;
Otherwise one is not called endowed with discipline.
When one has gained mastery over all dharmas,
Has grasped the realization of the aims of beings,
And gold and stone have become the same,
One swiftly acts without attachment.
From among the counts of secret mantra,
However many hundred thousands are taught,
When that much time has passed,
The observance becomes complete.
In the manner of Mahendra,
Abiding in a Mahendra maṇḍala,
Binding the vajra-holder's seal,
One should always drink milk as one's food;

Fully restraining breath and exertion,
The mantrin should recite for one month.
Then, in the second month,
Endowed with the water maṇḍala,
Having bound the lotus mudrā,
One drinks water as one's food at that time.
Then, in the third month,
Intent upon the aspect of fire,
Eating food one has not taken up,
And endowed with the sword mudrā,
One should burn away all the wrongdoing
Arisen from body, speech, and mind.
In the fourth, being joined with wind,
One should always take wind as one's food.
Then one binds the wheel mudrā,
And in equipoise recites the secret mantra.
Having remained intent in yoga
Upon the aspects of Mahendra and of water,
In the waxing fortnight of the moon,
Then, in the fifth month,
Having abandoned gain and lack of gain,
When the mantrin is wholly without attachment,
He becomes like a perfect buddha.
Having joined himself with wind and fire,
Free of every fault,
Having abandoned gain and lack of gain,
He should recite in a further month.
Śakra, Brahmā, and the other gods,
Piśācas, mahoragas, and rākṣasas
Will bow to him from afar,
And all of them will protect him as well.
All of them will heed his word
And will act according to his command.
The medicinal herbs, humans, and gods,
The vidyā-mantras and all the secret mantras
Will say, 'What shall we do?'
And will remain in his presence.

Obstructors, malicious vināyakas,
Rākṣasas, and the mātṛkās,
When they see the holder of secret mantra,
Will bow to him from afar.
Wherever the knower of mantra dwells,
Abiding in the vidyā observance,
That place blazes like a fire
Of utter destruction and becomes fearsome to them.
He attains every rank of lordship;
Gentle one, like a perfect buddha,
He is the glorious tamer of those hard to tame,
A great vajra holder, an ascetic,
Bringing benefit to all beings,
Compassionate like Lokeśvara.
When six months have passed,
He attains the desired fruit of siddhi,
And he always brings benefit
To himself and to others as well."

From The Manifest and Complete Awakening of the Great Vairocana, His Miraculous Manifestation and Empowerment, this is the extensive chapter on the observance of the vidyā-mantra.

Then again Vajrapāṇi asked the Blessed One about the essence of the secret mantras and of the maṇḍalas:

"What is the essence of all the secret mantras?
Knowing what does one become a master?"
When he had made this request, the Blessed One,
The Great Vairocana, at that time
Said to Vajradhara:
"Excellent, excellent, great being!
More secret than the secret of wisdom,
That from which the wisdom of secret mantra greatly arises
I shall explain to you, my son;
Listen with an undistracted mind.
The syllable a is rightly taught
To be the essence of all the secret mantras.
The secret mantras that arise from it,

Countless as they are, come forth;
And all the wisdom that pacifies
Every conceptual elaboration is born."

"Lord of Secrets, how is the syllable a the essence of all the secret mantras?

"The perfect Buddha, chief of those who walk on two feet,
Has said that a is the chief.
Therefore all of this, everything,
Abides throughout all the limbs.
The limbs too, as is fitting,
Always come to know in every way.
The letters pervade everything,
And the letters too are pervaded by it.
Within the letters sound arises,
Arising from part upon part.
Therefore all of this, everything,
The body, arises from variety.
Its arrangement has been rightly taught;
Gentle one, listen to the essences.
Having placed the essence at the heart,
Set the limbs upon the limbs.
The wise one, seated upon the seat of yoga,
Makes his own body into the body of a perfect buddha,
And recollecting the tathāgatas,
Should do all of this.
When one comes to know the vast wisdom
In accordance with the rite,
Then the buddhas of great power
Declare that one to be a master.
Therefore that one is the Tathāgata;
That one is called the perfect Buddha.
The buddhas and the bodhisattvas,
Brahmā, Viṣṇu, Maheśvara,
The Sun, the Moon, Varuṇa,
Śakra, and the Lord of Creatures,
Time and Yama too are that one;
He is Pṛthivī, the earth goddess, and Sarasvatī;

He is a brahmin and one who has performed the ritual bath,
And he is also called a celibate practitioner;
A glorious monk whose defilements are exhausted,
The holder of all secrets,
The Omniscient One and the All-Seeing One,
The chief lord of all dharmas;
One who is steadfast in the awakening mind,
Who is devoted to knowing sound,
Unattached to all dharmas,
Should be known as knowing all in every aspect.
The one on whose body
All the wheels of letters abide
Is the mantrin, the holder of secret mantra,
The glorious king of mantra, Vajradhara.
In the middle between the brows, the syllable hūṃ
Is the ground of the Vajra Holder.
At the chest is the syllable called sa,
Which is called the ground of Padmapāṇi.
I am placed at the place of the heart,
The lord of all, the Sovereign.
With all the variety of moving and unmoving things
Everything without exception is pervaded by me.
The one called a is the supreme life;
The one called va is taught to be speech;
The one called ra is said to be fire;
The one called hūṃ is taught to be the wrathful one;
kha should be known as space;
The anusvāra is called the supreme of emptiness.
One who knows this is called a master;
This is the truly sublime.
Therefore, in every way,
If one always strives at this
Which is called the mantra of the perfect Buddha,
One attains the state free of death and transmigration."

From The Manifest and Complete Awakening of the Great Vairocana, His Miraculous Manifestation and Empowerment, this is the chapter on knowing

the reality of the master.

How the letters are to be set out
Has been well taught by the perfect Buddha;
Therefore listen to it in full.
ka should be known to be at the gullet;
kha should be placed at the palate;
ga should be known to be at the throat;
gha is placed at the place of the neck.
ca should be placed on the tongue;
cha is placed at the middle of the tongue;
ja at the tip of the tongue;
jha at the root of the tongue.
ṭa should be known to be at the calves;
ṭha should be placed at the thighs;
ḍa is taught to be placed at the waist;
ḍha is placed at the two feet.
ta is taught to be placed at the bladder;
tha should be known to be at the belly;
da is placed at the two armpits;
dha is placed at the two sides of the ribs.
pa should be known to be at the back;
pha should be known to be at the chest;
ba is placed at the two shoulders;
bha is placed at the two hands;
ma is placed at the seat of the mind;
Then it should be known properly.
ya is said to be the male organ;
ra is taught to be the eyes;
la, which should be known as vast,
Is the forehead of that protector.
i ī are said to be the two eyes;
u ū are taught to be the armpits;
e ai should be known as the two ears;
o au are held to be the two cheeks.
aṃ is the state of the perfect Buddha;
aḥ is nirvāṇa.
Having come to know all of this according to the rite,

Through the supreme observance become a buddha!
The one in whose heart the treasure
Of the wealth of omniscience always abides
Knows all things in the world;
Gentle one, he is like the Omniscient One.

From The Manifest and Complete Awakening of the Great Vairocana, His Miraculous Manifestation and Empowerment, this is the chapter on the arrangement of the letters.

Then again Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, please explain the bases of training of the bodhisattva great beings, embraced by skillful means and wisdom, endowed with which the bodhisattva great beings will be free of doubt and hesitation and will not decline while they circle in saṃsāra."

When he had made this request, the Blessed One Vairocana looked upon the entire dharmadhātu with the eye of a tathāgata and said this to Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets: "Lord of Secrets, listen to the teaching on skill in the way of the bodhisattva's conduct, abiding in which the bodhisattva great beings will come to comprehend the realization of the Great Vehicle.

"Lord of Secrets, in this regard the bodhisattva should turn away from killing, from taking what is not given, and from sexual misconduct. He should turn away from lying, harsh speech, slander, and idle chatter. He should turn away from covetousness, malice, and wrong view. Lord of Secrets, these are the trainings of the bodhisattva, training in which one trains in conduct equal to that of the buddhas, the blessed ones, and the bodhisattvas."

Then again Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, said this to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, the Blessed One has also taught these ten paths of virtuous action in the Śrāvaka Vehicle. Blessed One, since worldly non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) too take up these ten paths of virtuous action and abide in them, Blessed One, what distinction is there in this? What difference is there?"

When he had asked this, the Blessed One said to Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets: "Excellent, excellent, Lord of Secrets! Lord of Secrets, that you have asked the Tathāgata about this matter, Lord of Secrets, you have done well. Therefore, Lord of Secrets, listen to the Dharma discourse that teaches the mode of thorough differentiation and the single mode.

"Lord of Secrets, the training that I have taught to the śrāvakas is not endowed with skillful means and wisdom; it carries out what has been commanded, and it is the realization of a partial knowledge. Therefore it and these ten paths of virtuous action are not the same. Worldly people engage in them out of attachment to things as their own, and on account of conditions supplied by others. Bodhisattvas who go by the Great Vehicle, because they enter into the sameness of all phenomena, do not depend on others; embraced by skillful means and wisdom, they engage in accomplishing the benefit of themselves, of others, and of both. Therefore, Lord of Secrets, bodhisattva great beings should strive to engage in all phenomena embraced by wisdom and skillful means."

Then the Blessed One, having looked upon the realms of sentient beings with the eyes of great loving-kindness and great compassion, said to the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi: "In this regard the bodhisattva should turn away from deliberately taking life. He should lay down the rod and give up enmity. He should protect the lives of others just as he does his own. The exception is when, toward such a person and in such a circumstance, he takes the evil upon himself and performs that act; and even that he should do without enmity, with a mind that has become compassion.

"He should turn away from taking what is not given. He should not even give rise to attachment toward the wealth that others possess, so what need is there to speak of taking others' wealth without its being given? The exception is when he sees sentient beings who are miserly and stingy, who do not give and do not make merit: what he does toward such persons in order to rid them of miserliness. Then he himself, without any attachment to it, should give gifts on their behalf. From time to time he should speak in praise of giving. If the bodhisattva were to give rise to attachment or desire for that wealth, Lord of Secrets, know that the bodhisattva has fallen away from the limbs of awakening and has incurred a transgression that cannot be remedied in the Dharma and Vinaya.

"He should turn away from sexual misconduct. He should not even give rise to a mind of desire toward women who are the wives of others, or who are protected by their family, by a sign, or by the Dharma; so what need is there to speak of engaging with what is not the proper organ, or of joining the two organs? The exception is acting in such circumstances.

"He should turn away from lying. Deliberately, even for the sake of his life, he should not speak a false word by which the awakening of the buddhas would be betrayed. For such a transgression against the awakening of the buddhas, Lord of Secrets, is the great lie of a bodhisattva who abides in the Great Vehicle. Lord of Secrets, by this explanation too you should understand that one should never abandon truthful speech in this way.

"Furthermore, Lord of Secrets, he should turn away from harsh speech. He should speak to sentient beings words that are gentle, soft, and pleasing to the mind. Why is that? Because, Lord of Secrets, soft speech is what comes first when the bodhisattva acts for the benefit of all sentient beings. The exception is the bodhisattva's speaking harshly, in those various situations, to sentient beings who bear the causes of terrible destinies.

"Furthermore, Lord of Secrets, he should turn away from slander. He should act in such a way that there is no division and no harm. Bodhisattvas are not engaged in dividing sentient beings. The exception is when he sees sentient beings sunk in such standpoints of view: dividing them in such a manner that those beings come to be firmly established in this single mode of omniscience.

"Furthermore, Lord of Secrets, the bodhisattva should turn away from idle chatter. He should speak words that suit the place, the purpose, and the time, that follow the meaning, that are pleasing to all sentient beings, and that move along the pathway of the ear. Why is that? Because the bodhisattva is endowed with many kinds of speech. The exception is when the bodhisattva, beginning with telling stories, delights sentient beings and, wishing to establish them in the Dharma of the Buddha, speaks even words that have no purpose. In that way, even in saṃsāra, the bodhisattva's cause will continue without interruption.

"Furthermore, Lord of Secrets, the bodhisattva should turn away from covetousness. He should not even give rise to a mind attached to the enjoyments of others or the wealth of others. Why is that? Because the bodhisattva is not faint-hearted. If a bodhisattva's mind becomes attached on his own account, he falls away from one part of the gateway of omniscience. Lord of Secrets, the bodhisattva should give rise to delight and think in this way: 'That they have themselves become prosperous in what I would have had to do for them is excellent!' Thinking this, he should give rise again and again to joy that the enjoyments of those beings are not wasted."

"Furthermore, Lord of Secrets, he should turn away from malice. In every situation he should be abundant in patience and loving-kindness, free of anger, and even-minded. Just as he is toward a friend, so too he should be toward an enemy. Why is that? Because the bodhisattva's mind is not possessed of dysfunction; the bodhisattva is by nature of completely pure intention. Therefore, Lord of Secrets, the bodhisattva should be free of malice.

"Furthermore, Lord of Secrets, the bodhisattva should be without wrong view. With right view, with a view that sees the dangers of the world beyond, without deceit, without crookedness, without guile, and upright, he should be of settled conviction toward the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha. Why is that? Lord of Secrets, wrong view is the great fault of a bodhisattva; it cuts off all the roots of virtue. It is the mother of all the roots of non-virtue. Therefore, Lord of Secrets, one should not give rise to wrong view even in jest."

Then again Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, please explain how bodhisattvas do not let their vow of these ten paths of virtuous action decline or be cut off at the very root; and, Blessed One, how a bodhisattva, even while surrounded by royal sovereignty, household, wife, sons, daughters, relatives, and blood kin, and while experiencing the happiness of gods and humans, does not incur a transgression."

When he had made this request, the Blessed One said to Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets: "Excellent, excellent, Lord of Secrets! Therefore, Lord of Secrets, listen and keep it well in mind, and I shall explain skill in the precise determination of transgressions in the discipline of bodhisattvas.

"Lord of Secrets, bodhisattvas are of two kinds. What are the two? Householders and those who have gone forth. Of these, the householder bodhisattva dwells in the household, takes up the five bases of training, and exercises sovereignty over a kingdom by various means and methods.

"Lord of Secrets, the bodhisattva who wishes to attain omniscience in accordance with place and time, embraced by skillful means, displays the various fields of craft, such as song, music, and conjuring, and through those various means and methods gathers sentient beings by the four means of attraction; and that, too, is for the sake of seeking unsurpassed, perfect awakening. In this he has entirely renounced taking life, taking what is not given, sexual misconduct, lying, and wrong view. The householder bodhisattva, having taken up those five bases of training and training in the

trainings just as they have been taught, should with faith train in the footsteps of the tathāgatas of the past.

"Abiding in the unsurpassed, unconditioned aggregate of moral discipline praised by the Tathāgata, he practices conditioned moral discipline embraced by skillful means and wisdom; and the four root transgressions he should never violate, even for the sake of his life. What are the four? They are abandoning the true Dharma, giving up the awakening mind, being miserly, and harming sentient beings. Why is that? Because these are not endowed with skillful means and wisdom, are by nature afflicted, and cannot be restored. Why is that?

"The buddhas who have passed beyond,
Likewise those who have not yet come,
And the protectors of the present,
Having trained in what is endowed with means and wisdom,
Attain that unsurpassed awakening,
Which is unconditioned.
The teaching of wisdom and of trainings
Not endowed with skillful means,
Great hero, was given to the śrāvakas
In order to draw them into it."

This concludes the chapter on the bodhisattva's training endowed with skillful means, from The Manifest Awakening of Great Vairocana, His Transformations, and His Empowerment.

The seventh section.

Then again the Blessed One Vairocana looked upon the assembled retinue, complete in every respect, and, wishing the teaching to be fruitfully accomplished, in order to explain the lord of all secret mantras, the king of secret mantras, the protector of all secret mantras, of great splendor, abiding in the three pledges, who brings the three paths to perfection,

He spoke with gentle voice
To Vajrapāṇi of great strength:
"Protector of secret mantras among secret mantras,
Hero, listen with undistracted mind."

At that time, having entered into the absorption called Sublime Wisdom, he uttered this secret mantra, the source of the various wisdoms, radiating a

hundred rays of light:

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ aṃ

"Vajrapāṇi,
This is the protector of all secret mantras,
Of great splendor;
This is the very self of the perfect Buddha,
The Sage, lord of all phenomena.
It destroys all the black darkness of ignorance,
And shines like the risen sun.
The great Sage in his very self
Has empowered it in just this way,
And, wishing to benefit sentient beings,
He emanates emanations.
However many heroic beings arise
Among purified sentient beings,
For that many will it accomplish
The sublime state of emanation.
Therefore, in every respect,
Those who seek the means of perfect buddhahood,
With their inner self purified,
Should always strive with diligence."

This concludes the chapter teaching the arising of the hundred syllables, from The Manifest Awakening of Great Vairocana, His Transformations, and His Empowerment.

Then again the Blessed One Vairocana said to Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets: "Lord of Secrets, when the buddhas, the blessed ones, attain the ground endowed with the empowerment of the superknowledge of great wisdom, at that time those buddhas, the blessed ones, see themselves abiding on the path of the three pledges. Lord of Secrets, at that time too, that Blessed One, endowed with the empowerment of the superknowledge of great wisdom, displays the activity of a buddha in the manner of a dhāraṇī."

"At that very time, through the activity of a buddha, those buddhas, the blessed ones, become present to all sentient beings as teachers of the path of the three pledges.

"Lord of Secrets, consider the gateway of the maṇḍala of my wheel of speech: a vast emanation pervading endless world systems, a gateway of purity, which

satisfies the hopes of all sentient beings just as they are, a gateway by which the realm of phenomena is individually discerned. Even now, although the Blessed One Śākyamuni is engaged in performing the deeds of a buddha in all the world systems, without exception, as boundless as the realm of space, Lord of Secrets, look how sentient beings do not recognize that 'this is the arising of the maṇḍala of the Blessed One's wheel of speech; this is the arising of the body of a buddha, from which springs the essence of the ornament of the array of the Buddha's speech, which satisfies sentient beings just as they hope.'

"Nevertheless, the bodhisattvas who strive to awaken fully to the realm of phenomena through gateways as many as the oceans of endless world systems, those who have arisen from the conduct of the bodhisattva Samantabhadra, here in this ocean of world systems adorned with the essence of the flower base, held in my embrace, purify buddhafields through gateways purified of various intentions, accomplish the seat of awakening, fully awaken into awakening, turn the wheel of Dharma, and empower the deeds of a buddha. Beyond that, seeking the state of a perfectly complete buddha, because the mind is immeasurable, the body is immeasurable; because the body is immeasurable, wisdom is immeasurable; because wisdom is immeasurable, sentient beings are immeasurable; and because sentient beings are immeasurable, they attain the immeasurable realm of space.

"Lord of Secrets, in this way, through immeasurable sentient beings, they attain the four immeasurables. Having attained them, endowed with the strength of the ten powers, victorious over the four māras, sounding the roar of the bull and the lion, they become perfectly complete buddhas.

"Having recited this essence of a hundred gateways
Spoken by the perfect Buddha,
Those heroes come to realize
All these sublime states."

This concludes the chapter teaching the application of the result, from The Manifest Awakening of Great Vairocana, His Transformations, and His Empowerment.

Then again Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, said this to the Blessed One:

"This explanation of the protector of mantras,
The source of mantras among mantras,
Is a great wonder, Blessed One.

Great Sage, in what place,
By what means, and how should it be known?
How the mantras arise from it,
By what and in what way, tell me.
Protector, supreme among speakers,
Please explain all of this to me."

When he had requested this, the Blessed One,
Lord of Dharma, the great Sage,
The omniscient Blessed One, Vairocana,
At that time, with words
That pervaded all the world systems,
Spoke with gentle voice:
"Vajrapāṇi of great might,
Great being, excellent, excellent!
The supreme secret of the buddhas,
Greatly wondrous, deeply hidden,
Unknown to all logicians,
All this I shall explain to you.

"Those empowered in the maṇḍala of the Great Vehicle,
The source of compassion,
Those who are upright and gentle,
And always of great compassion,
Those who never look upon awakening
As having an object:
Their essence
Will be known as the great self.

"The place where the Guide resides
Is the heart:
A lotus arisen from the mind,
Eight-petaled and most beautiful,
And on it a disk like the moon,
Like a stainless mirror.
There the protector of secret mantras,
Of great might, abides forever,
Golden in color and ablaze,
Abiding in a samādhi free from evil,

Hard to gaze upon, like the sun.
By it all these beings,
Both outside and within,
Are empowered so that it pervades them all.

"Know the mirror to be the mind;
The eye of wisdom is likewise.
When the mantra practitioner gazes
Into the mirror with the eye of wisdom,
He sees his own form as the perfect Buddha,
With characteristics utterly at peace.
Then on the body, the form of a body,
And in the mind, a form arisen from mind,
Pure and wholly beautiful,
Come forth through one's own action.
Then its rays of light,
By which the mantra practitioner
Accomplishes all the conduct of a buddha,
Shine out everywhere.
Likewise, by a purified self,
Through gazing or through speaking,
Every aim held in mind
Will indeed be accomplished."

"Furthermore, Lord of Secrets, a bodhisattva practicing the conduct of a bodhisattva by way of secret mantra should generate on the body the form of a body in this way. There is nothing superior to the perfectly complete Buddha. Just as one's own eyes, ears, nose, tongue, body, mind, and the rest are included within the four great elements, and these in turn are empty of essential nature, comprised by mere names, equal to and like space, ungraspable, arisen from causes and karma, like reflections, in just the same way the tathāgatas fully awakened. These too are linked in an unbroken stream of mutual dependent origination; whatever is born in dependence arises like a reflection. Therefore, because of mutual dependent origination, one should think, 'Whatever is the deity, that is myself; whatever I am, that is the deity,' and in this way generate the form of one's body as the body of the deity.

"Lord of Secrets, see how realization arises in dependence on the Dharma, and the Dharma arises in dependence on realization. Because both are empty of intrinsic nature, they are not even posited as agent and action with respect to each other.

"Lord of Secrets, if one asks how one should generate in the mind a form arisen from mind: Lord of Secrets, it is like this. If one brings to mind white, yellow, or red, the mind becomes attached to that consciousness. Therefore, by such a color one accomplishes only purposes of that same kind."

"Lord of Secrets, it is like this:

When one has visualized the maṇḍala in the mind
And places it upon someone with a fever,
In that very moment the person
Will be freed from the fever, without a doubt.

"Without the mind there is no maṇḍala, and without the maṇḍala there is no mind. Why is that? Because the maṇḍala and the mind are of one characteristic.

"Lord of Secrets, it is like this: if a magician were to have one illusory man conjure up another man, Lord of Secrets, what do you think? What difference would there be between them?"

When he had said this, Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, said this to the Blessed One: "There is no difference at all between those two men. Blessed One, why is that? Because both men have arisen from what is not real, and because illusion is empty of intrinsic nature."

"Lord of Secrets, in the same way, both the thing arisen from mind and the mind itself are imagined, and therefore they are empty of essential nature."

This concludes the chapter on the practice of arranging the hundred syllables, from The Manifest Awakening of Great Vairocana, His Transformations, and His Empowerment.

Then again the Blessed One said to Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets: "Lord of Secrets, listen to how the body of the protector of secret mantras and one's own body are inseparable.

"Arisen from what the mind has become,
And with the mind wholly purified,
When the protector dwells there,

Rays of light springing from his body
Radiate constantly in every direction
From each of his limbs.
Not knowing these modes,
The deluded do not understand them.
However many kinds of body there are,
They are more than can be told;
Likewise the kinds of the protector of mantras
Are said to be countless.
Just as the wish-fulfilling jewel,
Glorious, accomplishes the aims one desires,
So too the body of the lamp of the world
Accomplishes every aim."

"Lord of Secrets, if one asks how the nonconceptual realm of phenomena accomplishes every purpose: Lord of Secrets, it is like this, for example. The realm of space is not a sentient being, not a life principle, not a human, not an agent, not an experiencer, not something grasped and not a grasper, and it is free of all thought and conceptualization; and yet within it all the realms of sentient beings without exception carry out everything, going, coming, and the rest. Of this there is no doubt.

"Likewise this omniscience,
Nonconceptual and without abode,
Accomplishes with certainty
Everything for beings, outer and inner."

Then again the Blessed One, with words that range through all the realms of sentient beings without exception, spoke words for accomplishing samādhi, words of the gateway that transforms into inconceivable words:

"When from the very beginning
Nothing at all arises or perishes,
How then does the wisdom of emptiness
Arise for yogins?
When the thing called 'phenomenon'
Is not found by its essential nature,
Then the mind like space,
The source of awakening, will arise.

Then too compassion
In harmony with all the world will arise.
Abiding in the mode of mere names,
'Buddha' is here spoken as a name.
Then 'empty' and 'not empty'
Are truly designated as names.
Then the divisions of number,
One, two, three, and so on, also arise.
Thus, hero, that emptiness,
Through the empowerment of the self-arisen ones,
Increases in order, beginning with a:

ba ka kha ga gha ca cha ja jha ṭa ṭha ḍa ḍha ta tha da dha pa pha ba bha ma ya ra la va śa ṣa sa ha ṅa ña ṇa na."

"Lord of Secrets, with these, behold the mode of accomplishing samādhi through the empowering might of emptiness, empowered by the sign called a. Lord of Secrets, that very a abides as the self arrayed in various forms. It manifestly shows its own essential nature as 'All phenomena are unborn.'

"In some cases it teaches through the form of ba, meaning the inexpressible. In some cases it teaches through the form of ka, meaning that all phenomena are free of purpose. In some cases it teaches through the form of kha, 'All phenomena are like space.' In some cases it teaches through the form of ga, 'In all phenomena there is no going.' In some cases it teaches through the form of gha, 'All phenomena are a manifold massed into one.' In some cases it teaches through the form of ca, 'All phenomena are without death and transmigration.' In some cases it teaches through the form of cha, 'All phenomena are like autumn clouds.' In some cases it teaches through the form of ja, 'All phenomena are without birth.' In some cases it teaches through the form of jha, 'All phenomena are free of turbidity.' In some cases it teaches through the form of ṭa, 'All phenomena are free of pride.' In some cases it teaches through the form of ṭha, 'All phenomena are free of production.' In some cases it teaches through the form of ḍa, 'All phenomena are free of confusion.' In some cases it teaches through the form of ḍha, 'All phenomena are free of deception.' In some cases it teaches through the form of ta, 'All phenomena are free of suchness.' In some cases it teaches through the form of tha, 'All phenomena are free of a place.' In some cases it teaches through the form of da, 'All phenomena are free of giving.' In some cases it teaches

through the form of dha, 'In all phenomena an element cannot be observed.' In some cases it teaches through the form of pa, 'In all phenomena ultimate truth cannot be observed.' In some cases it teaches through the form of pha, 'All phenomena are without core, like foam.' In some cases it teaches through the form of pa, 'In all phenomena existence cannot be observed.' In some cases it teaches through the form of ma, 'In all phenomena death cannot be observed.' In some cases it teaches through the form of ya, 'In all phenomena a vehicle cannot be observed.' In some cases it teaches through the form of ra, 'All phenomena are free of dust.' In some cases it teaches through the form of la, 'In all phenomena characteristics cannot be observed.' In some cases it teaches through the form of śa, 'All phenomena are free of peace.' In some cases it teaches through the form of ṣa, 'All phenomena are by nature inert.' In some cases it teaches through the form of sa, 'In all phenomena truth cannot be observed.'

"In some cases it teaches through the form of ha, 'All phenomena are free of cause.'

"Lord of Secrets, in this way, from each of these gateways for accomplishing samādhi, one should understand thirty-two gateways for accomplishing samādhi. Lord of Secrets, see how the thirty-two marks of a great being also arise from these very letters. ṇa, ña, ṇa, and na have mastery over all samādhis; see how from them the excellent minor marks of the perfectly complete Buddha are also accomplished.

"Therefore, Lord of Secrets, a bodhisattva practicing the conduct of a bodhisattva by way of secret mantra should understand that in this way the culmination of the Buddha's intent, the pledge of the arising of the hundred syllables, has been taught in the measure of the ten minds multiplied tenfold.

"The perfect Buddha has encompassed
And expanded all of these;
Since all of them are present in me as well,
I am the supreme Victor, all the buddhas."

This concludes the chapter on accomplishing oneself, from The Manifest Awakening of Great Vairocana, His Transformations, and His Empowerment.

"Furthermore, Lord of Secrets, all of these are words for accomplishing the mode of samādhi. When one is empowered by this emptiness, one becomes just like the perfect Buddha, who has mastery over all phenomena.

"Therefore the letter is the deity:
The one called a is the supreme state.
Encircled by the letters,
It shines forth everywhere.
That deity is without characteristics,
Having abandoned both the basis of characterization and the characteristic.
From the deity without characteristics
These characteristics have arisen.
From sound the letters arose;
From the letters the secret mantras arose;
And that the result arises from the mantras
All the protectors have declared.
Sound should be known as empty;
Just as it is, in all kinds of beings,
Free of conceptual thought,
So all of this is empty.
Yet sound that is not empty also exists,
And its applications too are taught throughout.
When that sound has been realized,
The abode of the deity and samādhi,
The joining of the arrangement of letters,
And all things taught by means of the letters,
Become the basis for designating
The convention 'the many secret mantras.'"

This concludes the chapter on the mantra rite of the hundred syllables, from The Manifest Awakening of Great Vairocana, His Transformations, and His Empowerment.

"Just as space never abides
In any of the directions,
So the protector of secret mantras
Abides in no phenomenon at all.
Just as things abide in space
And always shine forth there,
Yet space does not become their abode,
So too is the protector of secret mantras.
Just as space is held to be
Free of the three times and the rest,

So the protector of secret mantras,
Though without the three times, shines forth.
A basis for designation as mere name,
Free of agent and the like:
So the wise designate space
By way of convention.
Apart from the name, nothing whatsoever
Exists, just as with space;
So too the lord of secret mantras
Merely appears as convention.
He is not fire, nor water, nor wind,
Nor earth, nor the sun,
Nor the moon or any of the planets,
Neither day nor night,
Neither birth nor cessation,
Neither death nor decline,
Not an instant, not a moment,
Not a year or the like,
Neither destruction nor formation;
No count of eons exists for him,
Nor is there any fruit
Arisen from virtue and non-virtue.
One who seeks the state of omniscience
Should always strive in that
Where all the various kinds
Of conceptual thought are absent."

This concludes the chapter teaching the essential nature of perfect awakening, from The Manifest Awakening of Great Vairocana, His Transformations, and His Empowerment.

Then Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, of what Dharma is this expression 'the three pledges' a designation?"

When he had asked this, the Blessed One Vairocana said to Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets: "Lord of Secrets, what you have asked me is excellent, excellent! Therefore listen and keep it well in mind, and I shall explain it to you."

Saying, "Blessed One, so be it," Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, listened to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One said this to him: "That special quality of the Dharma from which three kinds of special quality of the Dharma come forth in an unobstructed way is the three pledges. And what is that special quality of the Dharma? What is called Dharma is the first mind: the nature of what has been cultivated, together with the wisdom that arises subsequent to it; and, having fully understood reality just as it is by that wisdom, generating the mind free of the entire net of conceptual thought is the characteristic of awakening. The second is nonconceptuality: the state of the perfect Buddha. Lord of Secrets, having seen reality just as it is, and having looked upon all the realms of sentient beings without exception, one comes under the power of compassion, and there arises the awakening mind that thinks, 'I shall establish sentient beings in that very awakening which cannot be objectified, which is free of all conceptual elaboration and without characteristics.' That is the three pledges.

"Lord of Secrets, furthermore, what are the three pledges?

"The first mind is the Buddha;
The second is called the Dharma;
The mind that arises together with it
Is explained as the Saṅgha.
Hero, these three pledges
The guides have explained to you.
Then, through gateways of various modes,
The hero who wishes to benefit beings,
Abiding in these three pledges,
Practices the conduct of awakening.

"Lord of Secrets, when those who have mastery over the three bodies have become perfect buddhas, at that time those perfectly complete buddhas first empower a single emanation body and establish the teaching. Lord of Secrets, furthermore, that single body is set forth as three: the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha. Lord of Secrets, furthermore, it is taught by being set forth as the three vehicles.

At that time, having done all the deeds of a buddha, they display complete nirvāṇa and bring sentient beings to full maturity. Lord of Secrets, apart from those who are unwilling, the lazy, those given to busyness, those who lack faith in mantra, and those who amass many possessions, consider how, for

those who practice the conduct of a bodhisattva through the gateway of secret mantra, who possess full knowledge of the three pledges, and who accomplish the rites of secret mantra, there are no obstructors arising from conceptual thought. Drinking liquor and lying on a raised bed, these two are not to be done.

From The Manifest Awakening of Great Vairocana, His Transformations, and His Empowerment, the chapter on the practice of the three pledges.

How is one a Tathāgata?
How does one become the supreme Victor?
How is one a bodhisattva?
How is one called a buddha?
May the Great Sage
Dispel these doubts of mine.
Once doubt and hesitation are dispelled,
The bodhisattvas of great renown
Will practice the Great Vehicle,
The unsurpassed ocean of conduct.

Then the Blessed One Vairocana, having looked upon the assembled retinue, complete in every respect, said to the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, what you have asked me is excellent, excellent! Therefore listen as I explain the way of the Great Vehicle.

Awakening has the characteristic of space;
It has abandoned all conceptualization.
Whoever wishes to realize it
Is called a bodhisattva.
One who has accomplished the ten grounds,
Has well realized and fully understood the ten masteries,
Knows in all their aspects phenomena
Empty and like illusions, and here
Knows the ways of the whole world,
Is called a buddha.
The Dharma has the characteristic of space;
It is nondual and of a single characteristic.
One fully awakened through the ten powers
Is called a perfectly complete buddha.
Because even mere perception is abandoned,

Its own essence cannot be shown.
What is called self-aware wisdom
Is explained to be the Tathāgata."

From The Manifest Awakening of Great Vairocana, His Transformations, and His Empowerment, the chapter on teaching the Tathāgata.

"Vajrapāṇi, furthermore, once, when I had become a bodhisattva and was practicing the conduct of a bodhisattva while dwelling in the world of Brahmā, Brahmā asked me, 'O Great Brahmā, how many kinds of fire should be known?' And I said this to him: 'The proud fire is the self-born one. After it comes the son of Brahmā, born from it.

The worldly fire Pāvaka
Is the first son of Brahmā.
His son is Brahmā's Food, and his son in turn
Is said to be the one called Bharata.
His son is Vaiśvānara,
Then Havana, and Oblation-Bearer;
Side-Guardian, it is renowned in the ocean,
Is the son of Atharvan.
The fire called Vāyu
Is taught for the rite of entering the womb.
Then for the bathing of a person
Know likewise Pavamāna.
The one called Auspicious is for the parting of the hair;
For the rite of birth, Pragalbha.
The naming fire is Pārthiva;
Likewise for the first feeding, Pure.
The one called Śadvi is for the topknot;
For conferring the vows, Samudbhava.
The one called the Sun is for the gift of cattle;
For taking a bride, Joiner is taught.
With Agni one kindles the household;
For offerings, Fire itself.
The fire called Pāvaka
Is taught to be applied to all the gods.
For the householder, Brahmā's fire;
Likewise for offering wealth, Peace.

Likewise for tethering cattle,
The fire called Avanika.
For transgressions, Vicici;
For cooked offerings, Sāhasa.
For the junctures of time, know Havi;
Likewise for the lunar stations, Treasure.
The one called Mṛṭa is for the final full oblation;
For pacifying, Dāruṇa is held to be right.
The fire at the end of rites is Yama;
Likewise for increase, Giver of Strength.
For all fierce activities
The wrathful fire is proclaimed.
The fire called Desire-Born
Is taught for the purpose of subjugation.
For burning forests, the Messenger fire;
The fire within the belly is Jaṭhara.
The one that devours is said to be the flesh-eater (piśāca);
The Mare's Mouth is in the ocean.
At the time of destruction it is called Terrifying,
And is rightly proclaimed the fire at the end of time.
These are the fires in summary,
Which I have explained to you;
Those who practice the heard scripture of the Vedas
Declare them to be the sons of Brahmā.'
These forty-four
I taught at that time.
Lord of Secrets, in this regard,
Those who perform fire offerings
Without knowing the nature of the fires
Do not make a fire offering, do no good deed,
And there will be no fruit of the action either.

After I had fully and perfectly awakened to enlightenment, I taught twelve fires. If you ask what they are:

The fire of wisdom is the first;
It is proclaimed to be Mahendra.
It is yellow in color

And bestows complexion, increase, and strength.
Garlanded with flames, it is samādhi,
And is said to bring wisdom to perfection.
The second is called Holder,
Like the light of the autumn moon;
Glorious, clad in white garments,
It holds a rosary, a water pot, and a ewer.
The third is called Vāyu;
Its color is black and it is rough.
The fourth is called Red,
Like the red glow of the evening twilight.
The fifth, called Mṛḍa,
Is russet in its coloring,
With a long neck and great splendor;
It is said to benefit all.
The sixth is called Wrathful,
Squint-eyed, colored like smoke,
Its hair bristling upward, it gives a great roar,
Four-fanged and of great strength.
The seventh is called Belly,
Sharp, and possessing every color.
The eighth is called Exhaustion,
Like the flickering of lightning rays.
The ninth is called Mind-Born,
Of various forms and of great strength.
The tenth is the World Holder.
The fire of the piśācas is another besides these.
The twelfth is called Stupefier,
For it stupefies all sentient beings.
Lord of Secrets, in this way,
Having consecrated the form of the fire,
Make your own form
And the substances too of its very nature.
This is the outer fire offering;
Those who wish for accomplishment should perform the fire offering.

Lord of Secrets, the inner one is of a single nature: when the three are present by way of making the three places one, that is the inner fire offering. Lord of Secrets, possessing great loving-kindness and great compassion is pacifying. Possessing joy is increasing. With the wrathful fire one should perform fierce activity: making wrath itself powerful, insert the name between ṭa and pha, place an effigy too in the wrathful maṇḍala, and do it by subduing anger. In the center place the fire of wind.

"Lord of Secrets, in this way, in each of the places just proclaimed, one should perform the fire offering as is appropriate and as is fitting."

Then again Vajrapāṇi said this to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, how is the fire pit to be made?
How too are the purifying sprinklings to be done?
How is the kuśa grass to be spread?
Please tell me how it is to be contemplated."

When he had asked this, the Blessed One said this to the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi:

"Lord of Secrets, as for the fire pit,
It measures about one cubit all around;
Its rim should measure four fingers,
And it is marked with vajra signs.
Starting from the right side of the pit,
Spread fresh kuśa grass;
Wrap the tips with the roots,
And the roots with the tips.
Here do the sprinkling from the right side,
In the same way as the kuśa is laid around.
Unguents, flowers, and incense
Should be offered to the Mṛḍa fire.
In that hearth the Mṛḍa fire,
With a single flower, as one's own form,
The disciplined mantra practitioner should establish.
Then too the sprinklings are done.
With his own secret mantra
The wise one should offer it the full oblation.
Then he should perform the pacifying fire offering,
Or else the increasing fire offering.

This worldly fire offering
Is declared to be the outer one.

Furthermore, the inner fire offering
Is the restraining of action and of life;
It is to be known by the mind,
Abandoning form, sound, and the rest.

The eye, ear, nose, tongue, and body are born from mentation and abide in the king of mind. These, produced by conceptualization, together with the awakening mind, the sense objects, the eye and so on, and the fire of wind as well, are restrained by unwavering wisdom, and one makes the fire offering into the fire of mind.

This is called the inner fire offering;
Gentle one, I have taught it to you."

Then the Blessed One said to the assembled retinue, complete in every respect: "You should practice this Dharma discourse while abiding in heedfulness.

Apart from my sons,
Do not give it to anyone else.
I shall explain their characteristics;
All of you, listen.
Born of the lineage of the Sun,
Proud, and of subtle intelligence,
Grateful, desiring the Dharma,
Knowing the Dharma and striving in the Dharma,
With a complexion of bluish hue,
With a very handsome face,
A high nose with a sharp tip,
And a broad head and forehead:
All these are my sons;
They reflect on the meaning of the teaching.
To them, earnestly,
This should always be given."

Then all of them, their minds overjoyed, said, "We shall do just as the Teacher has declared."

Then at that time all of them
Bowed to the Tathāgata,
Made offerings well,
And, seated before him with joined palms,
Spoke these words:
"So that this way of the Dharma
May long endure throughout the world,
Protector, please speak words of empowerment
For this teaching."

Then at that time the Blessed One spoke words empowering this Dharma discourse:

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ sarbvathā śiṃ śiṃ traṃ traṃ guṃ guṃ dharaṃ dharaṃ sthāpaya buddhā satya vāka dharmma satya vāka saṃgha satya vāka hūṃ hūṃ veda vidi svāhā

When the Blessed One had said this, those vajra holders and the bodhisattvas Samantabhadra and the rest rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had spoken.

From the great and most extensive king of sūtras, The Manifest Awakening of Great Vairocana, His Transformations, and His Empowerment, the twenty-fifth chapter, on all the rites for practicing the conduct of a bodhisattva through the gateway of secret mantra, is complete.

Then the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, said this: "For the benefit and happiness of those who are devoted to practicing in this way, I shall explain the bindings for them in this teaching. Gather your mind one-pointedly and listen.

Raising the left foot,
Plant the right one well and firmly.
Direct the gaze toward the waist.
Both hands should be raised.
The right, extended, stays in the manner of a serpent's hood;
Bind it so that it is joined with the wheel.
By properly forming the wheel mudrā,
One should crush in every direction.
Having seen this mudrā of great power,
Whether Vajradhara himself
Or whoever is worldly,
All of them will be destroyed.

Placing both feet evenly,
Thunder out the roar called hūṃ.
Fierce, pressing the lower lip with the teeth,
Wrathful, with the head raised,
If one threatens, they will be overpowered.
Putting both heels together,
If with the spear mudrā one strikes them all,
They instantly turn to ashes.
Quickly taking a single step,
Raising the foot and turning the body,
In the manner of a bow,
Having crushed the whole face of the earth on every side,
The gods, asuras, and yakṣas
Who dwell here upon the earth,
Whenever the mantra practitioner abides here,
He always makes the obstructors vanish.
Extending the left foot,
Join both hands like a lotus;
The mantra practitioner, blazing, circles the crown of the head,
And with the foot strikes out like a lion's stance.
If, with wrath, one strikes the obstructors,
Even if a buddha had made them,
Those obstructors are destroyed into ashes
Or without doubt will die.

Whatever accomplishments the wise
Have taught in all the tantras,
If all of them are summarized,
Are included without remainder in four kinds:
The first of the activities is pacifying,
And likewise the others, increasing,
Subjugating, and the activity of fierce conduct.
These four kinds are proclaimed.

Among them, accomplishments such as liberation, pacifying harms such as those of grahas, and lengthening life are pacifying. The wish-fulfilling jewel, becoming a sword-bearing vidyādhara, the kingdom of a universal monarch, and so on, and any accomplishing of wealth, all of these are increasing; so say

those skilled in secret mantra. Bringing under control and summoning men, women, boys, girls, kings, ministers, and so on, as well as gods, nāgas, yakṣas, yakṣiṇīs, asura women, piśāca women, and so on, is bringing under one's control; so say the vidyā holders.

Binding, harming, cutting off limbs, setting at odds, causing enmity, killing, withering, and so on, in short, anything whatsoever that harms the bodies of sentient beings: all of these are fierce activity; so say the vidyā holders.

Through the actions of fire offering that satisfy,
The secret mantras swiftly grant accomplishment.
They empower all the gods,
And also bestow what is sublime.
Whatever is deficient, or not provided, or a lapse in the rite,
A letter crooked or lengthened, added or omitted,
Suppressed, or seized by obstructors,
All of that it purifies.
Without the fire offering, from the rites
Accomplishment will not come about.
For that very reason, one should apply oneself
To the definite actions of the fire offering.

The distinctions of the fire offering should be drawn according to the distinctions of pacifying, increasing, bringing under control, and fierce activity.

Among these, first, the definite fire offering for the activity of pacifying is as follows. Go about one krośa to the north of the village and examine the ground carefully. Whether on the bank of the river Gaṅgā, on the shore of a lotus lake, on the bank of a stream, or on an island in a lake, on ground that is white in color, empower yourself as Vajrasattva, perform the urging of the earth, its purification, and so on, and then begin the maṇḍala on the fifth, the fourth, or the tenth day of the waxing fortnight, or on the full moon; this is how it should be done. Uttarabhādrapadā, Pūrvaphalgunī, Āśleṣā, and Maghā are said to be the lunar mansions for pacifying. One should first begin the work when the planets the Moon and Venus hold sway.

Then, transforming yourself into the body of Avalokiteśvara, place the Blessed One Vairocana upon a lotus, as the sword mudrā or as the seed syllable, the letter a. a

Then to the north place the triangle mudrā of all the buddhas, or its seed syllable, on top of a lotus. aṃ

To the west of the buddhas place Ākāśagarbha, as the sword mudrā or as the seed syllable. ī

To the west of Ākāśagarbha is Mañjuśrī; place him too as the utpala mudrā or as the seed syllable. māṃ

To the west of him place Gaganalocanā, as the mudrā or as the seed syllable. gāṃ

To the east of the buddhas place Śākyamuni, as the alms bowl mudrā or as the seed syllable. bhā

Beside him place the wish-fulfilling jewel mudrā of the ūrṇā, or its seed syllable. bhru

Then draw the wish-fulfilling jewel mudrā of the bodhisattvas together with its seed syllable; the seed syllable for it is this: ka

Then on the right side of Great Vairocana place Avalokiteśvara, as the lotus mudrā or as the seed syllable. sa

On the left side of Avalokiteśvara place Mahāsthāmaprāpta, as the lotus mudrā or as the seed syllable. mā

Beside Mahāsthāmaprāpta place Bhṛkuṭī, as the water pot and ewer mudrā or as the seed syllable. bhṛ

To the right of the Lotus Holder place the goddess Tārā, as the utpala mudrā or as the seed syllable. tāṃ

Beside her place Pāṇḍaravāsinī, as the lotus mudrā or as the seed syllable. paṃ

On the left side of the Blessed One place Vajradhara, as the vajra mudrā or as the seed syllable. baṃ

On his right side place Māmakī, as the vajra mudrā or as the seed syllable. mā

Beside her place the vidyā queen Beautiful Destroyer, as the vajra mudrā or as the seed syllable. saṃ

On the left side of Vajradhara place Amṛtakuṇḍalin, as the vajra mudrā or as the seed syllable. mṛ

Beside him place all the vajra holders, as the vajra mudrā or as the seed syllable. hūṃ

Below the Blessed One, in the direction of Agni, place Acala, as the sword mudrā or as the seed syllable. hāṃ

Below the Blessed One, in the direction of Nairṛti, place Trailokyavijaya, as the vajra club mudrā or as the seed syllable. hā

At the two sides of the gate place the two nāga kings Nanda and Upananda, in the form of their names, "Nanda" and "Upananda."

Inside the gateways arrange the four guardians: in the east a sword with its seed syllable, ca; in the north a sword with its seed syllable, ba; in the west a club with its seed syllable, sa; in the south a club with its seed syllable, kṣa.

Then, inside the outer line, in the small maṇḍalas of the abodes, draw the five Pure Abodes. In the first maṇḍala it is saṃ saṃ svāhā. In the second it is manomaya. In the third it is dharmmā saṃbhava. In the fourth it is bibhava. In the fifth it is katanana. Alternatively, it is also permissible to place saṃ saṃ svāhā in the small maṇḍalas of the abodes.

In the place of the lord of the family to which one's own deity belongs, one should place one's own mudrā or seed syllable.

Then, inside the outer line, draw lotuses all around. Then, to the right of the gate of the maṇḍala, inside the surrounding ground, make the fire pit:

It is round all the way around,
And its measure should be about one cubit.
Its depth measures twelve fingers.
Above it, the rim
Should measure four fingers all around.
In the center of its floor
Make a wheel rim of one finger.

Then sit down, bind the pledge mudrā, and recite the pledge secret mantra. With the letter sa and the lotus mudrā, empower yourself as Avalokiteśvara. Imagine that from the letter a abiding in its own maṇḍala you become exactly the body of Great Vairocana, and display his mudrā as well. Then bind the sword mudrā, and from the letter a empower yourself as the body of Great Vairocana. Imagine that all the letters of the maṇḍala become the forms of their respective deities, and display each of their mudrās as well.

Then, reciting the mantra of noble Acala and binding the karma vajra, offer unguents, flowers, and so on to all the deities, however many reside in their respective retinues. Bringing to mind the samādhi that thinks, "Through the

letter ra this too is free from dust," consecrate the unguents, flowers, and so on with their respective secret mantras; consecrate the unguents and the rest also with their respective heart mantras, and offer them. One should also invite each one individually, saying, "Accept this unguent and be mindful of me." Apply this likewise to all of them.

namaḥ samanta buddhāṇāṃ traṭa amogha caṇḍa mahāroṣaṇa sphoṭaya hūṃ traṭa haṃ ma
This is the secret mantra of noble Acala.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ viśuddhe gandhodbhava svāhā
This is the secret mantra of unguent.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ mahā maitrya bhyuṅgate svāhā
This is the secret mantra of flowers.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ dharma dhātvā nugate svāhā
This is the secret mantra of incense.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ tathāgatārci spharaṇa avabhāsa gaganodarya svāhā
This is the secret mantra of lamps.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ traiyadhvikānāṃ arara parara balide baliṃ dhadāhi svāhā
This is the secret mantra of food offerings.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ gagana sama sama svāhā
This is the secret mantra of the water offering; it is applied at the beginning and at the end as well.

The rite of reciting the heart secret mantra is:
oṃ bhagavān vairocana idaṃ gaṃdhi pratigṛhya idaṃ me kāryaṃ kuru svāhā
Apply this likewise to all of them.

For the pacifying rite, offer white sandalwood mixed with camphor; if that is not available, offer puśelce. Likewise offer white lotus flowers, jasmine flowers, mallikā flowers, yūthikā flowers, and such fragrant white flowers as are auspicious. For incense in the pacifying rite, offer camphor and sandalwood, or else śivasaka. As food offerings, offer white things such as yogurt and cooked rice. As for lamps, offer butter lamps poured into white vessels. Offer a water offering in white vessels such as conch shells, filled with water mixed with sandalwood, camphor, and white flowers.

Having made the offerings as described, then go outside, empower yourself as Avalokiteśvara, and give the torma to the directions outside:

With parched rice and with sesame,
With water and with cooked rice,
With flowers and with cooked beans,
With kṛśara, and with plenty of oil and fat:
Such a torma the master
Should take up in his hand and, joyfully,
Scatter in all directions,
Offering incense and water as well.
First, in the direction of Īśāna,
Offer to the Bow-Bearer (Rudra) with his host.
Then in the direction of Indra
The wise one should offer to Indra himself.
Then the fearless mantra practitioner
Should offer in the direction of Agni.
Then the dauntless mantra practitioner
Should offer in the direction of Yama.
The knower of mantra, in the direction of Nairṛti,
Offers to Nairṛti with his host.
In the direction of Varuṇa, to the nāgas,
He offers while reciting the fearless secret mantra.
Having offered to them together with their lord,
He should go to the direction of Vāyu.
The knower of mantra, having gone there,
To Vāyu, the wind god, with his host,
Calling them by their own names,
Offers torma with their own mantras.
Having gone to the northern direction,
With his mind made fully clear,
Wishing to attain his own accomplishment,
He offers torma to the yakṣas.
To the rākṣasas, the piśācas,
The bhūtas who eat raw flesh,
And to sentient beings of every kind,
The wise one scatters torma in the directions.
To the beings of that place,

Who dwell in trees and in thickets,
Whoever comes to mind,
To each of them he gives torma.

The mantras of the torma for the directions are these. In the direction of Īśāna: rudrāya svāhā. In the direction of Indra: śakrāya svāhā. In the direction of Agni: agnaye svāhā. In the direction of Yama: vaiva svāhā. In the direction of Nairṛti: rākṣasādhipataye svāhā. In the direction of Varuṇa: meghaśanaye svāhā. In the direction of Vāyu: vāyave svāhā. In the direction of Kubera: yakśa vidyādhari svāhā. kraṃ kiri svāhā: this is for the rākṣasas. mici mici svāhā: this is for the piśācas. gu i gu i svāhā: this is for the bhūtas.

Having thus scattered torma all around, wash your hands and rinse your mouth. Then go inside, bow to all the buddhas, purify with noble Acala whatever substances there are to be burned, and place them on the right side. On the left side place two vessels for the water offering, filled with kuśa grass and water mixed with fragrances. One is recited over with noble Acala; the other is recited over with the Supreme Vajra Giver. Spread kuśa grass around the fire hearth in an encircling manner. On the seat where you yourself sit, also lay out kuśa grass in an encircling manner. Place in front of you the filling ladle and the pouring ladle of udumbara or aśvattha wood, and melted butter as well.

Then smear the fire pit with sandalwood and scatter loose fragrant white flowers. Take fire from the house of a brahmin, sprinkle it with the king of the wrathful ones, and kindle the fire on firewood of plakṣa and udumbara with a fan. Sit there facing north, anoint both hands with unguent, bind the pledge mudrā and the others, and with mudrā and secret mantra empower yourself as the body of Great Vairocana, exactly as he abides in the water maṇḍala.

Then imagine a water maṇḍala at the floor of the fire pit. In the center of the water, from the letter placed as before, it becomes the form of fire. Imagine the fire god thus: like a conch, a kunda flower, and the Moon in color, with his hair in a topknot, three-eyed and four-armed, holding in his hands a rosary, a water pot and ewer, and a club, and granting fearlessness; wearing white garments, with a white thread worn across his body as a sacred cord, marked at the heart with a triangle, marked with the letter ra, radiating white flames, and having the nature of wisdom.

With the water arranged earlier and consecrated by noble Acala, sprinkle around the fire in a circling manner. Do it three times with the Supreme Vajra Giver as well.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ maṃ svāhā
This is the Supreme Vajra Giver's.

Then offer unguent, flowers, and so on to the fire with its own secret mantra. Then give three burnt oblations of the three sweet substances. Holding the filling ladle in your fist, give three full ladles of butter. Then burn seven pairs of kindling sticks from the tips of udumbara or aśvattha, dipped in butter. Then again give three full ladles of butter, and do the sprinkling as before.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ oṃ vradāganaye śāntiṃ kuru svāhā

In the same way, perform the fire offering to each of the deities individually, and do the sprinkling.

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ hūṃ a mahā śānti gata śāntikara praśama dharmma nirjāta abhāva svabhūva dharmma samanta prāpta amukasya svasti śāntiṃ baṃ kuru svāhā
This is the secret mantra of pacifying.

Then, bringing to mind all the buddhas, meditate on the awakening mind just as it is, through the purity of the inner self. Then place your own vidyā-mantra on a moon maṇḍala, bind the mudrā of your own deity, and meditate on yourself in the form of your own deity. Then again, as before, offer the three full ladles and the rest, do the sprinkling in an encircling manner, and perform the fire offering with the substances arising from your own tantra for as long as you do not tire. When you grow weary, gaze upon the body of the perfect Buddha and meditate once more on the awakening mind. Then offer the water offering, bow to the deities, and request them to depart. Having requested all the deities to depart, cover the assemblies of mudrās with new cloth. On the following day, as before, imagine the deities abiding in their respective maṇḍalas, and carry out that same sequence of the rite until pacification has come about.

The accomplished mantra practitioner who knows the rite,
Whoever pacifies by means of this rite
Without laziness,
Will attain pacification itself.
In half a month a single realm

Will certainly be pacified;
For a king, in twelve days;
For a region, in ten days.

In this regard, one who performs the activity of the pacifying rite should practice the rite as follows:

Wearing white clothes, clean and peaceful,
Wholly devoted to the awakening mind,
He sleeps on a seat spread with kuśa grass,
And holds a purifier made of it.
He drinks barley gruel or milk,
And sets his mind on performing the fire offering.
With fire offering and recitation at the three times
He should practice the pacifying rite.
Water for the feet is offered with the Supreme Vajra Giver,
The sprinkling with Acala, the protector.
Here, for now, in summary,
The rite of fire offering is proclaimed.

From The Manifest Awakening of Great Vairocana, His Transformations, and His Empowerment, the chapter on the rite of the pacifying fire offering.

Then furthermore, O greatly fortunate one,
What the skilled in mantra formerly,
Out of loving concern for sentient beings,
Wishing to benefit them, taught
About the great increasing fire offering,
Listen to that with mind gathered one-pointedly.
Therefore in every way
One should practice the increasing rite.
Having made one's place in the eastern quarter
Of a village or of a district,
One should, as before, carefully examine
The ground that has been determined.
On a mountain peak, in a cattle pen,
Or at stūpas containing relics,
The wise one should draw the maṇḍala
For accomplishing the activity of increasing.

The skilled one, by the rite of the activity,
Having dug the ground well,
Places in the center precious things and grains
Mixed together with medicines.
There, with yellow earth,
One should fill the ground well.
Having made it level and well pounded,
On top of it one draws the maṇḍala.

Here too, for now, the mantra practitioner skilled in the rite meditates on himself as the Supreme Vajra Giver and, abiding in his own maṇḍala, empowers himself with its secret mantra and mudrā; with noble Acala he should seal the boundaries and take full possession of the ground. On the third, fifth, or seventh day of the waxing fortnight, or else on the full moon, under a good planet, Mercury or Jupiter, and under the lunar mansion Śravaṇa, Śatabhiṣaj, Jyeṣṭhā, or Rohiṇī, he empowers himself as Great Vairocana, takes a yellow cord, and strikes the lines of the maṇḍala with the same number and measurements as before. Then he circumambulates the maṇḍala, enters inside, recites the Blessed Mother, the Perfection of Wisdom, and bows. Again he empowers himself as Vairocana, takes yellow pigment, and

There places the letter ka.
At that moment the sage Kanakamuni,
Blazing with the color of gold,
Abides in samādhi and has destroyed evil.

Then draw the maṇḍala with its porticoes, and always open the western gate. Surround it on the outside with three square lines, and arrange the deities in the maṇḍala as before. In this there is the following distinction. In the place of noble Ākāśagarbha, place the mudrā of Samantabhadra, the jewel banner, together with the letter sa. sa

In the place of the ūrṇā, place noble Jambhala, as the mudrā of the bījapūra fruit together with the letter jaṃ, which has the character of nectar. jaṃ

In the place of noble Bhṛkuṭī, place Yaśovatī, as the mudrā of the priyaṅgu flower together with the letter ya. ya

In the place of noble Pāṇḍaravāsinī, place Mahāśrī, called the Noble White Lady, as the lotus mudrā or as the seed syllable. śrī

In the place of noble Beautiful Destroyer, place Subāhu, as the vajra mudrā or as the seed syllable. hūṃ

In the place of Amṛtakuṇḍalin, place Vajrasena, as the vajra mudrā or as the seed syllable. sa

In the place of the inhabitants of the Pure Abodes, arrange Śakra and the four world protectors.

Then, inside the two outer lines, draw vajras all the way around and in all the corners. Then, on the right side of the maṇḍala, inside the surrounding ground, make the fire pit:

Perfectly square, with a rim,
Its width should measure two cubits.
Encircle it all around with vajras.
Its depth measures about one cubit;
The rim measures one span to the little finger.
Plaster it with a wash of yellow clay.
The lotus mudrā measures one finger;
Make its height four fingers.

At the three times, smear it with cow dung that has not fallen to the ground. Then, as before, imagine the lord deity of the maṇḍala and the others exactly in their aspects and signs, and worship them with unguents, flowers, and so on. In this there is the following distinction: when one requests the Blessed One Vairocana to take his seat and makes offerings with unguents, flowers, and so on, at that time one should do so having empowered oneself as the Supreme Vajra Giver.

Here I shall explain the particulars of the unguents, flowers, and so on.

Saffron mixed with camphor
Is the finest unguent for rites of increase.
If that is not found, one should prepare
Something fragrant and yellow in color.
Campaka flowers are most excellent;
Yūthikā, yellow jasmine,
And others too that are fragrant
And yellow should be offered.
Saffron blended with aloeswood,
And blended with sugar,

In order to accomplish the rites of increase,
The wise one should offer as incense.
Guggulu and sandalwood too,
Blended with ghee, are the finest incense.
Sarja resin mixed with saffron
The one skilled in mantra should offer as incense.
A lamp vessel of gold is best;
Or else a yellow one of clay will also do.
The wise one should offer a yellow lamp wick
Made of yellow cloth.
With fine scented oil
Its oil should be made fragrant;
Or else, with sesame oil,
One should offer a clean lamp.
Yellow rice with a lentil dish,
Together with ghee, is most excellent.
The side dishes too should be made yellow,
And likewise the fruits and pastries.
Scented water with yellow flowers,
And likewise rice and dūrvā grass,
Poured into a vessel that is also yellow,
Is the auspicious guest-water for rites of increase.

Having performed the offerings properly in this way, one should then empower oneself as the Supreme Vajra Giver, go outside, and give the torma to the directions. Then, having performed the ritual sipping, one should go inside, pay homage to all the buddhas, and, as before, set down beside the fire pit the things to be burned and so on, purified with mantra. Sitting in the lotus posture upon kuśa grass spread on the ground, one should imagine oneself in the body of Great Vairocana. Smear the room and the hearth with yellow unguent, scatter loose yellow flowers, and spread kuśa grass. Take fire from a household of the warrior caste or from a royal palace, perform the purifying sprinkling, and kindle the fire with plakṣa and udumbara wood.

Then imagine the maṇḍala of Mahendra at the base of the fire pit, and imagine there the syllable ya with an anusvāra, resting upon a lotus: yaṃ. From the syllable ra, one should imagine fire arising from within the fire pit, as follows: he has a topknot the color of gold, three eyes, and four faces; in his hands he

holds a rosary and a water pot, and makes the gesture of granting the supreme; he wears yellow garments and a yellow thread across his shoulder as a sacred cord; he is smeared with three lines and bears the mark of a triangle; he is marked with the syllable ra; he is like gold in color, with blazing flames radiating in every direction, and possesses great power. Having imagined such a fire, arisen from the light rays of the king of secret mantra, one should then perform the purifying sprinkling, the rinsing of the mouth, and the offering of guest-water, and give unguents, flowers, and so on with his own mantra:

namaḥ smanta buddhānān oṃ agnaye svāhā

Then give three oblations of milk porridge blended with honey, ghee, and so on, or of black sesame blended with ghee. Then, with a filling ladle and a pouring ladle of bilva wood, give seven ladlefuls of ghee. Then give three oblations of kindling sticks taken from the middle part of plakṣa or udumbara wood, a thumb in thickness and a cubit in length, dipped in ghee, and again give three ladlefuls. Then, imagining the forms of the deities as before, offer three oblations with the heart mantra of each. Then, imagining all the buddhas, cultivate the awakening mind, imagine the form of one's own deity, and, having offered three oblations as before, perform the fire offering with the substances described in the accomplishment of one's own siddhi. Saying oṃ at the beginning, add at the end: "For fame, glory, wealth, virtue, and riches, svāhā." Or else, saying, "For the substance of the accomplishment I have conceived, svāhā," one should offer the oblations. Having performed the fire offering properly, one should carry out the same sequence of the awakening mind and so on, as before.

Here too, the rite to be practiced by the practitioner is this:

He should wear yellow garments
And carry a clean, yellow purifier.
His mind steady and his power great,
Keeping strict silence and free of avarice,
Always delighting in the awakening mind,
First performing the rite at the three times,
Eating cooked barley or drinking milk,
He should undertake the rite of increase.
Whoever, by this means, properly
Undertakes the rite of increase,

Whatever increase he has in mind
Will swiftly be accomplished.
A sword, a wheel, a vajra,
Realgar, eye ointment, bezoar,
A wish-fulfilling jewel, a vase, a garment,
A falling rain of riches, sandals,
A parasol, a chariot, a mount,
And likewise a multistoried house,
A lotus, a vase, a trident,
A rosary, a club, a gundhe,
A lute, a short spear, or an arrow,
An alms bowl and a ringing staff,
Or else whatever substance one desires
Should be accomplished in this maṇḍala.

This concludes the chapter on the ritual of the fire offering for the rite of increase, from The Manifest Awakening of Great Vairocana, His Transformations, and His Empowerment.

Then, furthermore, this fire offering
That fully accomplishes the rite of control
Was taught by the Lamp of the World
With a mind that had turned to love.
I shall explain it without omission;
You who desire prosperity, listen to me.
First, as for examining the site:
Make your dwelling to the southeast, the direction of Agni,
Of a town or else of a region,
In an empty house where no people are,
Or at the foot of a solitary tree, or in a charnel ground,
Or else at a shrine of Śaṃkara (Śiva),
Or at a shrine of the mātṛkās; a cave will also do.
As for the mantrin's drawing of the maṇḍala,
On the ninth day of the waning fortnight
One should begin the rite of control.
On the day of the Sun or of Mars,
Under the lunar mansions Puṣya, Kṛttikā,
Maghā, and Viśākhā,

The wise one should draw the maṇḍala.

For this, the mantrin first empowers himself as Vajrapāṇi, and on ground of a red color performs the purification of the ground, the taking possession of it, and so on. Then, having empowered himself as Great Vairocana, he takes a thread dyed crimson over which the noble Acala's mantra has been recited, and lays out the lines of the maṇḍala: it is triangular, with its door facing east, and the door frame, the portico, and the border are properly made.

Then, taking red pigment
Of very fine quality,
He places the blazing syllable:
The syllable ra with its anusvāra,
Like the rising sun,
Very hard to tame, supreme among the victors.
Having empowered the pigment in this way
And having recollected all the buddhas,
He draws the maṇḍala all around:
Three cubits, or else five,
Or else seven or nine will also do.
In keeping with the siddhi of secret mantra,
He should divide it into three parts.
The placing of the deities is as before;
The wise one should do it with the lord of the family,
And the rest, as is fitting,
The wise one should place.

There, in the place of Ākāśagarbha, one places the two, Keśinī and Upakeśinī, with the mudrās of the club and the noose. In the place of the Beautiful Destroyer one places Vajra Hook with the mudrā of the arrow. Crown Conduct too is placed with the mudrā of the arrow. Outside, one draws the four servants with the mudrā of the noose. Then one performs all the rites as before. The unguents, flowers, and so on that are offered are likewise red.

The fire pit, too, is made in the same place as before. It should measure twenty fingers in length, with a rim of two fingers, its opening facing outward. Its depth is one small span, and in the center one should make an eight-finger vajra smeared with red. That fire pit should be triangular, with three corners. Then, having empowered oneself as Vajrapāṇi, one gives the torma outside.

Then take fire from the house of a dyer and perform the purifying sprinkling as before. Kindle the fire with khadira wood, aśoka wood, or karavīra wood. Likewise, having empowered oneself as Vairocana, imagine the maṇḍala of fire at the base of the fire pit and place the syllable there. One imagines that this syllable ra, through light radiating from a garland of flames, turns into the form of Agni: like the rising sun, hard to tame, three-eyed, with a tawny topknot and four arms, holding in his hands a club, a noose, a rosary, and a gundhe; he wears red garments and bears a red thread across his shoulder, is marked with the syllable ra, and radiates red light with blazing flames. Having imagined such a fire, perform the purifying sprinkling, offer guest-water, and give unguents, flowers, and so on with his own secret mantra.

Then give seven oblations of kindling sticks of karavīra wood dipped in mustard oil and red sandalwood. Then offer seven oblations to the deities arranged in the maṇḍala. As before, imagine the form of one's own deity and set it in place, likewise offer oblations, and perform the fire offering with the substances that come from the rite. At the end too, perform in the same way the rite of cultivating the awakening mind and so on. In this rite, too, all the requisites of the maṇḍala should be made red. The place of the fire, too, should be smeared with red sandalwood at the three times, and loose red flowers should be scattered over it.

He wears glorious red garments,
Is adorned with red unguent and garlands,
And bears a red thread across his shoulder;
He knows the distinctions of the awakening mind.
For food he eats whatever small beans there are,
Or else for food he eats fruit.
Joyful and smiling, able to keep silence,
He joins mind with mind,
And constantly performs recitation and fire offering.
The person who contemplates the form of the deity
Should undertake every accomplishment
Of bringing under control.
Whoever, by this rite,
Knowing the ritual, undertakes the rite,
A majestic one or his son
Will come under his control within one month.
If he performs the fire offering for two months,

Male and female servants, yakṣiṇīs,
And likewise the maidens of the underworld
The mantrin will swiftly summon.
This, for now, in brief,
Is the proclamation of the fire offering for control.

This concludes the chapter on the ritual of the fire offering for bringing under control, from The Manifest Awakening of Great Vairocana, His Transformations, and His Empowerment.

Now I shall explain without omission
The rite of fierce conduct.
Yakṣas, mahoragas, cruel pretas,
Asuras, gandharvas, kiṃnaras,
Beings who delight in harm and are hostile,
Likewise obstructors and vināyakas,
Bhūtas, mātṛkās, rākṣasas,
Ḍākinīs and pūtanas,
And even humans who are arrogant, proud, and powerful,
Who do violent deeds or are hostile:
In order to tame them, the one who knows mantra
Should undertake the fierce rite.
Against minor offenses
The wrathful rite is not to be undertaken.

To the south of a town,
The one who strives in his vows, on black ground,
In a solitary charnel ground or a hermitage,
Or in an old pleasure grove, a peaceful place,
On the eighth day of the waning fortnight,
Or else on the fourteenth day,
On the day of Saturn or of Mars,
Under the lunar mansions that arise from wind,
Hasta and Citrā,
Aśvinī and likewise Uttaraphalgunī,
Punarvasu and Svāti:
These lunar mansions are fierce,
And on any one of them
The mantrin, wrathful like Yama,

Should draw the terrifying maṇḍala
That cuts off the life of the enemy.
With his own seal the mantrin
Empowers himself as Vajrasattva,
And, fearless in mantra,
Purifies the ground as before.
Then, with Acala of great power,
Having performed the taking possession and so on,
With the mudrā of his own syllable
He then makes himself Vairocana.
Taking there a blue thread
Spun by a young maiden,
He carefully lays the lines of the maṇḍala:
It is made triangular, and round on the outside.
Four cubits, five cubits, or eight cubits,
Or likewise twelve or sixteen cubits:
In keeping with the rite,
The wise one should determine its measure.
Then, with ash from a charnel ground,
Or with black pigment, the wise one
Places there the syllable ha,
Radiating a garland of blazing flames,
A form terrifying even to the fire at the end of time,
The color of a summer rain cloud,
Its mouth baring fangs:
Vajrapāṇi, wearing a diadem,
Who threatens all the hosts of Māra
And all who are hostile.
The one skilled in pigments, having placed
Such a syllable in those pigments,
The one endowed with wisdom draws the maṇḍala,
Marked with the sign of many banners,
With portico and door frame,
And the portions of the doors well divided.
The placing of the chief deity
Should be determined as before.
Having opened the northern door,

One should close the remaining doors.

Then, in the place of the noble Ākāśagarbha, draw the king of the wrathful ones, Yamāri, with the mudrā of the stake. In the place of the ūrṇā, draw the king of the wrathful ones, the noble one called Aparājita, with the mudrās of the vajra and the axe. In the places of Mahāsthāmaprāpta, the noble Bhṛkuṭī, and the noble Tārā, place Amoghapāśa, Ekajaṭī, and Hayagrīva, in that order, with the mudrās of the noose, the axe, and the vajra club. In the place of the Beautiful Destroyer, place the Chief Wrathful Moon with the vajra mudrā. The noble Acala, too, is placed with the mudrā of the club. Beside the doors, place the two, Durdharṣa and Abhimukha, with the mudrā of the club. In the place of the gods of the Pure Abodes, place Yama's Mṛtyu, the lord of death, together with Kālarātri. Nairṛti, too, is placed with the mudrā of the sword. Within the area for circumambulation, the fire pit should be made facing the door. Outside the maṇḍala, all around its circumference, draw banners.

The fire pit is made like the fire pit for the rite of control, with this distinction, that its outer rim is made round and marked with many banners. For the deities of the maṇḍala, imagine their individual forms as before and perform the rite of worship. Then, having worshiped the deities properly, empower oneself as Vajrapāṇi and give the torma of the directions outside, as before.

Here, the particulars of the unguents and so on are these. Offer a black unguent of red sandalwood mixed with turuṣka and charcoal. Offer flowers: blue utpala, blue aparājita, or other blue flowers. As incense, offer sarja resin blended with molasses. As the lamp, offer pungent mustard oil with a blue wick in a black lamp vessel. As the food offering, offer kṛsara and other foods that are pungent, bitter, and so on, together with side dishes of black color. Lentil rice, kṛsara, and meat and fish, cooked and raw, are given as the torma of the directions.

Having performed the torma rite properly, take fire from the house of a caṇḍāla or from a charnel ground, perform the purifying sprinkling with the king of the wrathful ones, and kindle the fire with wood from a charnel ground, or with bhallātaka wood, or with bibhītaka wood. Having empowered oneself as Great Vairocana, imagine the maṇḍala of wind at the base of the fire pit and place there the syllable hūṃ. One imagines that from that syllable hūṃ the form of the fire arises: black in color and exceedingly fierce, three-eyed, four-faced, unmoving and smoke-colored. He is hard to behold, tawny, with a

smoke-colored topknot and light rays like a blue rain cloud. He is big-bellied, wears blue garments, and bears a blue thread across his shoulder. Four fangs are bared in his mouth; he is wrathful, with his mouth gaping open. In his hands he holds a sword, a noose, a club, and a water pot. His heart bears the mark of a triangle, and he is marked with the syllable ra. His face is wrinkled in a frown. Together with the sound hūṃ, he blazes, black and rough, with a garland of radiating light rays like copper, and he abides as though the time of destruction had arrived. Having imagined such a fire, perform the purifying sprinkling and give unguents and so on with his own vidyā-mantra:

oṃ agnaye jāhi trad ṭa hūṃ phaṭ

Then give three oblations of kṛsara blended with pungent mustard oil, and give seven oblations of poison, blood, and mustard seed. Or else give kindling sticks of bhallātaka and bibhītaka wood, split with sharp points and dipped in pungent mustard oil and mustard seed. Then, imagining the lord of the maṇḍala and the other deities as before, offer oblations of those same substances with their own vidyās. Then imagine one's own deity as before and set it in place. Holding the substances that arise from one's own vidyā properly between the index finger and the thumb, recite the secret mantra wrathfully, and, adding phaṭ, offer oblations for as long as one wishes. Then, as before, one should rest by cultivating the awakening mind and so on.

Whatever mantrin performs
Such extremely fierce rites
Burns even the abode
Of the Thirty-Three like the finest grass.

Here too the rite should be performed in this way:

He wears glorious blue garments,
Is adorned with blue unguent and garlands,
And bears a blue thread across his shoulder;
He is always intent on the awakening mind.
He eats pungent, bitter, and astringent things,
And the food of kṛsara.
Skilled in the matter of arranging the deities,
Pure and supremely endowed with moral discipline,
Of great enthusiasm and with a courageous heart,
Wrathful like Antaka, the ender of the world,
Facing south and keeping silence,

As for his posture, he sits squatting.
Always diligent in fire offering and recitation,
Skilled in guarding and protecting,
Performing the fire offering at night,
He should undertake fierce conduct.

This concludes the chapter on the ritual of the fire offering of fierce conduct, from The Manifest Awakening of Great Vairocana, His Transformations, and His Empowerment.

Then once again the Blessed One Vairocana taught, to those who practice the conduct of bodhisattvas, the Dharma of the essential nature of the dharmadhātu: the domain of nondual emptiness, the cause of attaining nonconceptual wisdom, which is the heart of dependent origination; free of all elaboration, clear and pure, accomplished by the mind, completely perfect, and bringing to completion.

Then, at that time, the bodhisattva, the great being of great compassion, Avalokiteśvara, entered into equipoise in the samādhi of omniscient wisdom and said to the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi: "Lord of Secrets, how will those who follow it, abiding in the way of mantra, attain that which is the domain of omniscient wisdom, which accords with emptiness, grants the siddhis of all secret mantras, is without location, without characteristics, and without essential nature, is free of both the basis of characterization and the characteristic, brings about the attainment of the Great Vehicle, and bestows the nectar of immortality?"

When he had said this, the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, who reveals the secrets of all the tathāgatas, looked at the face of the Blessed One Vairocana and said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, since the bodhisattva of great compassion, Avalokiteśvara, who looks upon the mind streams of all sentient beings, is asking me this, Blessed One, please teach the Dharma that benefits beings and brings about the attainment of the Great Vehicle; the domain that is without characteristics and nondual; that grants the siddhi of the way of all secret mantras; the essential nature of the heart of dependent origination, which accords with the dharmadhātu and gives rise to the world systems of the ten directions; the Dharma of the domain whose essential nature is emptiness."

When this had been requested, the Blessed One Vairocana, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, who brings the three vehicles to completion, who causes omniscient wisdom to be attained, who frees from the ocean of all conceptual thought, who has all sentient beings in mind, who grants the siddhis of all secret mantras, who terrifies all obstructors, who summons all bhūtas, the inconceivable heart of all bodhisattvas, without form, without sound, without smell, without taste, without touch, without location, without mentation, without consciousness, without letters, without domain, inexpressible, without elaboration, the unmingled one, spoke thus to the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi:

"Of whatever dharmas arise from causes, their cause,
And also their cessation,
The Tathāgata has taught;
Thus the great śramaṇa has spoken.
Because the dependent does not exist,
The perfected too becomes otherwise.
The two do not exist;
The eight consciousnesses characterize the two."

Then all those of the great assembly who had gathered there, through the power of the miraculous display brought forth by their individual wisdom, understood the meaning of the two verses that had been spoken, each in keeping with their different intentions and different understandings. Those bodhisattvas then said to the Blessed One, "Excellent, excellent!" and offered these well-spoken words:

"Those who abide well in the way of secret mantra
And meditate on this very reality
Praised by the perfect buddhas
Will become buddhas themselves."

Then, at that time, the bodhisattva, the great being Avalokiteśvara, through the empowerment of the Blessed One Vairocana, said this to the Blessed One:

"If even through the unmingled mind itself,
Which has passed beyond recitation and conceptual thought,
Siddhi is attained,
What need is there to speak of conditioned things?
Whoever, having tamed through meditative equipoise
The mind that is like a horse,

Makes love and compassion firm,
Immediately attains stable siddhi.
Dharmas are forever unborn;
Their seed is the supreme a,
So the holy victors have taught:
a is called emptiness.
Since it is the mother of letters, the mother of all,
And likewise is endowed with the power to lead,
Unchanging and endowed with the unchanging,
Therefore it should be contemplated.
a and u,
ṛ, ḷ, and aṃ appear as supreme;
a is the holiest of the supreme appearances;
From it, it is taught, liberation is attained.
The ka class and the ca class,
Likewise the supreme ṭa class,
The ta class and the pa class,
These five together with their corresponding sounds,
And ya ra la va śa and the rest:
All are supreme victors, perfectly complete.
These are supreme in their vast meaning
And accomplish aims of many kinds.
By saying a, awakening is attained;
Likewise i is for summoning;
By saying u, killing is accomplished;
ṛ is for the rite of control;
o is the destroyer of rākṣasas;
Saying ai is held to be for binding;
au is the heart of the nāgas;
All of them are supreme and holy.
All the leading letters,
Endowed with ra and with the visarga,
When constantly joined with the dharmadhātu,
Through meditation and recitation bring the attainment of siddhi."

Then the Blessed One Vairocana said to the bodhisattva, the great being Avalokiteśvara:

"You have understood the realization of the ten grounds.
Great being, excellent, excellent!
You have explained the whole of the reality
Of the sugatas, perfect and inexhaustible.
You have realized the profound secret
Spoken by Vajrapāṇi."

Thus he gave his approval, saying, "Excellent!"

Then the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, said this to the Blessed One:

O hero, supreme victor, who turns
The wheel whose nature is the dharmadhātu!
Well restrained by the awakening mind,
With the mudrā of the hero of the world
And with the letter of nonarising,
Having likewise imagined oneself,
Through union with nondual emptiness
One should accomplish all the rites.
Having imagined the self, which is the completely pure dharmadhātu,
As endowed with the seed letter,
If one recites in equipoise and with faith,
One will attain siddhi.
Through bathing, confession, and so on,
Devotion to complete solitude,
And recitation that contemplates the mudrā and the garland of letters,
One attains stable siddhi.
If one practices with these mantras
That have become endowed with the dharmadhātu,
In the three realms of the moving and the unmoving
There is nothing that will not be accomplished.

Lord of Secrets, therefore, the one who performs recitation should establish the turning of the wheel in that rite of empowerment in his own maṇḍala.

This concludes the chapter on the arrangement of the letters for meditation and on empowerment, from The Manifest Awakening of Great Vairocana, His Transformations, and His Empowerment.

Then Vajrapāṇi said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, please explain to the bodhisattvas, through various means and in keeping with their intentions and inclinations, the inconceivable dharmadhātu, the manifest and perfect

awakening that comes about through the mind's perfectly passing beyond action. Sugata, please explain it."

Here, first of all, one should confess one's misdeeds individually with this rite: "All buddhas and bodhisattvas, please consider me. I, who am named so-and-so, from this time onward until I reach the heart of awakening, confess individually, in the presence of all the buddhas and bodhisattvas, all the misdeeds and nonvirtuous actions that I have committed, that I have caused others to commit, and in which I have rejoiced, while wandering in saṃsāra, in which births have no beginning and no end." This is done a second time, and likewise a third time.

Then, in the presence of all the buddhas and bodhisattvas, one should take refuge in the three: "All buddhas and bodhisattvas, please consider me. I, who am named so-and-so, from this time onward until I reach the heart of awakening, go for refuge to the buddhas, the blessed ones. I go for refuge to the dharmakāya of the tathāgatas, which is peaceful, unsurpassed, and to be known individually by oneself. I go for refuge to the Saṅgha of the great bodhisattvas of the four directions, the noble ones who are irreversible." This is done a second time, and likewise a third time.

Then, as for offering oneself: "All buddhas and bodhisattvas, please consider me. I, who am named so-and-so, from this time onward until I reach the heart of awakening, offer myself completely at all times to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas. Out of love for me, may all the buddhas and bodhisattvas please accept me." This is done a second time, and likewise a third time.

Then one should bind the samaya mudrā and recite the secret mantra:

namaḥ smanta buddhānān asame trisame samaye svāhā

Then one empowers oneself as the dharmadhātu:

namaḥ smanta buddhānān dharmmadhātu svabhāva ātmako 'haṃ

Then one empowers oneself as Vajrasattva:

namaḥ smanta buddhānān vajra ātmako 'haṃ

Then one should generate the mind set on awakening: "All buddhas and bodhisattvas, please consider me. I, who am named so-and-so, from this time onward until I reach the heart of awakening, generate the mind set on awakening just as the buddhas, the blessed ones, and the bodhisattvas generated it: free of all entities; rid of the aggregates, the elements, the sense

sources, the apprehended and the apprehender; one's own mind, because of the equality of the selflessness of dharmas, unborn from the very beginning, in the essential nature of emptiness. In the same way I too generate it." This is done a second time and a third time.

Then, binding the mudrā of fullness at the crown of the head and imagining clouds of incense, flowers, and so on throughout all the assemblies of the tathāgatas, one should recite this queen of vidyā-mantras three times:

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ abhismaye spharaṇa himāṃ gagan khaṃ dharmma dhātvā kāśa samatāya sarbba tathāgata pariṣadā maṇḍale mama praṇidhi puṇya jñāna balena sarbba tathāgata balena dharma dhātva dhiṣṭha na balena ca svāhā

The mudrā of fullness is that which is formed at the crown of the head like a lotus in bloom; that is the defining characteristic of the mudrā of fullness.

This concludes the chapter on the ritual of recitation.

Then the Blessed One Vairocana, having shown the inconceivable display of the dharmadhātu, and wishing once again to show the inconceivable domain, caused to emerge from the uṣṇīṣa on the crown of his head a net of light rays called Treasury of Dharma, which illuminates the dense thicket of the minds of the infinite realms of sentient beings. That array of the net of great light rays, through the vast display of the empowerment of the tathāgatas, circled around the tathāgatas who dwell in the palace of the dharmadhātu, vast as the element of space. It illuminated all the maṇḍalas of the assemblies of all sentient beings and set itself to protecting completely the realms of sentient beings without exception. It satisfied even the beings born in the destinies of the hells, of animals, and of pretas, and empowered the worlds of gods and humans as well to belong within the Dense Array of the Tathāgatagarbha. Then he empowered the inconceivable dharmadhātu too through the inconceivable concordant cause of the empowerment of the power of the tathāgatas' merit, and, since the purpose of the dharmadhātu had not yet been fulfilled, he entered into equipoise in the samādhi of the great king of maṇḍalas called Treasury from Which the Heart of Great Compassion Arises, the heart that completely protects the undetermined realms of sentient beings.

Having entered into that equipoise, he addressed Vajrapāṇi and the other vajra holders, as numerous as the atoms of ten buddha fields: "Sons of noble family, there is a maṇḍala called Source of All Tathāgatas, the king of the

heart that completely protects the undetermined realms of sentient beings. By relying on it, bodhisattvas will attain the ground of a tathāgata with little hardship, and will also directly realize the inconceivable dharmadhātu."

When he had said this, Vajrapāṇi and the other vajra holders, as numerous as the atoms of ten buddha fields, said with one voice: "Blessed One, now is the time for this; Sugata, now is the occasion for this. Excellent, Blessed One! Out of love for us, may the Blessed One please explain the empowerment of the arrangement of the great maṇḍala, whatever it may be.

Lord of the Dharma, sovereign of the Dharma,
Sovereign of the Dharma, free of Antaka (Death),
Teacher possessed of great wisdom,
You are the one and only sovereign of the grounds.
Your aims accomplished, your accumulations accomplished too,
You have passed beyond the burden and reached the end of existence.
Great king of physicians, you know reality.
In you there is no cessation, in you there is no annihilation;
You have entirely abandoned the two extremes.
Suchness and the true limit,
Free of elaboration, you have realized and understood.
You are refuge, abode, and island,
You are nirvāṇa and peace as well,
Liberation, free of fever,
Free of the taint of dust.
Free of expression and of all designation,
You utterly destroy all entities."

Thus all those vajra holders,
Their minds ever filled with joy,
Having rightly proclaimed his names,
Made their request to the Guide.
The omniscient one, the great hero, free of illness,
Having understood what they requested,
Said, "I shall explain the maṇḍala
Arising from the heart of great compassion."

Then the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, bowed at the feet of the Blessed One and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, what is the name of this maṇḍala?"

When he had asked this, the Blessed One said to the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, "Vajrapāṇi, the name of this maṇḍala is Universally Displaying the Appearance of Buddhas in World Realms Where There Are No Buddhas."

Then again the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, has the Blessed One not said that the tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly complete buddhas, are like space? In space there is no arising and no ceasing. Blessed One, if in the same way the tathāgatas too have no arising and no ceasing, then why, Blessed One, did you say, 'This is the appearance of buddhas in world realms where there are no buddhas'?"

The Blessed One said, "Lord of Secrets, when an emanated buddha has passed into parinirvāṇa, at that time, in those world realms, bodhisattvas who practice the conduct of bodhisattvas by way of secret mantra bring sentient beings to full maturity through the empowerment of the arrangement of the great maṇḍala."

When he had said this, the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, how wondrous! Those bodhisattva great beings who completely fulfill the aspirations of sentient beings, beings of differing faith whose dispositions are marked by attachment, aversion, delusion, dishonesty, deceit, and doubt, exactly according to their aspirations, should be known as doing what is extremely difficult."

The Blessed One said, "Vajrapāṇi, it should be known that those sons of noble family have not served just one buddha; rather, those sons of noble family have planted roots of virtue under many buddhas. They have also come forth through the three gateways of the illumination of the Dharma. What are the three? They are the way of illuminating the gateway of the approach of great compassion, the way of illuminating the gateway of the approach of the profound Dharma, and the way of making offerings to and honoring the tathāgatas. Those sons of noble family should be known to possess these three gateways of the illumination of the Dharma."

Then again the Blessed One, gazing with his two eyes of loving-kindness and great compassion upon the bodhisattvas dwelling in the great palace of the dharmadhātu, said to the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, listen to the characteristics of a master. First of all, the master is one who has generated the mind set on awakening, who practices the training of a bodhisattva, who is restrained by the bodhisattva vows, who is compassionate and of great faith, who abides in the profound Dharma, who is skilled in the way of the Perfection

of Wisdom, who is skilled in the arts, and who is clean and careful in his craft.

Trained in the practices of secret mantra,
In mudrā, in maṇḍala, and in ritual action,
Having received authorization from the guru
To perform the work of making maṇḍalas;
One who has become free of doubt
Toward the Buddha, the Dharma, and the supreme assembly,
And strives in order to protect completely
The realms of sentient beings without exception:
Such a learned one is fit
To draw the maṇḍalas of the buddhas.
Complete in all the marks, steadfast,
Upright of mind and courageous,
Able to pacify obstructors,
Whether for himself or for his students;
One whose inclination is vast
Toward realizing the meaning of perfect truth,
Patient and without pride,
Who performs vast deeds
And has faith in what is vast;
Who, hearing the aspirations
Of the bodhisattvas, the protectors, and the buddhas,
Rejoices again and again
And is always delighted;
Who strives in the practice of secret mantra
And makes effort in reciting recitations;
Who entertains no idle talk or guile at all,
And does not look to worldly concerns:
A mantrin devoted to mantra
Who possesses these and other such qualities
Is honored by the Teacher as a master.
Or else, one who abides
In the isolation of all phenomena
Is also fit to reveal
The appearance of buddhas, of all the buddhas.
Or else, one who knows the three samayas
Praised by the perfect buddhas,

And has entirely abandoned all faults:
A mantrin abiding in these,
Even if he does not possess every quality,
Is also fit to draw the maṇḍala.
If he possesses all such qualities,
Through having seen the rite of the action
He is fit to perform all maṇḍalas,
Both worldly and transcendent.

When that master is entreated by another, if he knows that the student earnestly seeks the goal and has faith in him,

Having known this, the master
Should carefully examine the ground.
Adorned all around with lakes, pleasure groves,
And ponds,
With trees bearing fruit and flowers,
And likewise with shrubs,
With fine and delightful saplings
Bearing fruit and flowers;
A land in which there are
Geese, cranes, peacocks,
Swans, parrots, and mynahs:
Diligently cultivate that land and resort to it.
Mountains with flowers and fruit,
Pure and lovely ponds,
Flowing streams of sweet water,
And rivers that circle to the right:
There the intelligent mantrin
Should draw the maṇḍala for the increase of wealth.
A land that is very fertile,
Temples and houses,
Shrines of the gods and cattle pens,
A solitary tree, and also a crossroads:
For peaceful rites, the wise one
Should draw a peaceful maṇḍala.
Empty houses or charnel grounds,
Barren places fit for fierce rites,

Foul, rough, and frightening,
Likewise thickets, harsh and terrifying:
In places such as these
Draw the maṇḍala of fierce rites.
In the fierce, perform fierce rites;
In the peaceful, perform peaceful rites;
In the abundant, it is increase itself:
That is the rite of increase.
Or again, wherever
The mind surely comes to feel joy,
In that place one should duly undertake
The work of drawing the maṇḍala.
For one whose mind is utterly pure,
Who has abandoned doubt and the like,
All rites will thereby
Be accomplished, without any doubt.
Nonconceptuality, free of conceptual thought,
Is awakening,
And it is attained by abandoning
Conceptual thought, not by anything else.
Therefore, in every way,
The intelligent one, having abandoned doubt,
Wishing to benefit the whole world,
The wise one should draw the maṇḍala.
There is no place, nor is there any time;
There is no act, nor any agent.
In all phenomena
There is only dharmatā.
Fools, obscured by ignorance,
Bewildered by causes and conditions,
Not realizing that phenomena are empty,
Are always under the power of Māra.
Therefore the Teacher, possessed of wisdom,
Knowing through realization free of elaboration,
Has taught the immeasurable Dharma
That abandons all conceptual thought."

Then again the Blessed One Vairocana entered into equipoise in the samādhi called King of the Array of the Ornaments of All Buddhas. As soon as the Blessed One had entered into equipoise, a light ray called Ornament of All Buddha Fields came forth from between his eyebrows. Having come forth, it illuminated everything. Having fully illuminated this buddha field, it made level as the palm of the hand all these fields adorned with the array of the flower-ground essence, which have arisen from the maturation of the tathāgatas, are richly adorned with divine portals, and whose features and the limits of whose qualities could not be fathomed even in hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of eons. Having thus empowered the inconceivable array of the tathāgatas, those light rays vanished into the crown of the head of the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi.

As soon as those light rays had vanished, Vajrapāṇi bowed at the feet of the Blessed One and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, please explain the empowerment of the arrangement of the great maṇḍala."

When he had requested this, the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva great being Vajrapāṇi, "Vajrapāṇi, listen to the empowerment of the arrangement of the great maṇḍala."

Saying, "Blessed One, I shall do so," Vajrapāṇi listened to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One said this to him: "Vajrapāṇi, in the places proclaimed above, the size of the maṇḍala should be made from one cubit upward to as much as one yojana. It should not be made larger than one yojana."

There the ground should be level and smooth,
Well smeared with fragrant ointments;
Or else the mantrin should diligently
Smear it with clean clay.

Then, having recited the secret mantra of all actions one hundred and eight times over pegs eight finger-widths long, if one drives them in evenly at the four corners, the maṇḍala will be empowered so as to be wholly unassailable by anything at all: namaḥ smanta vajrāṇān haṃ koṭaya same mahācaṇḍali hūṃ phaṭ.

Then, on the next day, one should gather the requisites of the maṇḍala, make the preparations, protect them with the secret mantra of all actions or with noble Acala, and have them placed on the north side of the maṇḍala. Or else, having empowered them, one should place them oneself. Then, on the following day, the students should be accepted: one should accept those who

have great faith, great cleanliness, who strive in the Dharma, who are of good family, and whose inclination is vast, whether one, two, three, or as many as one wishes. With the secret mantra of all actions, or of noble Acala, or of the Invincible One, one should tie three knots in a thread spun by a girl, or in some other thread, or even in kuśa grass.

Then, having consecrated it with mantra
A hundred times or even more,
So that the student's rites may be accomplished,
It should be tied on the left upper arm.
A tooth stick of udumbara wood,
Smeared with flowers, scents, and the like,
Very fine and well protected,
Eight finger-widths long, with a single tip,
Fine and pleasing:
The learned one should then give it.
Facing east or north,
They should chew the tooth sticks.
Then the intelligent one, not eating it,
Should toss it away without deliberating.
Wherever it falls,
Accordingly will accomplishment come from that.
Have them listen to the Dharma of the sūtras,
Such as the Perfection of Wisdom.
To make the students weary of saṃsāra,
Give a very excellent Dharma talk.
If they see good
Or bad dreams,
To examine their own fortune,
They should relate them to the guru.
Stūpas, monastic parks, temples,
Books and deities,
Wish-fulfilling jewels and precious cloth,
Or else finding flowers and fruit,
Swords, wheels, and lutes,
And the various substances of accomplishment:
Whoever dreams of obtaining these in a dream,
His accomplishment will be as he wishes.

Seeing the sun, the moon, fire, or weapons,
Likewise crossing the ocean,
Or riding upon elephants:
For him accomplishment is not hard to obtain.
From such good dreams
Supreme accomplishment may be inferred.
If one sees the opposite, dreams harsh
And frightening, there will be no accomplishment.
Donkeys, camels, and dogs,
Water birds, tigers, cats, and foxes,
People whose bodies are smeared with sesame oil,
Naked, coarse, and ugly:
Such bad dreams as these
The intelligent person should reject.
Or else, knowing things to be like dreams
And like a city of gandharvas,
The intelligent one should explain
That dreams are without essence.

Then Vajrapāṇi said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, what is the cause and what is the condition by which bodhisattvas who practice the conduct of a bodhisattva by way of secret mantra become firm of mind toward such dharmas from the very beginning?"

The Blessed One said, "It is like this: those sons of noble family possess great compassion and view all phenomena as utterly and completely passed into nirvāṇa, and they know the characteristics of ordinary beings to be mistaken and wholly devoid of characteristics. Therefore they are firm of mind and certain toward all of these."

Then again the Blessed One empowered the vast expanse of the inconceivable dharmadhātu and said to the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi: "Lord of Secrets, listen to the empowerment of the arrangement of the great maṇḍala. First, the master, having cleansed himself, should stand in the direction of Nairṛti, the southwest, and divide up the ground of the maṇḍala. Having bowed to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas and recollected the completely pure dharmadhātu, he should gaze upon the empowerment of the infinite, vast, and boundless array. Having gazed, he should empower himself as Vajrasattva, and with a cord of five colors,

Or else the learned one may do so mentally,
The wise one should divide
The fixed places of the deities.
Perfectly square and even,
With four gates and with archways,
With wide and extensive gateway enclosures,
It is drawn with a completely pure mind.
With powder of the five precious substances,
Or else with rice powder,
Or else with incense or with ashes,
The mantrin should draw the maṇḍala.
Square, with four gates,
The western gate should be left open.
Then one should recollect the queen of vidyā-mantras,
The great protectress, the Invincible,
Or else recollect Acala.
Having recollected the perfect Buddha,
One goes to the direction of Nairṛti.
Then, having stretched out the cord,
One circles around and returns.
Then the intelligent one
Goes to the northwestern quarter.
There too, facing east,
He stretches the cord toward the east.
Thus, knowing the method of the cord,
One should always strike the line properly.
Then, seated in the center,
Recollecting the tathāgatas:
The Protector Sarvāpāyajaha,
The supreme among humans, Amitābha,
Likewise Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin,
The Sage Saṃkusumita,
The Victor Vairocana,
The Great Sage, Victor over Māra,
Likewise the one called Akṣobhya,
And the Buddha Dundubhisvara:
There too the ascetic,

Diligently, should mark out the three portions.
Thus the one skilled in the rites,
Having examined the ground well,
The intelligent bodhisattva
Should also recite the Mother of the Buddhas,
Or else some other profound sūtra
That sets out the grounds.
Having recited it, the intelligent one,
Having wafted incense all around,
And having bowed to the sons of the supreme Victor
And to the buddhas,
The learned one should draw images
Of all the buddhas, or their mudrās,
Or else anything else at all:
All of these should be drawn."

Then again the Blessed One Vairocana said to the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi: "Lord of Secrets, there is a practice for accomplishing the mode of the inconceivable dharmadhātu, endowed with which bodhisattvas who practice the conduct of a bodhisattva by way of secret mantra will, with little hardship, liberate even the infinite realms of sentient beings from the ocean of existence."

When he had said this, Vajrapāṇi said this to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, please explain the bases of practice which, when they are endowed with them, enable bodhisattvas who practice the conduct of a bodhisattva by way of secret mantra to complete every rite and to please the tathāgatas as well."

When he had requested this, the Blessed One Vairocana empowered the vast mode of the dharmadhātu, and having empowered it with the vast basis of practice, he explained the excellent practice: "Lord of Secrets, in this, a universal monarch should draw a maṇḍala about one yojana in size. The site is a house made of fine sandalwood, the supreme uragasāra, hung with great bells and small bells and with canopies of jewels; perfumed with various incenses of fine aloeswood; encircled with threads of Jambu River gold; adorned above with nets of bells and small bells of various jewels; resounding with the sounds of various sweet-sounding drums. On the four sides there are

various archways, hung with garlands of pearls, draped with cloth dyed in various colors, and embellished with various arrangements and ornaments; and it should be brightly illuminated with various jewel lamps.

"Then, while remaining amid the assembly of the tathāgatas, one should empower oneself as the completely pure dharmadhātu, or as focused on its form, and bind the mudrā of the source of phenomena or the samaya mudrā. Then one should have those who follow the essential nature of emptiness take up the vows of the buddhas and bodhisattvas and the awakening mind. Then, in order to purify the unsurpassed eye of wisdom, one should show the samaya.

"Here, the mudrās of the inner maṇḍala are these. In the east one should draw the mudrā of all the buddhas, a triangle resting on a lotus. Its secret mantra is this: namaḥ sarvva buddha bodhi satvānān a sarvva traṇa ki svāhā.

"To the right of the Blessed One one should draw the mudrā of all the buddhas and bodhisattvas, a victory banner of the wish-fulfilling jewel. Its secret mantra is: namaḥ smanta buddha bodhi satvānān samanta amṛte jvala svāhā.

"Below it one should draw the mudrā of Samantabhadra, a sword, and a small maṇḍala of his abode. The secret mantra is: namaḥ sarvva buddha bodhi satvānān vajra rāja māla svāhā.

"To the left of the mudrā of all the buddhas one should draw the mudrā of the wheel of Dharma. Below it one should draw the mudrā of the Blessed One Śākyamuni, an alms bowl and Dharma robes. On the right side of the Blessed One one should draw the mudrā of the Eye of Space, resembling a uṣṇīṣa, resting on a lotus. Below the Blessed Lady one should draw the mudrā of the Supreme Vajra Giver, a vajra placed on an utpala flower. To the north of noble Samantabhadra one should draw the mudrā of Maitreya, a water flask. To the west of the Blessed One one should draw the mudrā of Avalokiteśvara, a lotus. To the north of the Blessed One one should draw the mudrā of King Acala, radiating infinitely and vast. To the south of the bodhisattvas one should draw the mudrā of all the vajra holders.

"Then the outer maṇḍala is made in three parts, leaving a strip for the circumambulation path. In the east one should draw the mudrā of all the hosts of messengers. In the southeast corner from them one should draw the mudrā of all the female messengers; the mudrā of the female messengers is a hook, and the mudrā of the hosts is a noose. On the southern and northern sides one should draw the mudrās of the male and female servants: the mudrā of the

male servants is a sword, and for the mudrā of the female servants one should draw a dagger and a vajra needle.

"Then one should recite the Blessed Mother, the Perfection of Wisdom. Having recited it, one should rise, circumambulate the maṇḍala, and bow to the buddhas, the blessed ones. Then the students, who have generated the mind set on awakening, who have faith, great cleanliness, who are firm in their commitments, who have taken the vows, whose intention is to protect all beings completely, who are greatly compassionate, whose faces are covered with a cloth, whose hands are not empty, and who focus their minds one-pointedly on the maṇḍala, should circumambulate the maṇḍala and stand at the gate of the second maṇḍala. Binding the mudrā of fullness, the mudrā of the source of phenomena, or the samaya mudrā, and reciting the samaya, one should lead them into the maṇḍala. Then one should have them cast a flower. Wherever the flower falls, that is their deity.

"Thus the one who is firm in the samaya should generate toward the master the perception that he is the Teacher, and the master too should generate the perception that the student is his child. Then, having observed whether their mental continuum is superior, middling, or inferior, one should give them the yoga rite for entering the practice of secret mantra. If this is done, they will see the samaya in this arrangement of the great maṇḍala. Whether or not they have entered worldly and transworldly maṇḍalas, they will have entered the samaya. One who has thus been empowered in the great maṇḍala, who is free of all evil, who has been born from the family of the tathāgatas, and who keeps in mind the complete protection of the infinite realms of sentient beings, should recollect the yoga rite of the practice of secret mantra."

Then again the Blessed One Vairocana gazed with his two eyes of great loving-kindness and great compassion upon the bodhisattva great beings seated in the abode of the dharmadhātu, and smiled slightly. Wishing to teach the unsurpassed, utterly pure dharmadhātu by way of entering the discriminating knowledges of the tathāgatas, he laughed a great laugh called Vowing to Deliver from the Whole Ocean of Existence, and from the maṇḍala of his great uṣṇīṣa a light ray called Source of the Domain of All Tathāgatas went forth in every direction. Having gone forth, that light ray, throughout the boundless world realms of the ten directions that pervade the expanse of space, illuminated all the bodhisattvas seated in the maṇḍalas of the assemblies of all the tathāgatas, and showed them the domain of entering the inconceivable dharmadhātu. It gazed upon the mental conduct of all sentient

beings and took as its object the infinite, completely pure dharmadhātu. It sported by way of the sport that teaches the sameness of phenomena, following the sport of the dharmadhātu, which is equal to space. With a wind maṇḍala of devotion, accomplished from the inconceivable maturation of the roots of virtue of the tathāgatas and accomplished from the intention of the tathāgatas, it richly adorned the buddha fields with ten kinds of array; and, having arranged the empowerment of the maṇḍala of the great array upon the surface of space, it remained there.

As soon as those great light rays had come to rest, this thought arose in the mind of the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi: "How wondrous it is that these light rays, arisen from the intention of the Tathāgata and displaying arrays never seen before, have covered the surface of space with various arrangements, have displayed the great sports of the tathāgatas, and have then vanished into the face of the Tathāgata! Therefore, surely the Blessed One now wishes to explain the Dharma discourse on the sport of all the tathāgatas, the completely pure basis for entering sameness through the pure mode of accomplishing the great discriminating knowledge. Therefore I shall ask the Blessed One."

Then Vajrapāṇi bowed at the feet of the Blessed One and said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, from the time the Blessed One first generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening until the Blessed One became manifestly and perfectly awakened, I have always been in attendance. Yet never before have I seen such a wonder as this: the Blessed One first laughing a great laugh as now, and then from the maṇḍala of the uṣṇīṣa on his head thousands of light rays going forth, as many as the particles in the atoms of ten buddha fields, and those light rays illuminating the world realms bounded by the limits of the expanse of space. Therefore I think, 'Since the Blessed One now wishes to explain to us the Dharma discourse that is the completely pure basis of the mode of accomplishing entry into the great discriminating knowledge, the manifestation of the perfect and complete awakening of all the tathāgatas, we have gained what is truly worth gaining.' Therefore, Blessed One, excellent! Out of love for us, please explain the Dharma discourse on the manifestation of the perfect and complete awakening of all the tathāgatas, the completely pure basis of the mode of accomplishing entry into the great discriminating knowledge. It will bring illumination to the beings of future times as well."

When he had requested this, the Blessed One said this to the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi: "Excellent, Lord of Secrets, excellent! That you ask about this matter is excellent indeed. Therefore, Lord of Secrets, listen well and keep it thoroughly in mind, and I shall explain to you the Dharma discourse on the manifestation of the perfect and complete awakening of all the tathāgatas, the completely pure basis for entering sameness in the pure mode of accomplishing entry into the discriminating knowledges of all the tathāgatas."

Saying, "Blessed One, I shall do so," the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, listened to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One said this to him: "Lord of Secrets, the basis of emptiness is the basis of perfect and complete awakening. The basis equal to space is the basis of perfect and complete awakening. The basis of characteristiclessness is the basis of perfect and complete awakening. The basis of the tathāgata is the basis of perfect and complete awakening. In this way, a bodhisattva should cultivate these bases of perfect and complete awakening. Lord of Secrets, this is the Dharma discourse on the basis for entering sameness through the pure mode of accomplishing entry into the discriminating knowledges of all the tathāgatas."

Then the Blessed One Vairocana empowered the vast, boundless, and infinite dharmadhātu, and entered into equipoise in the samādhi called King of Stainless Space, Maturation Vast and Infinite like Space.

As soon as the Blessed One had entered equipoise, a ray of light called Illuminating the Domain of All the Tathāgatas, Revealing the Infinite Expanse of Inconceivable Domains, came forth from the crown of his head. Having come forth, it showed its accord with all the tathāgatas, circled the Blessed One Vairocana many hundreds of thousands of times, lit up the world systems of the ten directions with a great radiance, and stayed in the sky above. It set out the great maṇḍala of the secret essence, and with the light of the three great samayas it illuminated the world systems to the very limits of the expanse of space. It blessed the realms of sentient beings so that the sprouts of the three samayas would grow in them, and then the rays of light descended from the sky and alighted on the crown of Vajrapāṇi's head.

The very instant the rays of light alighted on the crown of Vajrapāṇi's head, the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi attained the great samādhi called Arising of the Domain of the Tathāgata, and through attaining it he came to abide nondually on the ground of the tathāgatas. Then the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi, his mind satisfied with the joy of the tathāgata's wisdom, gazed for a moment at the

Blessed One Vairocana with unblinking eyes, smiled slightly, and asked the Blessed One with his mind:

How is one a tathāgata?
How is one a supreme victor?
How is one a bodhisattva?
And how is one called a buddha?
Protector, I pray that you, great sage,
Dispel this doubt of mine.
Then the bodhisattvas of great renown,
Having cast off doubt and hesitation,
Those sons of the victors, will practice
The Great Vehicle, the king of conduct.

When he had made this request, the Blessed One said to the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi, "Lord of Secrets, it is excellent, excellent, that you think to ask about such a matter. Lord of Secrets, rare are the beings who, on hearing such a basis for accomplishing the way of the Dharma, are not frightened and not terrified. Lord of Secrets, know that those sons of good family have not served just one buddha, but have planted roots of virtue under many thousands of buddhas. Therefore, Lord of Secrets, a bodhisattva who practices the bodhisattva conduct by way of secret mantra should first of all fully understand the realization of the Great Vehicle. Why is that? Lord of Secrets, a bodhisattva who has fully understood the realization of the Great Vehicle will accomplish the bodhisattva conduct by way of secret mantra with only slight difficulty. For this practice of the bodhisattva conduct by way of secret mantra is the thorough purification of the great superknowledges."

Then again the Blessed One Vairocana said to the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, "Lord of Secrets, therefore listen, and keep it well and thoroughly in mind, and I shall explain it to you."

When he had said this, the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi listened to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One spoke as follows:

"Phenomena have the characteristic of space;
They are nondual, of a single characteristic.
One perfectly awakened through the ten bases
Is called a perfectly awakened buddha.
Because even mere perception is abandoned,
His own nature cannot be shown,

And he is self-aware through wisdom:
He is said to be a tathāgata.
Awakening has the characteristic of space;
It is the abandonment of all conceptions.
Whoever wishes to realize it
Is called a bodhisattva.
Having accomplished the ten grounds,
He fully comprehends the masteries.
Phenomena are empty, like an illusion:
One who fully realizes this here,
And knows the mindstreams of all the world,
Is called a buddha.

"Lord of Secrets, these, then, are the establishment of the states of the bodhisattva's mind. Lord of Secrets, by this enumeration too, it should be known that bodhisattvas do not accomplish any fixed establishment of their own mind."

Then again the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, that the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the Perfectly Complete Buddha has so well explained to the bodhisattva great beings the Dharma discourse on the realization of the Great Vehicle is wonderful, Blessed One. It is most wonderful, Sugata. Blessed One, I do not say that those sons of good family, while they circle in the saṃsāra of the five destinies, have any fear of the bad destinies and the lower realms, any fear of the works of Māra, or any fear of being born in unfavorable states. Why is that? Because the great bodhisattva who abides in the realization of the Great Vehicle, although he lives together with the world, does not give up the path that transcends the world, and in order to bring sentient beings to maturity he also displays, through skillful means, all the activities of the world. Nor does he ever fall away from the realization of the Great Vehicle."

Then again the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi made this request to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, please explain the maṇḍala of the great secret essence. It will bring benefit and happiness to many people."

When he had made this request, the Blessed One said to the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi, "Lord of Secrets, therefore listen, and keep it well and thoroughly in mind, and I shall explain to you the setting out of the maṇḍala of the secret

essence.

"First of all, the master is skilled in distinguishing the three samayas, and he himself abides in the three samayas. Lord of Secrets, what, then, are these three samayas? They are three distinctive dharmas: the distinctive dharma that, in the times belonging to the three times, operates in an unobstructed way is called the three samayas. Lord of Secrets, what, then, is that distinctive dharma? Lord of Secrets, mind is the distinctive dharma. Lord of Secrets, in this, the thorough knowledge that all conceptualizations of mind are absent is the seeing of the perfect buddha. The aspect of self-awareness that realizes its dharmadhātu is the characteristic of the tathāgata."

"Whatever engages body, speech, and mind is the characteristic of emanation. Lord of Secrets, these are the three samayas. Since even all the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas do not realize them, what need is there to mention the other tīrthikas?"

Then the Blessed One spoke these verses:

"Childish beings obscured by ignorance,
Who have not come to know this way,
Seek the buddha somewhere else;
They do not realize that he dwells right here.
In no other world system whatever
Could a buddha ever be found.
Mind itself is the perfect buddha;
No buddha other than this has been taught.
Therefore the yogin,
Always casting off doubt,
Should examine the three kinds of distinction of mind;
Then he will know the three samayas."

Then again, having spoken these verses, the Blessed One said to the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi, "Lord of Secrets, in this, the master who is skilled in knowing the three samayas should resolve that he himself is the dharmadhātu, and through a practice that takes it as its focus he should purify the ground. Having thus purified the ground, by fully inclining toward what is like the expanse of space, he should bless himself as Vairocana, thinking, 'I am the domain of the unobstructed wisdom of the dharmadhātu.' Having thus blessed himself, for the sake of the purity of the dharmadhātu, he should, through the practice of nonduality, bless it so that the maṇḍala is in his own

body, or so that the maṇḍala is his own body. Then, with powders of five colors made by his own mind, or others will do as well, he should lay it out according to the earlier rite. Lord of Secrets, this is in order to protect suffering sentient beings. Lord of Secrets, one should perform the rite of entering the samaya of the essence."

Then again the Blessed One Vairocana performed such a blessing of the Dharma that through it bodhisattvas who practice the bodhisattva conduct by way of secret mantra would attain even the wisdom of the tathāgata in this single life alone.

Then the Blessed One, having looked upon the realm of sentient beings with his two eyes of great love and great compassion, said to the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi, "Lord of Secrets, listen to the basis of the blessing of the dharmadhātu, the basis for accomplishing blessing through which the omniscient wisdom of the tathāgatas, hard as it is to attain, will be firmly set even in the mindstreams of others, sentient beings who have not made merit."

When the Blessed One had said this, Vajrapāṇi joined his palms and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, wonderful is the mastery of wisdom of the buddhas, the blessed ones, who possess the strength of the ten powers, the leaders of the herd who roar the lion's roar of the four fearlessnesses. Blessed One, what son or daughter of good family of wise nature would not endure, for the sake of such omniscient wisdom, even the unbearable sufferings of the hell beings for eons bounded only by the limits of the expanse of space? Blessed One, therefore, the wise son of good family who wishes to train in this will train in following the Tathāgata. Blessed One, therefore, out of your kindness toward us, please explain those bases of the blessing of the dharmadhātu well."

When he had made this request, the Blessed One said to the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi, "Lord of Secrets, because they are the same as the characteristic of space, all phenomena have a single characteristic. Because the dharmadhātu cannot be apprehended, all phenomena have the characteristic of the blessing of emptiness. Lord of Secrets, these are the bases of the blessing of the dharmadhātu that I cultivated and practiced many times, from the time I practiced the bodhisattva conduct until I sat at the seat of awakening. Lord of Secrets, therefore, that is the unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening of the tathāgatas. Son of good family, when I was seated at the seat of awakening, through these I attained the door of the Perfection of Wisdom

called Abandoning All Conceptualization of Mind and Mental Factors. I also attained the dhāraṇī door called Proclaiming Infinite Sounds and Melodies, and the queen of vidyā-mantras called Melody That Defeats the Four Māras, which has no abode, is the domain of space, is without characteristics, without a goer, without an agent or an experiencer, and transcends all the courses of the world.

"Lord of Secrets, what, then, is that great queen of vidyā-mantras, infinite, boundless, and vast, that is to be taught?

namastraiyadhvīkānāṃ buddhagatepratiṣṭhitebhyaḥ apratihataśāsanebhyaḥ mahākṛpebhyaḥ gaganaamalarūpadhāraṇītathārūpavibhavavibhavena pararūpadharemahākṛpevimale sarvvagateviśodhani

"Here, this is the incomparable vajra word:

amahāvismayehūṃkhaṃ

"Vajrapāṇi, this is the queen of vidyā-mantras called Stainless like Space, blessed with the blessing of all the tathāgatas, the mother of all the buddhas and bodhisattvas. Son of good family, I have never seen a buddha field in which the tathāgatas do not explain and recite this queen of vidyā-mantras. Lord of Secrets, by this enumeration too, it should be known that a bodhisattva practicing the bodhisattva conduct by way of secret mantra who wishes to enter this maṇḍala of the secret essence, its mudrās, and its samaya should apply himself zealously to this king of the bodhisattva conduct by way of secret mantra."

Then the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, how do bodhisattvas who practice the bodhisattva conduct by way of secret mantra show the nature of secret mantra? How do they progress, up to attaining mastery over all phenomena?"

When he had made this request, the Blessed One said to the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi:

"Lord of Secrets, in this, a bodhisattva who practices the bodhisattva conduct by way of secret mantra should receive empowerment from a master. He should give rise to the thought, 'This master is my teacher, who urges me on toward unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.' Then he should approach with palms joined and make his request. The master, for his part, knowing that he seeks this aim, should make great compassion manifest and speak these words: 'Son of good family, arise! I shall show you the

unsurpassed eye of the tathāgata.'

"Then, having examined a pleasing site and purified the ground according to the earlier rite, he should draw a square maṇḍala with a single door, in which the places for distinguishing the deities are well determined, furnished with an array of various places of offering, with a vase filled with sweet-smelling scented water set in the center. The disciples are seated upon lotuses, abiding in the visualization that the form of their own deity is themselves, their minds become the awakening mind, intent on protecting all beings without exception, and wishing to be born into the family of the tathāgata. With that vase he empowers them from the crown of the head. He should also say, 'Son of good family, you are born into the family of the tathāgata. The eye of the tathāgata is opened.'

"Lord of Secrets, in this, bodhisattvas who practice the bodhisattva conduct by way of secret mantra should know that the form of the deity, whether it be as many bodies of the tathāgata as there are, or the particular guises of all the infinite sattvas, comes about through blessing by secret mantra and mudrā. Lord of Secrets, and what is blessing by secret mantra and mudrā like? Lord of Secrets, at the time of empowerment, the master, with the lotus mudrā, should set out a seat, conceived as firm, stable, inconceivable, and indestructible like a vajra, made of gold, copper, or clay, or else drawn as a picture. For the one seated upon it, in order that he may gain mastery over all phenomena, he should confer empowerment from the crown of the head with a vase filled with sweet-smelling scented water. The master himself should also resolve upon it in a corresponding way, or perform the corresponding act with its mudrā.

"With the mudrā and the secret mantra of the Dharma conch, he should bless the maṇḍala of the wheel of the tathāgata's speech. With the mudrā and the secret mantra of the sword, he should bless the destruction of all views of the perishable collection. With the mudrā and the secret mantra of the tathāgata's wheel of Dharma, he should bless the tathāgata's wheel of Dharma. With the mudrā and the secret mantra of the vajra, he should bless the destruction of the city of ignorance. With the mudrā and the secret mantra of the uṣṇīṣa, he should bless the crown whose summit is invisible. With the mudrā and the secret mantra of the ūrṇā, he should bless the possession of the ūrṇā. With the mudrā and the secret mantra that arise from all the limbs, he should bless all the limbs.

"Lord of Secrets, in this, the lotus mudrā is formed thus: join the two hands together, open them out from the wrists, and stretch out all the fingers with their tips even. This mudrā is the vajra seat of all the tathāgatas, supreme and of great power. This secret mantra is the door of all great marvels:

namaḥsmantabuddhānān gaganāmalaprabhāvajrābhedyanāmahakṛpātmakaḥ

"Here, these are the incomparable vajra words:

ativismayamahākṛpātmajaḥhūṃ

"Cross the two hands, join them back to back, and interlace the fingers as though locked with one another; turn the left thumb back, and join it with the right thumb at the nail.

This seal is the great mudrā,
Proclaimed as the wheel of Dharma.
The protectors of the world, the saviors,
Turn this supreme wheel.

namaḥsmantabuddhānān tathāgataamṛtevijayavarṇanasarvvajayagatadharthakārimahākṛpehūṃhaṃtrahimahādbhūtehūṃ

"From the secret mudrā, place the two thumbs in the palms, wrap the two index fingers around their bases, and raise the rest, keeping them in place.

This mudrā of the world's protectors, the saviors,
Which always swiftly accomplishes
The aims of all sentient beings,
Is renowned as the Dharma conch.

namaḥsmantabuddhānān tyadadhvabhagavatipratiṣṭhāte anantarusaravinirghoṣaṃ sarbatathāgatavākprasaravismayakadharamahādharamahādharamaṣkasarvvasatvasantośanārāmahāmahāhūṃ

"From that same secret mudrā, bend the two index fingers and hold them on top of the thumbnails in the manner of a sword.

This mudrā of very great power
Is renowned as the sword mudrā.
It severs even the innate
View of the perishable collection in all beings.

namaḥsmantabuddhānān amahākhaḍgaprajñātejitasatkāyadṛṣṭicchindanakāra tathāgatādhimuktinirjātavidhutasaṃkalpamahāmahāhūṃjaḥ

"From that same mudrā, stretch the two index fingers outward and hold them at the third joint of the two middle fingers, about a barleycorn's breadth apart, without touching, making it like a vajra; place the thumbs, the ring fingers, and the little fingers inside.

This mudrā, proclaimed
By the buddhas, protectors of the world,
Is renowned as the vajra mudrā,
Which destroys the city of ignorance.

Its secret mantra is:

namaḥsmantabuddhānān
mahāvismayatejodbhavamahācaṇḍadurdantātrabhañjahā

"From that same vajra mudrā, hold the two index fingers against the sides of the two middle fingers, in the shape of an uṣṇīṣa.

This is the uṣṇīṣa mudrā;
It is the protector of the world, the savior.
For whoever binds this mudrā,
This becomes the uṣṇīṣa.

Its secret mantra is:

namaḥsmantabuddhānān sarvvatraapratihatabhavatidharmmatābalinān sarvvatathāgatanodudharyabaśaya mahābudhāsarvvatathāgata adhiṣṭhānaadhiṣṭhātesphuramahāmahoṣṇīṣasvāhā

"Make a fist with the right hand and hold it between the eyebrows.

This seal is always proclaimed
As the ūrṇā of the supreme victors.

Its mantra is:

namaḥsmantabuddhānān
aśikhendubamaprabhasarvvasatvakleśasantapapraśamanāgaramahātidhara
sarvvatathāgataalaṃkāramahāpuruṣarūpadharakakotigatasvāhā

"Lord of Secrets, whatever it is through which bodhisattvas who practice the bodhisattva conduct by way of secret mantra abide close to the activity of the buddhas, it is these secret mantras and mudrās. Lord of Secrets, therefore, bodhisattvas who are blessed by these secret mantras and mudrās of the bodhisattvas by way of secret mantra, with bodies like a wish-fulfilling jewel of various forms, display in the realms of sentient beings bodies that accord with

whatever is needed to tame sentient beings."

Then again the Blessed One Vairocana said to the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi, "Lord of Secrets, in the maṇḍala of the secret essence there is the vow, and the awakening mind: possessing that vow, bodhisattvas who practice the bodhisattva conduct by way of secret mantra come to practice with body, speech, and mind restrained. Lord of Secrets, what, then, is the vow? Restraint is the vow: that which gathers in and thoroughly gathers in body, speech, and mind, and which dispels outer and inner suffering, is the vow."

When he had said this, Vajrapāṇi said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, how should a bodhisattva who practices the bodhisattva conduct by way of secret mantra take up the vow?"

When he had made this request, the Blessed One said to the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi, "Lord of Secrets, in this, the master should invite the deities, recite the Blessed Mother, the Perfection of Wisdom, and sit there facing the maṇḍala. He should call the disciples and instruct them thus: 'Child, receive the vow of entering the great samaya, which abides without obscuration in the three times.' The disciple, for his part, should join his palms, kneel, and say, 'Master, please heed me. I, who am called such-and-such, from this very moment today until I reach the seat of awakening, request the master to bestow upon me the vow of entering the great samaya. I wish to receive the command of the Teacher upon the crown of my head.' Then the master should also say this: 'Son of good family, consider! You who desire unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening should, until you sit at the seat of awakening, offer yourself with superior intention to the buddhas and bodhisattvas.'

"Lord of Secrets, this is the vow called entering the great samaya. Bodhisattvas who abide in this vow and practice the bodhisattva conduct by way of secret mantra are thoroughly restrained in moral discipline and firmly established in the unsurpassed moral discipline of the tathāgata. Lord of Secrets, therefore, a bodhisattva who wishes to train in this door of the bodhisattva conduct by way of secret mantra should apply himself zealously to this entering of the great samaya.

"Lord of Secrets, listen also to that awakening mind, possessing which a bodhisattva is born into the family of the tathāgata, and the wisdom of the past, future, and present buddhas, the blessed ones, becomes firmly established in him."

Then Vajrapāṇi said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, out of your kindness toward us, please explain that awakening mind."

When he had made this request, the Blessed One said to the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi, "Lord of Secrets, what, then, is awakening? Awakening is the essential nature of space. Space, moreover, is formless, indemonstrable, and ungraspable. Whatever is the characteristic of awakening is also the characteristic of mind. Lord of Secrets, therefore, mind, space, and awakening are nondual. In this, the realization of phenomena as sameness, the comprehension of the dharmadhātu, is unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. In this, the arising of mind in the manner of non-arising and in the manner of non-apprehension, Lord of Secrets, is called the awakening mind.

"Lord of Secrets, moreover, a bodhisattva realizes awakening through five bases of abiding. What are the five? Lord of Secrets, in this, bodhisattvas realize it as free of all entities. Some realize it as empty, like an illusion, eliminating the aggregates, the elements, the sense bases, the grasped, and the grasper. Some do so by focusing on phenomena. Lord of Secrets, however, a bodhisattva who practices the bodhisattva conduct by way of secret mantra should realize it thus: free of all entities, eliminating the aggregates, the elements, the sense bases, the grasped, and the grasper, through the sameness that is the selflessness of phenomena, his own mind, unborn from the very beginning, is the essential nature of emptiness."

"Lord of Secrets, in this, 'free of all entities' is the Tathāgata's teaching of the complete abandonment of the worldly path, in that here there is no self, no sentient being, no birth, and no person, but only aggregates, elements, and sense bases. 'Eliminating the aggregates, the elements, the sense bases, the grasped, and the grasper' is the establishment of the bodhisattvas' realization of the Great Vehicle by way of thorough knowledge of the realization of the śrāvaka path. 'Through the sameness that is the selflessness of phenomena': through it, bodhisattvas who practice the bodhisattva conduct by way of secret mantra see their own mind as unborn from the very beginning, and realize it as the essential nature of emptiness, without substance and without characteristics. Lord of Secrets, therefore a bodhisattva should give rise to a mind that has no abode, no obscuration, and is free of all elaboration.

"Lord of Secrets, by this enumeration too, it should be known that, for bodhisattvas rightly established in the Great Vehicle, apart from the door of liberation that is the accomplishment of the way of practicing secret mantra,

there is nothing that benefits unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Why is that? That perfect and complete awakening which bodhisattvas fully awaken to after striving and seeking for many eons and doing even what is hard to give up, bodhisattvas who practice the bodhisattva conduct by way of secret mantra will fully awaken to, as unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, in this very life. And why is that? Lord of Secrets, what is called 'life' is merely what the Tathāgata has us conceive of as birth. And that perception of those bodhisattvas ceases even before they attain the samādhi that comprehends the essential nature of all phenomena."

Then again the Blessed One Vairocana said to the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi, "Lord of Secrets, a bodhisattva who wishes to enter this maṇḍala of the secret essence and the samaya of the mudrās should abandon five things far away. What are the five? Avarice, harming sentient beings, doubt, laziness, and disrespect toward secret mantras and the like. Lord of Secrets, these five things should be abandoned far away by bodhisattvas who wish to enter the supramundane path in this very life. Lord of Secrets, for the bodhisattva who abides in these things, I do not declare that even the slightest part of the conduct of awakening is brought to completion. Lord of Secrets, why is that? These things are great obstacles to the awakening mind of bodhisattvas."

Then the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, how much will the merit increase of a son or daughter of good family who comes to abide in the samaya of this secret essence?"

When he had made this request, the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, "Lord of Secrets, can the limits of the expanse of space be known?"

He replied, "Blessed One, since the expanse of space has no measure, its measure cannot be taken."

The Blessed One said, "One might be able to know the limits of the expanse of space, but the measure of the merit generated by a son or daughter of good family who has seen the samaya in the maṇḍala of the secret essence cannot be known. Why is that? Lord of Secrets, this maṇḍala is seeing the appearance of a buddha. Lord of Secrets, what is called 'maṇḍala' is the chief essence, the culmination of all essences; there is no maṇḍala of the tathāgatas higher than it. It has become the essence of all roots of virtue, the abode, the refuge.

"Lord of Secrets, therefore a son or daughter of good family who wishes to enter this maṇḍala, mudrā, and samaya should go to wherever one may obtain entry into the maṇḍala, mudrā, and samaya, wading there on both feet

even if the world system were completely filled with burning embers. Toward those bodhisattvas who practice the bodhisattva conduct by way of secret mantra, those sons or daughters of good family should give rise to the perception of a spiritual friend, the perception of a father and mother, and the perception of a preceptor. Why is that? If one could not repay those bodhisattvas even by honoring them with one's own flesh and blood, how could one do so with any other offering? Lord of Secrets, how could one ever repay those bodhisattvas who practice the bodhisattva conduct by way of secret mantra, in reliance on whom the stream of hell beings is cut off, going to rebirth among animals is ended, and the aggregates belonging to the world of Yama cease to be? It should be known that those bodhisattvas abide as equal to the unequaled, are blessed with the blessing of all the tathāgatas, and have, like space, a domain without abode.

"Lord of Secrets, I shall instruct you; it should be known: in future times there will arise foolish people, who hold to objects of apprehension, attached to the view of the perishable collection, with distorted understanding, who have not settled the ground of their own minds, and who, confused, will say, 'This was not spoken by the Buddha; these were fabricated by fabricators.' Lord of Secrets, it should be known that those foolish people will go to two destinies. What are the two? They are the hells and the animal realm. Lord of Secrets, I do not declare that they have even the slightest cause in roots of virtue."

Why is that? Because they have set about cutting off the root. There will arise those overpowered by Māra, who create obstacles to the awakening of the buddhas, whose nature is corrupt wisdom, who have not trained themselves in the Great Vehicle, and who regard the Śrāvaka Vehicle as the essence. Toward the sons or daughters of good family who devote themselves to this Dharma discourse, they will speak abuse, saying, "How could those of corrupt moral discipline, who engage in evil things, have the awakening of a buddha?" Because those foolish people speak that abuse, they fall into the two lower destinies. For the conduct of practicing secret mantra was taught in this way by the Blessed One, the Omniscient One: he taught all of these for the sake of benefiting sentient beings. By giving rise to hostile thoughts toward them, they become ones whose lot is suffering. Why is that? It should be understood that those practitioners are holders of the secret of the tathāgatas, worthy of homage from the world together with its gods.

Then again the Blessed One Vairocana addressed Vajrapāṇi and the other vajradharas, as many as the atoms of ten buddha fields: "In order that those

sons of good family be guarded, protected and concealed, I entrust them into your hands, son of good family. You must guard those sons of good family constantly and without interruption. Protect them fully, and turn harm away from them."

When he had spoken thus, Vajrapāṇi and those other vajradharas, as many as the atoms of ten buddha fields, said these words with one voice: "Blessed One, Tathāgata, Lord of the Dharma, we shall do everything just as you have commanded. We shall guard those sons of good family until they reach the seat of awakening."

The Blessed One declared: "Excellent, excellent, sons of good family! Act in such a way that the teaching of the Teacher does not by any means perish."

Then the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, said to all those vajradharas: "Friends, what the tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly complete buddhas, accomplished through many hundreds of thousands of hardships is this unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Therefore all of you, applying yourselves with diligence, must guard those practitioners. Why is that? Through this it will be said, 'We act according to the command of the tathāgatas.' It will be said, 'We guard the teaching of the tathāgatas.' It will be said, 'We are equal to the unequaled.' It will be said, 'We hold the ten powers.' Therefore we must always strive to guard, protect and conceal this Dharma discourse. And we must strive to guard, protect and conceal those sons of good family as well."

When he had said this, those vajradharas said with one voice: "We must certainly do this, so that by all means the teaching of the Teacher may remain for a long time and not perish."

Then the Blessed One Vairocana, looking upon the beings of the future, so that this Dharma discourse might remain for a long time, and placing great compassion first, spoke these words of secret mantra:

namastraiyadhvikānān sarbbatathāgatānān sarbbatathāgatāsamatāgatigate ekaddharmmasambha sarbbasaraṇe vicitrarūpadhāriṇī sarbbasatatra abhiprāyabaripūraṇi sarbbabodhisatatragatamānase trahimaṃ sarbbaṅharmmasama mahāmahī vairocanagarbhasaṃbuddha sarbbatathāgata adhiṣṭhite trahite bhagavate hūṃ

Then Vajrapāṇi, authorized by all the tathāgatas and empowered by the blessing of the Blessed One Vairocana, made great compassion manifest and

spoke the subsequent tantra of this very text:

First the master makes himself clean. Then, with a mind that has become the sphere of reality (dharmadhātu), he transforms himself into Vairocana through his mudrā and secret mantra, and draws the maṇḍala.

The mantrin, in the rite of secret mantra,
Always following the preceding rite,
Having taken up white powder,
With a mind that has become compassion,
Always keeping Acala in mind,
Should first lay down the colored powder.
Then the second colored powder,
Red, he should take up and lay down.
The third colored powder, yellow,
He should lay down with great certainty.
Then he lays down one like emerald,
Then lays down one like sapphire.
Whatever color is taught for any deity,
That is the very maṇḍala of that one.
So too the color of the deity:
For pacifying, enriching and fierce conduct,
Its secret mantra is held to be the same.
This is the teaching of the secret.
Whatever secret mantras of the Tathāgata there are,
They are proclaimed to be of Mahendra.
Those of Padmapāṇi are of water;
Those of Vajrin are of wind.
The messengers and the other servants,
And whatever belong to the class named the wrathful ones,
Who act everywhere without obstruction:
For all of them the maṇḍala is fire and wind.
Or else all of these
Possess the full force of efficacy.
Sated with the nectar of emptiness,
Their eyes of compassion are stainless;
Well clad in the armor of loving-kindness,
Endowed with the prowess of stainless joy,
They strive intently to draw out

The beings sunk in the ocean of existence.
They do not abide in saṃsāra,
Nor do they dwell in nirvāṇa;
Having settled on the very limit of reality,
They work for the benefit of sentient beings.

Then the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, looking upon the maṇḍala of the assembly in its entirety, spoke these words:

What this Teacher, the Omniscient One free of evil,
The Blessed One, will explain
With certainty: the occasions
On which obstructors arise,
Listen to it, all you friends.
Obstructors are of many kinds:
Gods, asuras, yakṣas and humans.
Among these, obstructors are of two kinds:
Those whose sphere is outer and those whose sphere is inner.

Coughing, shortness of breath, fever and vomiting,
Pallor sickness and loss of appetite:
These and other such fevers,
Which arise in unbearable forms
From wind, cold, heat and the like,
Should be known as the inner obstructors.
The great outer obstructors
Are humans and likewise nonhumans.
These thorns to wisdom
Arise, through conduct of many various kinds,
In order to bring the world to ruin;
They bewilder those who abide in austerity.
Through the ritual of action that has been seen,
One should turn them back again.
Obstructors that come having become heat
Should be pacified by what is cooling.
The wise one, by means of the antidotes,
Should cure each of them in turn.
Or else, for all the obstructors,
Once the mantrin has firmly set the boundary,

Wisdom is declared to be supreme
In pacifying all obstructors.

Here ends the great maṇḍala blessing called The Arising of the Tathāgatas, from the noble Great Vairocana's Manifest Awakening, Emanation and Blessing, the king of Great Vehicle sūtras, the supreme of secrets, set out in sequence.

It was translated, edited and finalized by the Indian preceptor Śīlendrabodhi and the chief editor-translator, the monk Paltsek.

Translator's Notes

• This is the opening of the Mahāvairocanābhisaṃbodhi Tantra. The names of the vajra holders are translated by meaning (apart from Nārāyaṇa and Vajrapāṇi), since their Sanskrit forms cannot all be confirmed with confidence from the Tibetan alone. "Having blessed the day of the Tathāgata that transcends the three times" renders □□□□

through five refers to the multiplication of the basic mental states into the one hundred and sixty worldly minds. "Ground of conduct through devoted interest" renders adhimukticaryābhūmi.

• "Conferred together with all the tathāgatas" reads the Tibetan "de bzhin gshegs pas thams cad" as "de bzhin gshegs pa thams cad"; the stray instrumental appears to be a slip. "Resolute" renders zung thub, whose exact sense here is not certain. The chapter title in the colophon renders sems kyi khyad par rim par phye ba.

• "Monastic quarters" renders gra gang, which is unclear as written; it is read as grwa khang. The line "In all phenomena there is nothing whatsoever" renders the obscure "yong med"; the sense of this and the following line ("merely partial," nyi tshe) is uncertain. "Self-arisen protectors" (rang mgon) most likely refers to pratyekabuddhas. Saṃkusumita renders me tog kun rgyas; the full form of this buddha's name is often given as Saṃkusumitarāja.

• "Its center is called the essence, and its circle is completeness" explains the two parts of the Tibetan word for maṇḍala, dkyil and 'khor, corresponding to Sanskrit maṇḍa ("essence") and la. "Tomorrow, when midday has passed" renders sang gi gdugs 'das nas, whose precise sense is somewhat uncertain. The Mother is presumably the Mother of the Buddhas, the Perfection of Wisdom.

• "The one of great might, holding a lotus" (mthu chen) is presumably Mahāsthāmaprāpta; the Tibetan gives only "great might," so it is translated rather than named. The cord-stretching directions are given as the Tibetan states them; some of them (such as stretching "toward the north" from the northeast while facing west) are terse and their exact geometry is not certain.

• "Vajra Point" (rdo rje rtse mo) is translated literally; the corresponding figure in the Chinese version is Vajrasūcī, but the Sanskrit underlying this Tibetan is not certain. "Krodhacandra, the Lord" renders khro zla gtso bo; the Chinese parallel names this figure Krodhacandratilaka. In the Trailokyavijaya verse, lag na rdo rje rtse bran rgyan is read as "foremost attendant (rtse bran) and ornament of Vajrapāṇi," which fits the following line about receiving his command; the phrase is unusual. Among the Pure Abode gods, "Garland of Light" and "Far-Renowned" are translated literally because their Sanskrit forms cannot be fixed with confidence. Of the three uṣṇīṣas to the right of Ūrṇā, the first two names, Greatly Arising and Upward Arising (likely Abhyudgata and Udgata or similar), are rendered literally for the same reason.

• The figure in the third section, here rendered literally as "the Giver of the Supreme Vajra," occupies the position and has the iconography (saffron color, five locks, youthful form, blue utpala with vajra) that the maṇḍala of this tantra assigns to Mañjuśrī; the Tibetan epithet is translated as it stands. The water pot renders gunde, taken as kuṇḍī or kuṇḍikā. "The Wondrous Hero" (dpa' bo ngo mtshar can) is translated literally because its Sanskrit form is uncertain; the Sanskrit forms of the other seven bodhisattvas in that list follow the standard names of this maṇḍala. The line "brgya lam na ni res 'ga' zhig / 'byung 'gyur yang ni mi 'byung ngo" is understood to mean that buddhas appear only rarely and in some ages not at all. The meaning of the assembly's final line ("dbang du gyur") is taken as gaining mastery through the question being asked.

• The explanation of "color" (tshon) rests on a wordplay in the Sanskrit original, where the word for color is related to the word for attachment or delight; the Tibetan conveys this by saying beings cling to it and that it is the flavor of the dharmadhātu. "O fearless one" takes 'jigs med as an address to Vajrapāṇi; it could also refer to the successive enclosures. In the verse on the bodhisattvas bound to one more birth, "the ground of the purpose" renders dgos pa'i sa literally; the Chinese version here speaks of the ground of faith and understanding, and the Tibetan wording is unusual. The last line of the eighth-ground verse ('jig rten 'jig rten dbang du 'dod) is difficult; it is taken to mean that the world regards such bodhisattvas as its masters.

• "The purification of karmic life" renders las tshe rnam par sbyang; the Chinese version reads this as the purification of karmic birth. In the syllable list, the glosses follow the Tibetan as it

stands even where they differ from the Sanskrit wordplay preserved elsewhere: for ka the Tibetan has "intention" (dgongs pa), where a gloss on action (kārya) would be expected, and for gha "utter ruin" renders gcig tu 'phungs pa, where the Chinese has "compactness."
• Several food offerings are obscure in the Tibetan and are given in transcription: gorbö (gor bod), mathuśira, phena, aśokavarti, parpaṭa and hvak (hwags) are likely Indian names for particular sweets and cakes, and their exact identity is uncertain. "Pale cakes" renders khur skya, and "sugar candy" renders li kha ra. The drawing of the places of the fire "in triangular form" takes mdo ru in that sense, which is uncertain.
• The names of the four vajra holders are given in their attested Sanskrit forms (Niṣprapañcavihārin "Abiding without Elaboration", Gaganāmala "Stainless Space", Vimalanetra "Stainless Eye", Vicitrāmbara "Wearing Various Garments"). Of the four companion bodhisattvas, only Dhāraṇīśvararāja is rendered in Sanskrit; the other three are translated from their Tibetan meaning, as their Sanskrit forms could not be identified with confidence. The four emblems on the remaining petals are likewise translated by meaning. The golden probe is the eye-surgeon's instrument (śalākā) used to remove cataracts, the image underlying the verse that follows. The phrase rendered "the Tathāgata need no longer be greatly concerned" (literally "the Tathāgata will not need to think greatly") apparently means that where such initiates dwell, the Tathāgata's work is already being done.
• The phrase rendered "abiding in unobstructed understanding" could also be taken as "abiding in an unobstructed rite (kalpa)"; the Tibetan rtog pa admits both. The sentence beginning "there exist" has no expressed subject in the Tibetan; from context it refers to the protective mantras the Buddha is about to reveal.
• In the instructions for binding the wind, "the quarter of the wind" is the northwest, the direction of Vāyu. The Tibetan names the bodhisattva here as "Samanta-Avalokiteśvara" and his samādhi as "Samantāvalokita" (Looking Everywhere); the bodhisattva is given simply as Avalokiteśvara. In the sentence about deities abiding in their own maṇḍala places, the grammar does not state the subject explicitly; it has been taken as the deities, which fits the verse on deity colors that follows.
• The deity rendered "the Chief of the Wrathful Moon" (khro zla gtso bo) is translated by meaning, as its Sanskrit form could not be identified with confidence. Likewise "the Vajra Point" (rdo rje rtse mo) and "the Vajra Chain" (rdo rje lu gu rgyud, probably Vajraśṛṅkhalā) are given in English. "Attendants" renders phyag brnyan, the servant-messengers of Vajrapāṇi's retinue. The gatekeeper gdul dka' ba ("Hard to Tame") is given as Durdānta, which matches its mantra.
• Several deities in this list are given in English because their Sanskrit forms could not be identified with confidence: the Great Hero, the Lord of Waters, the Wondrous One, the Giver of Fearlessness to All Beings, the Purifier of All Lower Realms, the One Tormented by Compassion, the Pacifier of All Torment, the One Who Has Attained Dhāraṇī, the One with the Jewel Mudrā in His Hand, and the One of Firm Intention. "With a tranquil mind" renders des pas, which may be a slip for dad pas, "with faith".
• The places listed for the rite include "a shrine of a single liṅga," taking □□□□□□□□ as Sanskrit ekaliṅga, as in the Indian lists of sites; it could also be read "for a single night." □□□□□□ in that list is rendered "a peaceful place" rather than "calm abiding," since a location is meant; it may stand for a shrine of Śiva (śivālaya). "Life-force and exertion" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, the two halves of prāṇāyāma, which the text then glosses as wind and mindfulness.
• The names of the two vidyā-mantras, Intoxicating and Swift as Thought, are translated from the Tibetan since their Sanskrit forms cannot be identified with confidence; the second may render manojava. "The lord of the desire realm" is probably Māra as ruler of the Paranirmitavaśavartin heaven, but the text does not name him.
• The door guardian □□□□□□□□ is translated by meaning, "Hard to Tame," since its Sanskrit form cannot be identified with confidence; it may correspond to Durdharṣa, who appears with

Abhimukha among the gatekeepers in this tantra. □□□□□□□□□□ is taken as eye ointment (añjana), a standard substance in siddhi rites, and □□□□□□□ as bezoar (gorocanā). In the prose about austerities, □□□□ is read as □□□□, "to strive," which the sense requires.

• □□□□□□ is here rendered "a person of splendor," the object of the subjugation rite; the glossary's nāga-king reading Manasvin does not seem to fit, and the verse that follows suggests a ruler ("lord of men"). The verse itself is terse: the syllables A and PA appear to stand for the practitioner and the target, marked with a lotus and a conch.

• The Mahendra maṇḍala (□□□□□□□) is the square, yellow maṇḍala of the earth element, associated with the syllable A, as VA is with water and RA with fire in what follows. In the list of substances, □□□□ ("what is called clear") is obscure and may be a corrupt reading. □□□□□□□□ is normally "bull"; in a list of white substances it may refer to something from a bull or to choice crystal, so the reading is uncertain.

• "Here, at this heart of awakening" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, taken as a metrical inversion of □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, the seat of awakening (bodhimaṇḍa). "Mahendra," on which the practitioner is seated, here denotes the earth maṇḍala (the square yellow seat associated with Indra), as elsewhere in this text. The syllables RA, VA, HA, A and KHAṂ correspond to fire, water, wind, earth and space respectively. Vajradhara at the end is Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets.

• The last two lines of the closing verse of the chapter on accomplishing siddhi are terse; they are taken to mean that those who have attained this wisdom abide throughout the world and teach it, though the subject is not explicit. "Gentle śrāvakas" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□, taking □□□□□ as "gentle, disciplined."

• The lines on recitation are terse. "With its limbs left deficient" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, taken as a warning against reciting without completing the prescribed limbs of the practice. "The count of secret mantra, three hundred thousand" is read as the standard number of recitations for the approach.

• "The Sage of golden light" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ as a descriptive epithet; it is not identified here with a specific named buddha. "Vajrapāṇi, adorned with pointed tips" renders the obscure □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, apparently referring to the prongs of the vajra. "Bound to one more birth" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (ekajātipratibaddha).

• The protectresses Fearless, Remover of All Fears, Hard to Tame and Vajra Tamer of the Untamed are given in English because their Sanskrit forms cannot be fixed with confidence. "The Bestower of the Sacred Vajra" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ literally; the description (youthful, five locks of hair, saffron color, utpala bearing a vajra, seed syllable maṃ) is that of Mañjuśrī, who occupies this place in the maṇḍala.

• The "three dharmas" whose path one is kept from transgressing are not specified in this passage; commentaries on this tantra relate them variously (for example to the three vehicles or to body, speech and mind). The phrase "empowered by itself" in the vajra-mudrā verse renders an elliptical line that may also be read as "shown through the buddhas' own empowerment."

• In the fang mudrā, the Tibetan reads □□□□□ "praise," which makes no sense in a hand gesture; it is taken as □□□□ "point, direct," and rendered "hold them pointed." The name of the great protectress, rendered literally as "Unbearable," could not be securely matched to a Sanskrit form. The "specific knowledges" are the four pratisaṃvids of a buddha.

• The female attendants (□□□□□□□□□□) are the servant goddesses of Mañjuśrī's retinue; no single Sanskrit name is given here, so the term is rendered descriptively.

• Several of the bodhisattva names here are given in their Sanskrit forms as known from the retinues of Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin and Kṣitigarbha in this tantra: Apāyajaha (□□□□□□□□□□□□□), Maitryabhyudgata (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□), Karuṇāmṛdita (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□), Acintyamati (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□), Ratnapāṇi, Viśuddhamati and Gaganāmala. The closing line "of □□□□□□□□□□□□□" after the five-pointed vajra mudrā is an abbreviation that, in

context, refers to the One with the Jewel Mudrā in His Hand rather than to Ratnapāṇi. "Krodhacandra" renders □□□□□□, the wrathful deity elsewhere called Krodhacandratilaka; "Vajra Point" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is given in English because its Sanskrit form (perhaps Vajrasūcī, as the mantra suggests) is not certain.

• The uṣṇīṣa deities and the gods of the Pure Abodes are given in their Sanskrit forms where these are standard for this tantra's maṇḍala (Sitātapatra, Jayoṣṇīṣa, Vijaya, Vikiraṇa, Tejorāśi, Mahodgata, Abhyudgata, Anantasvaraghoṣa, Samantakusuma, Raśmimālin). "Proclaimer of Sound" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) and "the One Without a Frown" (□□□□□□□□□) are rendered literally because their Sanskrit forms could not be identified with confidence. Among the mātṛkās the Tibetan reads □□□□□, "Brahmā," where the female Brāhmī might be expected; it is kept as written. Here □□□□□ is used in the sense "raise."

• In the final paragraph, "those who experience the fruits of action, lifespan and karmic maturation and of those who cause them to be experienced" renders a compressed Tibetan phrase (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□); the emanated bodies appear in the guise of beings of every kind so as to suit each being. The two verse-like lines about understanding by the intellect are set as verse following their seven-syllable meter.

• In the maṇḍala-on-the-body verse, the line read "then in the village (□□□□) as far as the heart" makes no sense; it is translated as "above that" (□□□□), the evident reading in the sequence feet-to-navel, then up to the heart.

• In the line "auspicious and praised by the worlds," the Tibetan writes □□□□ ("mantra"), which makes no sense here; it is read as □□□□□ ("praised"), as in the parallel closing line "praised by kings." The four kinds of disciple are given compactly in the Tibetan (one accomplished at once, one in two stages, one neither, and the one complete in all characteristics); the rendering follows that wording without expanding it.

• The verses on the inner and outer fire offerings are terse, and the precise referents of "three components, three places, and abides in three" are not spelled out in the passage itself; they are rendered literally. "The sixth fascicle" marks a division (bampo) of the Tibetan text.

• "The vidyā Bhogavatī" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, and "all the glorious ones" renders □□□□□□□□; the precise identity of the latter group of goddesses is not certain. □□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered literally as "Vajra Point," since its Sanskrit form cannot be fixed with confidence. In the tathāgata maṇḍala, "rays should be made, twofold" follows the wording as it stands (□□□□□□□□□□), whose exact sense is unclear.

• The names of the Vajradharas in the opening list are given in English, since their Sanskrit forms cannot all be identified with confidence; the line division of some (for example "the Gentle One" as a separate name and "the Other Vajra") is uncertain. The Tibetan "rgyal dang rnam par rgyal ba" beside the Sun is taken as the goddesses Jayā and Vijayā, the Sun's attendants, distinct from the uṣṇīṣa deity Vijaya earlier. "gnyer ba'i lag pa," rendered "the hand of devotion," is uncertain. "skem byed" is taken as Skanda and "dka' zlog" as Umā.

• "The words of the twelve limbs" are presumably the twelve syllables placed on the disciple's body after the purifying burning; the text does not specify them here. The final line of the verse on the pledge ("dam tshig can ni gzhan mi bya") is terse; it is taken to mean that the pledge holder is to be regarded as no different from the Buddha.

• The "double dot" of the maṇḍala of the abiding Dharma renders klad kor gnyis, as in the preceding passage. The phrase "klad kor can snyems pa dang bcas pa," rendered "bearing the anusvāra, and majestic," is uncertain. "Bless oneself as the Vajrasattva of action" renders "bdag las kyi rdo rje sems dpar byin gyis brlabs"; it could also be read as a reference to Karmavajrasattva. The list of "thorns" corresponds to the standard list of wrong views of a self (ātman, sattva, jīva, poṣa, manuja, mānava, kāraka).

• "Eating food one has not taken up" renders "ma blangs pa'i zas," probably food that one has not solicited or accepted in the ordinary way; the precise ascetic practice is not specified. The

line "In the waxing fortnight of the moon" has no expressed main verb in the Tibetan and is left as it stands.
• Two body places in the arrangement of letters are uncertain: "chu sor," rendered "the bladder," and "nam mtshong," tentatively rendered "the eyes" for the syllable ra. The armpits are given twice (for da and for u ū) as the Tibetan stands. "The Vajra Holder" (rdo rje can) and "Padmapāṇi" (phyag na padma) are taken as the heads of the vajra and lotus families.
• "Protected by a sign" renders mtshan ma; it likely refers to a woman marked as betrothed or under some other protective token, but the Tibetan does not specify. In the passage on idle chatter, "the bodhisattva's cause will continue without interruption" renders rgyu yang bar du gcod pa med pa; rgyu could also be read as "wandering," giving "his course through saṃsāra will be unbroken." The phrase "carries out what has been commanded" renders bka' grub par byed pa, describing the śrāvaka training as mere observance of precept.
• The five bases of training listed for the householder bodhisattva here are abstention from killing, stealing, sexual misconduct, lying, and wrong view; the text names wrong view where the usual list has intoxicants, and the translation follows the text. "Vajrapāṇi" directly after the mantra is taken as an address opening the verses that follow.
• "This ocean of world systems adorned with the essence of the flower base" renders the Tibetan descriptively; it most likely corresponds to the Kusumatalagarbhavyūhālaṃkāra world system familiar from the Avataṃsaka, but the Sanskrit form is not certain, so the name is translated.
• The letter linked to "existence cannot be observed" is written pa, the same letter as for ultimate truth just before it; in the order of the alphabet one would expect bha (for bhava, existence). The translation keeps the letter as written. Several statements, such as "free of suchness," "free of giving," and "free of peace," are rendered literally as the Tibetan gives them; each plays on the Sanskrit word beginning with the letter in question.
• "Multiplied tenfold" renders "the ten minds transformed into ten kinds," the arithmetic that yields the hundred syllables. In the verses on the lord of secret mantras, fire, water, wind, the sun, and the moon are named as elements and celestial bodies that he is not, so they are rendered as common nouns rather than as the deities Agni, Varuṇa, and Vāyu.
• The ten □□□ here, beside the ten grounds, are the ten masteries (vaśitā) of a bodhisattva, not empowerments. The forty-four fires are given in this Tibetan with Indian names partly transliterated and partly translated; translated names that could not be identified with confidence (Brahmā's Food, Side-Guardian, Holder, Joiner, Treasure, Giver of Strength, Desire-Born, Messenger, Terrifying, World Holder, Stupefier, and others) are rendered by meaning, and transliterated ones (Śadvi, Avanika, Vicici, Havi, Mṛṭa, Dāruṇa) are given as the Tibetan spells them. The line about Side-Guardian and Atharvan is obscure, and the phrase rendered "russet in its coloring" (□□□□□□) is uncertain. Brahmā's address "O Great Brahmā" is kept as the Tibetan has it.
• "Even if a buddha had made them" renders literally a line whose sense is that nothing can protect the obstructors from this wrathful practice. The "bindings" (□□□□□□) introduced by Vajrapāṇi are bodily postures and mudrās.
• The lunar mansions are identified from their standard Tibetan names. The vidyā queen named □□□□□□□□□ beside Māmakī could not be identified with confidence and is rendered by meaning as "Beautiful Destroyer"; the same Tibetan elsewhere renders the name Sumbha. The "Lotus Holder" is presumably Avalokiteśvara. The syllable ra is contemplated as removing dust (Sanskrit rajas).
• The deity or mantra □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ could not be identified with confidence and is rendered by meaning as "the Supreme Vajra Giver." The substitute for sandalwood, □□□□□□□□□, and the incense □□□□□□□□ are unidentified plant substances and are given as the Tibetan spells them. "The king of the wrathful ones" here is presumably Acala.

• The planets and lunar mansions are identified from their standard Tibetan names. The figure called "Mahāśrī, the Noble White Lady" may correspond to Mahāśvetā; the name is rendered as the Tibetan gives it.
• The syllable placed in the Mahendra (earth) maṇḍala is given in the text as ya, and is translated as written. The material of the alternative lamp vessel (khams pa) is uncertain; "clay" is a tentative rendering, and brass or bell metal is possible. The thickness measure of the kindling sticks (chang gang) is uncertain; "a thumb in thickness" is tentative. The implement "gundhe" is a transliterated Indic word that I cannot identify with confidence and is left as written.
• The deity name gtsug spyod is rendered literally as "Crown Conduct," since I cannot identify its Sanskrit form with confidence; "Vajra Hook" (rdo rje lcags kyu, perhaps Vajrāṅkuśa) is likewise given in English. The dye le brgan, used for the thread, is rendered generically as "crimson." "A majestic one" (gzi brjid can) probably refers to a powerful person such as a ruler.
• "With his own seal" renders rang gi rgyas, which is terse; it likely refers to the mantrin's own mudrā. The figure placed in the place of the Beautiful Destroyer, khro zla gtso bo, is rendered literally as "Chief Wrathful Moon," as I cannot identify its Sanskrit form with confidence. "Stake" for gsal shing is tentative.
• The second verse spoken by Vairocana is terse: it appears to speak of the dependent (paratantra) and perfected (pariniṣpanna) natures, the "two" being these, characterized by the eight consciousnesses; the rendering follows the Tibetan closely. The phrase 'dren ldan, describing the syllable a, and yi ge 'dren pa, "the leading letters," are rendered literally; they may refer to the vowels or to letters that carry the others.
• The verses at the opening follow the statement that Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One, yet the prose after them addresses the Lord of Secrets; the speaker is therefore left as the text gives it, without quotation marks. The confession formula says "from this time onward until I reach the heart of awakening" before confessing past deeds; this is translated as it stands.
• "Free of fever" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□, probably reflecting Sanskrit nirjvara, a standard epithet of nirvāṇa and of the Buddha.
• The word rendered "saplings" (Tibetan gel pa) is uncertain; it appears to denote young trees or shoots. "Adorned with the array of the flower-ground essence" likely reflects Sanskrit kusumatalagarbhavyūhālaṃkāra, the name of the world system familiar from the Avataṃsaka literature.
• "The Invincible One" renders mi bzod pa, and "the great protectress, the Invincible" renders mi bzad srung ba chen mo; the underlying Sanskrit names of these protective deities could not be identified with certainty. The "Mother of the Buddhas" is a standard epithet of the Perfection of Wisdom sūtras.
• "Uragasāra" renders sbrul gyi snying po, literally "snake essence," the name of a precious sandalwood. The implement given to the female servants, written khad ga ri, is most likely the Sanskrit kaṭāri, a dagger; this identification is tentative. "The Blessed Lady" appears to refer to the Eye of Space just mentioned.
• "Discriminating knowledge" renders so so yang dag par rig pa (Skt. pratisaṃvid), the analytical knowledges of a buddha. The verb in the name of the laugh, bsgral ba, here has its ordinary sense of ferrying beings across the ocean of existence, not the wrathful-rite sense.
• In the verse "He fully comprehends the masteries," □□□ is taken in the sense of the bodhisattva's masteries (vaśitā) attained on the ten grounds, not ritual empowerment; likewise □□□□□ in "the mindstreams of all the world" means the mental continua (saṃtāna) of beings, not "tantra." The sentence on bodhisattvas not accomplishing a fixed establishment of their own mind is terse; it is rendered literally.
• In the final question, □□□□□□□□□ is rendered "attaining mastery" (vaśitā) rather than

"empowerment," as the context is mastery over all phenomena. The phrase "leaders of the herd" renders □□□□□□□□ (Skt. ṛṣabha, "bull"), an epithet of the buddhas.
• Before the sword mudrā the Tibetan reads □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("full mudrā"); since the phrase refers back to the mudrā just described, it is taken as a slip for □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, "the secret mudrā." In the sword verse, □□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□, the perishable collection (satkāya). □□□□□□□□□ in "gain mastery over all phenomena" is rendered as mastery rather than empowerment.
• In the final sentence the Tibetan reads □□□□□□□□, taken as a slip for □□□□□□□□, "I do not declare." "Person" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (Skt. manuja).
• "Cutting off the root" reads □□□□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□□□ (□□ "cut off"), the evident reading for an unclear □□. "Mahendra" here, as in earlier pieces, names the earth maṇḍala (the square yellow maṇḍala of Indra), and the elements water, wind and fire are the corresponding maṇḍalas assigned to each mantra family. "Vajrin" (□□□□□□□□□□, "the one possessing the vajra") denotes the Vajra family lord. □□□□□□□□□ is the Tibetan spelling of Sanskrit indranīla, sapphire.
• □□□□□□□ is an uncommon disease name; it is rendered here as "pallor sickness," a sickness marked by a pale, wasted complexion, but its exact identification is uncertain. "Ritual of action" renders □□□□□□□□□□□, the rite of ritual activities (karma), presumably the rites taught earlier in the tantra.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.